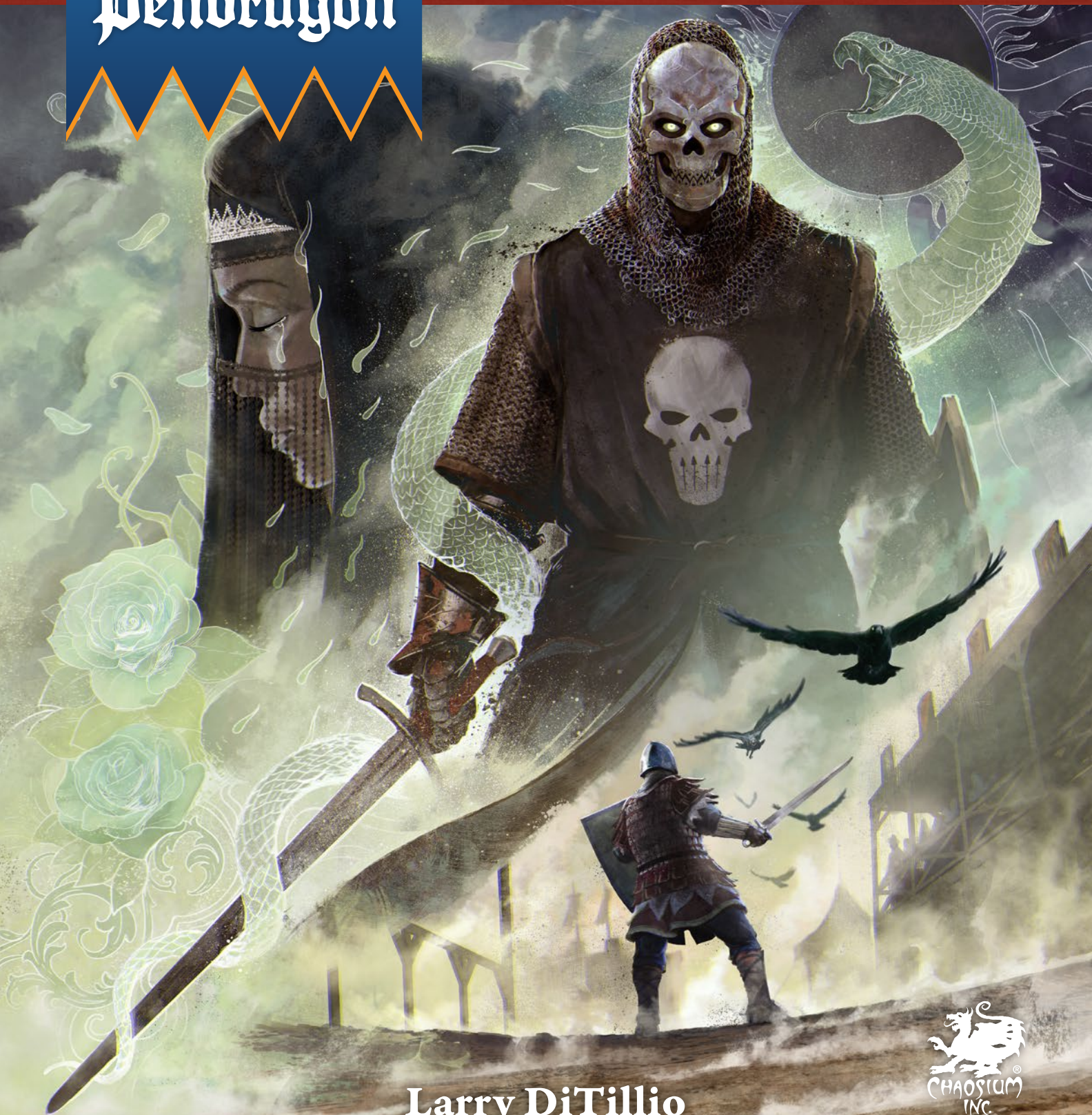




Pendragon

The Grey Knight

A Pendragon Campaign



Larry DiTillio



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The Grey Knight

Larry DiTillio



The Grey Knight, Revised Edition

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“The Grey Knight” by Loïc Muzy

The spectres of the mysterious Grey Knight and the enigmatic Lady de Vawse loom over the tournament field at Carlion as premonitions of doom rush towards the brave defender of King Arthur’s court.



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Introduction



In the year 515, a terrible and otherworldly threat comes to King Arthur's court. Although the reason for the coming of the Grey Knight at first is shrouded

in mystery, over the events of the scenario, the Player-knights will come to find that sins of the past do not always stay there, nor do old enemies long dead always stay in the ground...

The Grey Knight comes jam-packed with enough action and adventure to keep your group playing for some time and plants many seeds of future plot developments for those who wish to continue their adventures beyond the events described herein.

The first two scenarios, intended as precursors to the main event, as it were, should take one or two sessions to complete apiece.

The first scenario, entitled "Bearding the Lion," finds the Player-knights marching to war under King Arthur's banner. The Boy King's wars of unification are reaching a crescendo, and the fate of all of Britain lies in the hands of the Player-knights and their comrades in arms. Those who die on the field of Terrabil will leave lasting legacies that reverberate throughout the remainder of the events described in this book.

The second scenario, "King Pellinore's Quest," introduces the Player-knights to many great marvels, from the young enchantress Nimue to the twin legends of the Questing Beast and its dogged hunter, King Pellinore!

As for "The Grey Knight" scenario proper, many strange and wondrous adventures await. Take your time with these. You will likely need two or three sessions to get through the events of this scenario alone!

It is not strictly necessary for the Player-knights to know each other at the beginning of the scenario, but getting them acquainted

“YPWV”

The events of *The Grey Knight* feature many situations drawn directly from or otherwise referencing Arthurian canon. If this is your first time running **Pendragon**, or you are still relatively new to the game, keep in mind that the tenet “Your **Pendragon** Will Vary” (YPWV) is key to this game. It gives explicit permission from the designer to change elements of the setting as a Gamemaster wishes, but it also signals an understanding that *every* game is going to be different. The Players’ actions and the Gamemaster’s preferences change characters, events, and interpretations of what and why.

Remember, the goal is to have fun. Now go forth and have fun!

as soon as possible is advisable. Use the events of the Prologue Scenarios that follow for that purpose, or they may improvise their own incidents to meld the Player-knights into what will eventually be a questing group.

Possession of either the **Pendragon Player’s Handook** or *Starter Set* is all that is required to run the scenarios in this mega-adventure.

Gamemasters who have run their group through the *Sword Campaign* from the *Starter Set* can easily dovetail their campaign with *The Grey Knight*, thus creating their own six-year **Pendragon** campaign in the process!

On the other hand, if this is your first time running **Pendragon**, welcome! *The Grey Knight* serves as an excellent introduction in its own right to the world of King Arthur and his knights. Herein, you will find many of the game’s central themes presented in all their glory, as well as gain a solid introduction to the personalities and politics (to say nothing of the supernatural threats!) that characterize Arthur’s Britain.

For those of you already engaged in your own **Pendragon** campaigns, you will find *The Grey Knight* fits right in, with easy introductions to the various scenarios that should work

regardless of where your Player-knights call home. Salisbury knights, for example, march to war with Count Robert in 513 and would naturally be invited to the royal wedding in 514 and the Easter tournament in 515.

Finally, a note on freedom of play.

This adventure presents a complete story from start to finish, providing many avenues for Player-knights to interact with the plot. It also presents methods for keeping the Players on the right track. Despite your best efforts, Players may inevitably find a different way to approach a problem than described here. Also, the luck of the dice has a way of derailing even the best-planned episode.

Allow this creative freedom to guide you rather than trying to strongarm a rigid plotline. The capacity for success and failure, and the exciting and unexpected changes this creates, is critical to the roleplaying game experience. Half the enjoyment of gamemastering comes from adjusting your plans to cope with the Players’ inventiveness.

Earlier Versions

This revised edition is the third version of *The Grey Knight*.

The original, published in 1986, was the first stand-alone adventure for **Pendragon** and published by Chaosium in 1986, was written by Larry DiTillio, author of the classic **Call of Cthulhu** scenario *Masks of Nyarlathotep*, among much else in the worlds of gaming and entertainment media.

An updated version saw print as part of the adventure anthology *Tales of Mystic Tournaments*, edited and revised by Matthew DeForrest and published by Green Knight Publishing in 2000.

This version builds on both its predecessors by introducing two Prologue Scenarios and making a few changes to “The Grey Knight” scenario proper. Most notably, certain characters and locations were changed to bring the events of *The Grey Knight* back in line with the detailed Arthurian chronology developed by Greg Stafford in *The Great Pendragon Campaign* and subsequent publications.



Chapter 1

Prologue Scenarios



These prologue scenarios take place in the two years running up to the events of *The Grey Knight* proper in 515 and may involve Player-knights from the

Pendragon Starter Set or knights of your own creation. If this is your first **Pendragon** adventure, see the nearby boxed text for a summary of recent events leading up to these years.

513: Bearding the Lion

With the recent revelation of Arthur's royal parentage, Merlin at last puts to rest the lingering doubts of the Boy King's right to rule; the gift of Excalibur only added to his increasingly regal presence. Priests say the sword is a sign of the king's divine right to rule, while bards sing that it marks Arthur's incarnation as the

The rumors presented here and elsewhere often bear no immediate fruit, though for some their importance becomes more obvious in the years ahead. Players familiar with Arthurian lore will probably recognize their significance. Regardless, little details such as these help create a sense of a larger living world.

Shining One, come to save the land in its time of need. For his part, King Arthur now styles himself the Pendragon, like his father Uther and uncle Aurelius Ambrosius before him.

The comings and goings of innumerable nobles, envoys, petitioners, and supplicants fill the knights' lives whenever they visit the king at court. Many eligible young ladies are calling as well, for everyone agrees the king needs a queen. The chaos and confusion of years past is mostly a memory now.

With all these visitors come swarms of rumors, buzzing like bees after pollen. There is talk of a visit sometime last year from Lot's wife, Queen Margawse, on some sort of secret mission of peace. What came of it few can say, though there is speculation the king is now betrothed to one of Lot's daughters. Others whisper of a barbaric tragedy in the North, of an evil force (Merlin, perhaps?) who snatched hundreds of infant boys from their cradles and murdered—or sacrificed—them.

Now, it is the year 513, and after a one-year respite, rumors of war swirl once again. If Margawse did indeed venture south to work out a peace deal, it did not hold. A successful **Intrigue** roll discloses a rumor of nightmares that have been plaguing King Arthur lately, though no one knows the cause save, perhaps, Merlin, and he is tight-lipped about the whole thing. By day, the king is as active as ever and always happy to stop in his current business (whatever it may be) to discuss Chivalry.

The Player-knights have been busy training for battle, forming their own established conroi. The Player-knight with the highest Glory is the conroi commander by default. If another Player-knight has a better Battle Skill and wishes the position for themselves, the more Glorious knight must succeed at a **Modest** roll first to cede the position (and earn a check to the Trait in the process).

As spring gives way to summer, word reaches Arthur that King Ryons is besieging King Leodegrance at Castle Terrabil, near Stafford in Cameliard. The king orders his army to assemble and march to lift the siege! Mustering and marching out go smoothly, and other lords join Arthur's summons as he makes the 90-mile march north from his unofficial capital at Carlion.

Arriving at the siege as the sun begins to set, the Player-knights see the mighty double-motte-and-bailey edifice of Castle Terrabil and the enemy's siegeworks surrounding it. On a hill sit two great tents: One bearing the arms of Ryons and the other the arms of King Lot, the Pendragon's great rival. It seems the Twelve Kings of the North have linked up. This will be another desperate and bloody battle.

The army makes camp and settles in. Envoys ride between Arthur's tent and those of the rival kings. Arrangements are made to meet on the battlefield in the morning. Everyone else marks the time, checking and double-checking their weapons, armor, and horses, trying to give themselves something to do to pass the time. There is much chatter but little laughter or singing to be heard. Everyone knows that Ryons and his brother Nero are fearsome

Recent Events

510: Arthur the Boy King draws the Sword from the Stone. Some lords of Britain proclaim him the High King, while others raise the flag of rebellion. Arthur and his allies win a desperate battle at the gates of Carlion.

511: King Arthur finds more allies and once again fights his rival, King Lot, and his rebel army at the Battle of Bedegraine. Thanks to Merlin's magic, the arrival of an allied army from the Continent, led by King Ban of Benwick, sends Lot's army fleeing north once again.

512: Merlin helps Arthur recover Excalibur from the Ladies of the Lake; later, his lineage is confirmed by the dowager Queen Ygraine, who acknowledges him as her son by King Uther, stolen away by Merlin while still an infant. Arthur is hailed as the Pendragon.

513: King Arthur begins promulgating his new philosophy of chivalry, an idealized view of knighthood. Earlier this year, Sir Balin le Sauvage killed Nineve, chief Lady of the Lake, by beheading her at Arthur's court. This act of infamy led to his banishment and exile, leading to the incident of the Dolorous Stroke and the creation of the Wasteland.

opponents, rumored to be half-giants, and their troops have swollen the ranks of Lot's already impressive host.

At this point, one of the Player-knight's squires (pick at random) comes running up, their face looking fit to burst. "My lord! I've just heard—"

The squire stops, suddenly realizing they are shouting. They move in closer, dropping their voice to a whisper.

"I've just been down to yonder village to see to reprovisioning, and I got to talking with the local alewife. She tells me King Ryons is



involved in a secret love affair with a certain Lady de Vawse—and she dwells not far from here, *and* the king is even now engaged in an assignation with her!” The squire is nearly shouting again with excitement, and it is easy to see why. If the Player-knights can catch the king without his bodyguard, they might have a chance of capturing him and bringing him back as a gift for Arthur on the eve of battle!

A **Trusting/Suspicious** Opposing Trait roll may be in order. The squire is clearly in earnest, but it is quite possible the youth has fallen for a trap meant to lure knights away from

the army for capture and interrogation. Let the Player-knights hash out an argument. Not all need to go, though those who remain behind should get a check to Prudent and are Out of the Story for now. Only a critical success with **Suspicious** absolutely prevents a Player-knight from going. Presumably, perhaps after a bit of cajoling, all the Player-knights jump at the chance to secure the ransom of a king and impress their own lord in the bargain.

Everyone gets into their armor and prepares to set out. The squire leads the Player-knights into Cannock Chase Wood, along quiet trails by the light of the moon and away from the encamped armies. After about a half-hour, the light of a campfire becomes visible through the

KING RYONS OF NORGALLES

A fearsome foe, undefeated in combat

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON	APP
25	14	18	21	15

ATTACKS

WEAPON	SKILL	VALUE	DAMAGE
Marmiodoise	Sword	20 (+3)	7D6
Dagger	Brawling	14	2D6+7

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	46
Knockdown	25
Major Wound	21
Unconscious	12

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	21
Armor Points	9
Glory Award	200*
Healing Rate	4

Armor: Advanced hauberk, aketon

Traits: Chaste 7, Energetic 18, Forgiving 5, Generous 18, Honest 12, Just 12, Merciful 8, Modest 0, Prudent 6, Spiritual 10, Temperate 8, Trusting 6, Valorous 20

Passions: Hate (King Arthur) 14, Honor 15, Hospitality 15, Love (Family) 18, Love (Lady de Vawse) 20, Station 12

Skills: Awareness 14, Battle 20 (+2), Compose 10, Courtesy 10, Falconry 5, First Aid 12, Flirting 8, Folklore 7, Horsemanship 20, Hunting 12, Intrigue 8, Orate 8, Play Instrument 7, Recognize 8, Religion (Pagan) 6

* Ryons' Glory reflects his Sword Skill of 20 (+3); increase this to 300 or 500 if he boosts his Skill by +5 or +10, respectively, with his Love (Lady de Vawse) Passion (i.e., if he is Inspired or Impassioned, respectively, by the Passion).

trees. A pavilion tent stands nearby, with two horses—one a gentle palfrey, the other a massive stallion—contentedly grazing in the flickering shadows.

King Ryons is inside the tent with his lady. He has just arrived and has taken off his helmet and coif and set aside his shield but is otherwise still armed and armored, though the Player-knights have no way of knowing this. All they can make out (with a successful **Awareness** roll) is a great rumbling voice engaged in quiet conversation. Indeed, the half-giant is reciting a bit of love poetry, it seems!

Let the Player-knights decide how they wish to

approach the situation. Are they looking to kill King Ryons or capture him for ransom? Do they wish to nominate a champion from among their ranks to fight him, or do they gang up on him? (There is no Honor loss for the latter tactic, though it is not terribly chivalrous.) Attempts to capture Ryons through trickery or stealth earn a Deceitful check, but the Player-knights may go ahead if they wish. A particularly dishonorable and unchivalrous action would be to take Lady de Vawse hostage or otherwise threaten her life. Famously or Exaltedly Honorable or Chivalrous knights will reject this plan out of hand, but if the Player-knights do go through with it, make an opposed roll of Ryons' **Love (Lady de Vawse)**



King Ryons

The Player-knights' decision of how to confront King Ryons is precisely the sort of moment that helps define their legacies.

The Sword of King Ryons

King Ryons wields a sword called *Marmiodoise*. It is said the Pagan god Vulcan forged it, and the heroes Jason and Hercules wielded it. Brandishing or even wearing the blade grants a +2 bonus to the owner's Sword Skill.

The sword glows with an intense light when unsheathed, bright enough to blind opponents. Those fighting the wielder of Marmiodoise suffer -5 to their Weapon Skills. Making a successful Awareness roll negates the penalty for one Combat Round at a time; characters may make the roll at the start of every round before attempting a Combat Action.

Passion versus his **Prudent**. If Prudent wins, he surrenders without a fight.

Sir Ryons does not otherwise voluntarily surrender; he must be rendered unconscious or killed outright. He invokes his **Love (Lady de Vawse)** Passion before combat is joined, applying the bonus to his Sword Skill. If mounted foes attack, he first uses his great strength to Grapple and pull down the riders, putting them on an even footing with him.

If Ryons is killed or incapacitated, Lady de Vawse (who has been watching from just inside the tent) runs forth, wailing. "Villains! You have slain the noblest of knights!" she spits, her eyes blazing with equal parts grief and fury. It is a face the Player-knights will not soon forget...

THE BATTLE OF TERRABIL

If the Player-knights capture or kill King Ryons and bring him back to Arthur's tent that night, the Pendragon is, of course, delighted. If Ryons is still alive, he remains defiant, spitting at Arthur's feet. In return, King Arthur orders Ryons clapped in irons.

Either way, the Boy King covers the Player-knights in Glory. If any of their number has grievous wounds, he calls for Merlin to see to them. Strangely, the old magician is nowhere to

be found. Arthur nevertheless has his personal barber-surgeon tend to them (First Aid 20 (+1), Chirurgery 20).

If the Player-knights failed in their mission or refused to go, shortly before dawn, two mystery knights appear dragging a beaten and bloodied Ryons behind them. "We found this one trying to sneak back to his camp, sire," they report. They bear no arms and refuse to give their names when asked, but Arthur accepts the prisoner happily. The mystery knights depart shortly thereafter.

Now, the sun rises blood-red over a misty field. Lot's army is practically wrapped in a blanket of fog, the king's tent barely visible.

As Arthur's army shakes out onto the field, only a portion of Lot's army is there to meet him. In command, it seems, is Sir Nero, the younger brother of King Ryons. But where is King Lot, and why does the rest of the army hang back?

The two forces clash. King Arthur watches from the rear, keeping part of his own army in reserve in case of treachery. The Player-knights are Out of the Battle in this first clash, and so watch along with the High King as his army grinds down Nero's troops, setting them to retreat by noon.

Hardly have the cheers of Arthur's knights gone up than they die away again as the bulk of the forces of King Lot at last march forth, the king of Lothian riding at their head. Arthur hastily calls his troops back to reform and prepare for another engagement.

Just then, blaring trumpets announce the arrival of another bataille: This force flies the arms of King Pellinore! He and Arthur embrace on the field, and Arthur quickly gives Pellinore a place in the main guard near to the Player-knights.

Now King Lot, his bellowing shouts audible across the bloody battlefield, spurs his knights forward. Arthur orders a countercharge. The battle is joined!

If you have access to the Battle rules found in the **Pendragon Starter Set** or *Gamemaster's Handbook* and wish to game out the conflict, guidelines are presented below for running

The identities of the mystery knights will be revealed in the battle ahead.

Merlin wove a powerful spell that kept King Lot from joining the battle in the morning and his rage at this magical trickery is great.

this portion of the fight. Otherwise, quickly narrate the actions and outcomes of the day before wrapping up and moving on to the end of this year's adventure.

The afternoon battle lasts four Battle Turns. The starting Intensity is 14.

Battle Cards

Select the following Encounters and Opportunities:

- * Knights of Lothian
- * Knights of Gorre
- * Knights of Malahaut
- * Breton Mercenary Knights
- * Northern Prickers
- * Irish Kerns
- * Cambrian Archers
- * Capture the Banner
- * Clash of Champions
- * Fight Enemy Commander
- * Rally the Division!
- * Rescue Captive Knights

Events

- * **Turn 2:** Two knights burst from cover and fall upon Lot's flank, killing knights and single-handedly scattering their foes like a storm. If the Player-knights are part of this Event, they are close enough to recognize the men: They are none other than Sir Balin, the Knight of Two Swords, and his brother, Sir Balan! (If the Player-knights failed to capture King Ryons, they now recognize the duo as the knights who brought the king to camp earlier today.) Every Player-knight involved in this Event enjoys a +5 bonus to their Weapon Skills as inspiration sweeps through the ranks!
- * **Turn 3:** King Lot and King Pellinore clash. With mighty blows that strew gobbets of blood, armor, and flesh around the field, the two mighty heroes fight until, at last, Pellinore strikes Lot dead, cleaving him from skull to teeth. The rebels are stunned for a moment, then either surrender or turn and flee. Player-knights involved in



Transcendent Beauty

Some characters are noted for their Transcendent Beauty. Those who look upon them often find themselves in thrall and consumed with a desire to possess or protect the character at all costs.

The Gamemaster may wish to impose a chance to generate an involuntary Adoration Passion whenever a Player-knight first sees a person of Transcendent Beauty, wealth, political power, and grace. These folks include Queen Guenever, Queen Isoud, Sir Lancelot, Sir Tristram, and any characters the Gamemaster thinks are worthy. This obligatory roll is attempted only once when the character first sees such perfection.

To see if an involuntary Adoration is gained, the Player must roll the character's **Lustful**, **Arbitrary**, and **Honest** Traits as a Test. If all three rolls succeed, the power of

the Transcendent Beloved overwhelms the knight, who gains the Adoration Passion at a value of 1D6 plus any bonuses from Transcendent Beauty. These bonuses vary by character; in the case of Guenever, the starting Passion has a value of 1D6+10. If the character fumbles any of these Trait rolls, it generates a Jealousy Obsession with a value of +2D6 instead (see the *Pendragon Player's Handbook* for more details).

If the character already has an Adoration Passion greater than the generated value, they may ignore the new Adoration Passion. However, if the new Adoration value is higher than the old, the character abandons their former Beloved to moon over the unearthly beauty and charisma of this perfect specimen before them. (You may only maintain one Adoration Passion at a time.)

this Event may only fight one Combat Round of their Encounter, regardless of Posture. If they win the round and inflict damage, their enemy surrenders and may provide a ransom (if a knight).

- ✱ **Turn 4:** With Lot dead, his army routs off the field. If the Player-knights are involved in this Event, they may select the Rescue Captive Knights Opportunity without the need for a roll and no minimum Morale.

CONCLUSION

King Lot is dead! The Northern Rebellion is crushed. Arthur orders a magnificent tomb erected to cover the graves of the twelve enemy kings slain here. (If the Player-knights did not kill King Ryons, they learn he died after being clapped in irons under mysterious circumstances.) He takes his remaining army and marches northward, seizing the possessions and lands of all who opposed him. Norgales falls, as does Lothian. Arthur seizes the lands of the dead kings, and his army occupies their strong points.

"Let us pray that this is the last of those forbidding conflicts," he says that winter, a great Yule log crackling in the hearth. "For certes the Virgin of Battles has been with us. But for the sake of the commons, our farms, and especially our families, let us drink to this being the end of the fighting!"

Witnesses of Love

As a final coda to the year's events, the Player-knights are present in the solar of Castle Terrabil when King Arthur first meets Lady Guenever. They themselves have never seen her in person.

See the above boxed text on "**Transcendent Beauty**" for the rules concerning generating an Adoration Passion for her.

What is crystal clear to all present is that the Boy King is instantly smitten with the princess as he blushes and trips over his words to make small talk. Gone is all the royal dignity and high talk of Chivalry; here, instead, is an earnest young lad experiencing true love for the first time.

The solar is a small, private hall used by the lord and their family. It is usually situated on an upper floor with good access to light. In many cases, solars are attached to the main hall and accessed from behind the dais.

Glory for 513

- ✱ 200 Glory for defeating Ryons
 - +100 if he fought while Inspired
 - +300 if he fought while Impassioned
- ✱ 100 Glory for returning Ryons (dead or alive) to Arthur
- ✱ 120 Glory for participating in the Battle of Terrabil, plus Glory for opponents defeated
- ✱ 240 Glory for the conroi commander
- ✱ 25 Glory for being present at the meeting of Arthur and Guenever

514: King Pellinore's Quest

The year is now 514. The start of the scenario finds the Player-knights on the road to Carlion once again. This time, happily, the reason for their journey is one of peace rather than war. After many back-and-forth exchanges between envoys and diplomats, the High King has agreed to marry the daughter of King Leodegrance of Cameliant: Lady Guenever.

The Player-knights have heard lots of gossip about the upcoming nuptials. Everyone knows King Leodegrance is sending the Round Table of King Uther as a wedding gift. This is a massive circular table that Uther Pendragon occasionally used for meetings of his lords; there are rumors that King Arthur intends to found an order of knighthood to commemorate this gift.

The suitability of the match has been much discussed, with some averring the Cameliant princess has captured the young king's heart, and they are marrying for love, while others insist it is simply a strategic alliance and love has nothing to do with it—as with most marriages amongst the

nobility. A successful **Intrigue** roll divulges the knowledge that Merlin does not approve of the union; a critical success gives the reason: He has foreseen doom in this union, though he is not sure of its precise nature.

HUNTING THE QUESTING BEAST

The Player-knights are within a day's ride of Carlion on a fine early summer morning when they must all make **Awareness** rolls. Those who succeed hear a ghostly noise on the breeze, the disembodied howls of hounds on the trail of their quarry. (Those who then succeed at **Folklore** immediately think of the dreaded Wild Hunt!) Soon after, everyone hears the sound of a great creature drawing near.

Everyone must now roll **Valorous** as a Test; any Player-knight who is thinking of the Wild Hunt suffers a -5 penalty. Those who fail are reluctant to investigate further, while a fumble sends the knight fleeing in panic as they check their Cowardly Trait. They are Out of the Story until the next scene, when they can meet up with their friends again.

The noise is coming from nearby woods, and Player-knights who succeeded at their **Valorous** rolls may move forward to investigate.

The noise of hounds and pursuit guides them towards a copse of trees. There, beyond the screen of trunks and branches, they see a marvelous sight: A large creature with the neck of a snake, the body of a leopard, the haunches of a lion, and the feet of a hart is descending towards a pool. As it lowers its serpentine head and begins to drink the water, the noise of the hounds ceases altogether.

THE QUESTING BEAST

Also called Glatisant, or the Barking Beast

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON
65	45	25	30

ATTACKS

WEAPON	VALUE	DAMAGE
Bite	10	4D6

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	95
Knockdown	65
Major Wound	30
Unconscious	24

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	40
Armor Points	10
Glory Award	Special
Healing Rate	6

Skills: Avoidance 20 (+5) when pursued, 20 (+15) when cornered or approached

Special Glory Awards: 15 for seeing it, 100 for getting within one yard of it, 250 for killing it, and 500 for capturing it alive.



Chapter 1: Prologue Scenarios

Though the Player-knights do not know it, there is nothing they can do to avoid being late to the wedding feast.

A successful **Folklore** roll with a +5 bonus identifies the creature as the legendary Questing Beast. A critical success recalls that, although it has been hunted by many a knight, it is most commonly pursued by the great King Pellinore—he must not be far from here!

However, right now, the Player-knights have the Questing Beast all to themselves. Point out the potential Glory award for capturing the monster and hint that presenting its head at the royal wedding feast would bring yet more Glory. On the other hand, pursuit might make the knights late for the wedding...

The Player-knights must all make **Selfish** Trait Decision rolls at this point. Any who succeed are taken under the spell of the Questing Beast and feel compelled to hunt it. Those who roll a critical success immediately develop an Avarice Obsession of +2D6 for the Beast (see the **Pendragon Core Rulebook** for more details). Those who fail their **Selfish** tests may decide to follow their comrades or press on; those who choose the latter are Out of the Story for the time being as well.

Pursuing the Questing Beast takes the Player-knights deeper into the rough and wooded hills. The knight with the highest



Hunting Skill should take the lead and make an opposed roll against the Barking Beast's Avoidance of 20 (+5). A win or partial success keeps it in sight, while a loss means the group can only hear the baying of the hounds inside Glatisant's belly. Any fumble, or two losses in a row, means the Player-knights are utterly lost; proceed to "**A Dastardly Knight**" below.

A critical success corners the Questing Beast in some manner. Inform the Players of the potential Glory awards for approaching it, killing it, or capturing it alive. Any attempt to attack or corral Glatisant must beat its Avoidance, now risen to 20 (+15). A partial success merely keeps it cornered, while a loss allows it to escape. The Player-knights may resume the hunt or else resume their course towards Carlion (after finding the main road).

A DASTARDLY KNIGHT

After the encounter with the Questing Beast, the Player-knights may be separated—some having fled, others pressing on, still others lost in the woods.

Suffice it to say that, despite their best efforts, they find themselves still on the road as the day wears on. Eventually, they reunite (if necessary); as they catch their first glimpse of Carlion's mighty Roman walls and the cyclopean eminence of the Giants' Tower, they hear every church bell in the city ringing out. They have missed the wedding ceremony!

No matter. They will arrive in time for the feast, which is bound to last all day and well into the night. Or so they think...

Within sight of the gates, the Player-knights spot a knight riding hell-for-leather away from the city. He is too distant to make out much more in the way of detail than the fact he wears a black surcoat and rides a black charger; also clear is the fact he bears a noblewoman with wild, unbound red hair slung across his saddle and, judging from her kicking and screaming, she is being borne away against her will!

Clearly, swift action is required. Each Player-knight wishing to pursue must roll against their horse's **Movement Rate**, opposing the **Movement Rate** of the Black Knight's

steed—normally 16, it is reduced to 11 due to the lady's added weight and her furious thrashings throwing off its balance. Sort out the wins, partial successes, losses, and fumbles.

- ✱ A *win* catches up with the Black Knight. This requires another successful opposed roll, this time using **Horsemanship** against his Skill of 20, to draw close enough to block the knight's progress. A critical success accomplishes this automatically.
- ✱ A *partial success* keeps up with the Black Knight and adds a +5 bonus to further **Movement Rate** rolls to catch him.
- ✱ A *loss* lags behind. Further **Movement Rate** rolls are made without bonus or penalty.
- ✱ A *fumble* requires an immediate **Horsemanship** roll to avoid being thrown for 2D6 damage. If the Player-knight succeeds, future **Movement Rate** rolls are made at -5. On a failure, they fall ruinously and lose any chance to catch up with the knight.

Each set of opposed **Movement Rate/Horsemanship** rolls is one phase of the chase. If the Black Knight's progress is not blocked after four phases, he gets away, outpacing the Player-knights with a dazzling display of horsemanship. Proceed to "**If the Knights Are Defeated**" to learn of their much-reduced role in this tale.

Assuming at least one Player-knight stops the Black Knight's flight, the rest catch up in short order. Now face-to-face, a **Recognize** roll with a +3 bonus identifies the knight as Sir Hontzlake, a local knight of little honor. A critical success recalls his origin in far-off Wendland across the waves and his service as a mercenary during the Anarchy.

Sir Hontzlake is clearly affronted at this interruption, but not nearly as much as the maiden who slides from the saddle despite the knight's best efforts and stares up at him, sparks flying from her eyes, her righteous anger belying her apparent youth. "How you dare!" she sputters. "Do you realize what you've done?"

"Indeed, lady," replies Sir Hontzlake, sneering. "You are mine by right of conquest, as witnessed by none other than King Arthur himself!"

Any Player-knight who steps forward to defend the maiden may check their **Just**. Anyone hesitating may make a Trait Decision roll opposing **Just/Arbitrary**, with a success in the latter Trait causing sympathy for Sir Hontzlake's claim. Remember that chivalry is still a new concept, and Sir Hontzlake represents the type of knight who once thrived in the time of King Uther and the subsequent Anarchy. Indeed, Famously Arbitrary Player-knights may share his outlook and think chivalry a waste of time.

But we hope at least one Player-knight is willing to defend the maiden's honor. Sir Hontzlake gladly accepts challengers, though he insists on fighting them one at a time. If the Player-knights do not oblige his request (there is no Honor loss in this), he immediately begins fighting dirty, as described below. Otherwise, he challenges each individual knight to three passes with the lance, after which (if neither knight is unseated) they may draw their weapons and fight on to surrender or incapacitation.

SIR HONTZLAKE

The Black Knight of Wendland

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON	APP
10	16	14	18	9

ATTACKS

WEAPON	SKILL	VALUE	DAMAGE
Lance	Charge	20	6D6
Arming Sword	Sword	18	4D6
Dagger	Brawling	15	2D6+4

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	28
Knockdown	10
Major Wound	18
Unconscious	7

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	20
Armor Points	10+6
Glory Award	50
Healing Rate	4

Armor: Hauberk, nasal helm, aketon + kite shield*

Traits: Chaste 3, Energetic 17, Just 5, Merciful 4, Trusting 6, Valorous 15

Passions: Homage (King Alain) 8, Honor 8, Hospitality 10, Love (Family) 10, Station 18

Skills: Awareness 12, Courtesy 10, Falconry 15, Horsemanship 20, Hunting 14

* Shield penalizes -2 to all weapons when mounted except Mounted Charge with spear or lance; -10 Missile Attack Penalty



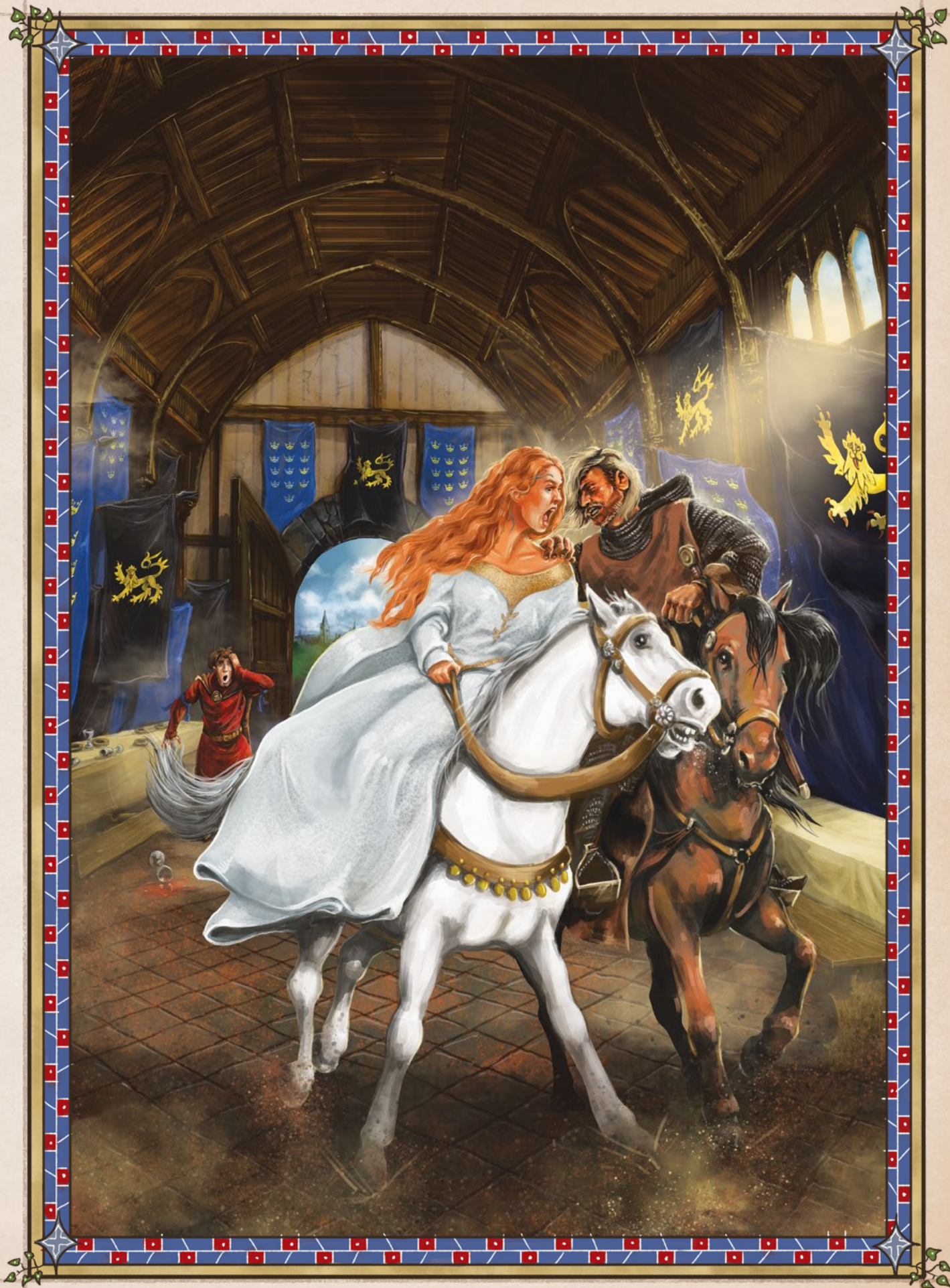
If Sir Hontzlake is knocked from his horse or reduced to half his Total Hit Points, he starts fighting dirty by aiming all of his attacks against the Player-knight's horse! Such perfidy surely warrants a Passion roll for **Honor**...

He accepts any offer of surrender and ransom but does not take the Player-knight with him, knowing he must keep moving swiftly to reach his castle before the knights at the wedding feast can mount an effective pursuit. He has no intention of surrendering and fights until incapacitation or death.

INTRODUCING NIMUE

If the Player-knights succeeded in defeating Sir Hontzlake, the abducted maiden approaches them, beams with joy, and exclaims, "Goodly knights, I praise thee for thy courage and gallantry! Surely there are no finer knights in all our young king's lands!" She proffers her pale hand to be kissed in gratitude. Those knights who bow and kiss her hand gain a check to Courtesy.

She introduces herself: "Verily, I am Nimue, a Maiden of the Lake. I was a-hunting alongside my lovely brachet when, to my dismay, this wretched cur snatched me from in front of the illustrious assemblage of King Arthur's wedding feast! Should you deign to accompany me



on my journey to Carlion, I shall be eternally indebted to thee. I must make amends and plead mercy from our good king and queen.”

KING PELLINORE’S QUEST

If the Player-knights succeeded in defeating Sir Hontzlake, they must now escort Nimue back to Carlion. If, on the other hand, Sir Hontzlake got the better of them, they are now his captives. Either way, they are due to encounter King Pellinore in short order.

If the Knights Are Victorious

If Sir Hontzlake yet lives, the Player-knights can anticipate collecting on his handsome £50 ransom. Even dead, news of his defeat should earn them recognition and recompense from the king in the form of an F50 Favor.

As they prepare to continue back to Carlion (with Nimue accompanying them, naturally), they spot a well-dressed, powerful knight riding towards them from the direction of the city. There is no need for Recognize rolls—this is clearly King Pellinore! The Questing Beast did indeed foretell his coming. Yet he is not hunting Glatisant this day.

“What ho!” cries the king, reining in his horse. “My enemy lies defeated? The maiden saved? I am in your debt, good knights! Now, if you’ll allow me, I shall escort the young madam back to court, as it was I who was bidden rescue her.”

The Player-knights are likely seeing their promises of riches and rewards draining away before their eyes. Do they protest? A **Prudent/Reckless** Decision roll may be in order. Player-knights who crossed lances with the king during the events of “The Adventure of the Broken Sword” (see the **Pendragon Starter Set** for more details) should certainly be thinking twice about challenging him now (and earn a check to Prudent if they demur).

Any who do dare to issue a challenge receive a jocular chuckle in reply. “Not giving her up without a fight, hm?” asks the king. “Very well. I can spare a few moments to show you why King Arthur entrusted me with this quest.”

If a Player-knight somehow overcomes King Pellinore and returns to Carlion with Nimue

Background: Lady Nimue

Just a few hours (or even minutes!) before she was abducted, Nimue was out hunting a white hart with her hounds and fairy brachet, a magical female scent hound. She got terribly lost and ended up crashing—literally—King Arthur’s wedding feast. She recklessly chased the hart right through the great hall, bursting through the doors in a calamity of baying and screaming. The hart bounded over the high table, and Nimue quickly took off after it. She was captured by Sir Hontzlake, who had been riding in pursuit (unbeknownst to her) a few moments later.

Lady Nimue is a major Arthurian magician character. A few years after the events of this scenario, she becomes the Chief Lady of the Lake, the High Priestess of Avalon, a magically hidden realm ruled by the pagan enchantresses called the Ladies of the Lake. She becomes Merlin’s apprentice when she later meets him in Carlion, seemingly betrays him in 517 by trapping him beneath a stone in Cornwall, and then wins the chieftaincy of the Ladies in 518, becoming one of the most powerful magicians in Britain and one of King Arthur’s most trusted and important allies.

instead, they indeed earn great rewards (see “**Conclusion**”), but also the enmity of King Pellinore and his many offspring.

Regardless, Nimue applies a magical healing ointment to any wounded Player-knights, restoring a total of up to 15 Hit Points, divided among them if necessary.

If the Knights Are Defeated

If Sir Hontzlake manages to defeat all his challengers, he extracts an oath to pay him their ransom within a year and a day before once again snatching up the maiden Nimue and riding off.

Shortly thereafter, the Player-knights spot King Pellinore coming up the road. He reins in

his horse and asks them if they have seen a Black Knight with a lady. The Player-knights are no doubt eager to help and may even accompany Sir Pellinore as he rides in pursuit, assuming they are not too wounded.

Those that do so then witness King Pellinore as he catches up with Sir Hontzlake and slays him after the dastardly knight kills the king's horse!

CONCLUSION

On the way back, the Player-knights observe a tragic scene. A knight, dead on the side of the road, and a lady lying dead across him, his sword transfixing her. If the knights are with King Pellinore, he cries out. "Alas! This lady I passed, paying her cries for mercy no heed, so intent was I on my quest. And now she is dead by her own hand, the sword of her lover, the instrument." He remains immersed in deep thought for the remainder of the journey.

In time, the Player-knights at last arrive at Carlion. They have missed the ritual gift-giving, in which the king and queen bestow their largesse upon their subjects, but may have earned some reward of their own, depending on their actions during this short but eventful scenario.

If the Player-knights defeated Sir Hontzlake, they each earn an F10 Favor from Lady Nimue. They may also divide amongst themselves either the knight's ransom of £50 (if he lives) or the F50 Favor from King Arthur (if they killed him). If it was the Player-knights who returned Nimue to Carlion, this becomes an F100 Favor divided among them, but—as noted above—they now have an enemy in King Pellinore and the de Gales clan.

Glory for 514

- * 15 Glory each for seeing the Questing Beast
 - 150 Glory as a group award, divided among the Player-knights who corner it
 - 250 Glory group award if they killed it
 - 500 Glory group award if they captured it
- * 50 Glory for killing or capturing Sir Hontzlake
- * 20 Glory for challenging King Pellinore
 - 200 Glory for defeating him

KING PELLINORE DE GALES

The Questing King

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON	APP
17	16	18	17	17

ATTACKS

WEAPON	SKILL	VALUE	DAMAGE
Lance	Charge	20 (+10)	6D6+2
Arming Sword	Sword	20 (+10)	6D6+2
Dagger	Brawling	15	2D6+8

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	34
Knockdown	17
Major Wound	17
Unconscious	9

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	22
Armor Points	12+6
Glory Award	200
Healing Rate	5

Armor: Advanced hauberk, advanced nasal helm, aketon + kite shield*

Traits: Chaste 2, Energetic 18, Forgiving 13, Generous 17, Honest 17, Just 12, Merciful 12, Modest 3, Prudent 6, Spiritual 12, Temperate 10, Trusting 10, Valorous 17

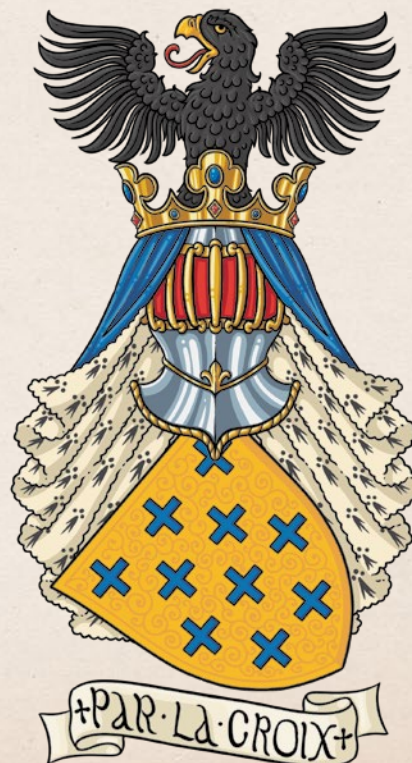
Directed Trait: Suspicious (Other Cambrian Kings) +9

Obsessions: Avarice (Glatissant, the Questing Beast) +28

Passions: Hate (Irish) 10, Honor 17, Hospitality 15, Love (Family) 12, Station 14

Skills: Awareness 16, Courtesy 10, Falconry 8, First Aid 17, Flirting 15, Folklore 11, Horsemanship 20 (+10), Hunting 20 (+4), Intrigue 5, Orate 7, Play Instrument 11, Recognize 8, Religion (Pagan) 11

* Shield penalizes -2 to all weapons when mounted except Mounted Charge with spear or lance; -10 Missile Attack Penalty





Chapter 2

Setting: The City of Carlion



ften called “King Arthur’s favorite city,” Carlion lies in a small, flat valley surrounded by low hills. To the south and east the River Usk (pronounced “ihsk”) winds past, providing a good highway to the sea at high tide.

Located in Escavalon, this is the see for Archbishop Dubricus, head of the Roman bishops in Britain. The archbishop is sometimes found here but is often on his own progress, visiting his bishops and other church lands.

Before King Arthur

In the long-ago past, this was once the site of a hillfort. During the time of the Romans, this was the home fortress for the *Legio II Augusta* for two centuries.



*How many dukes and earls withal,
Good authors, can you tell,
And so true writers shew you shall
How Arthur there did dwell?
What court he kept, what acts he did
What conquest he obtained?
And in what princely honour still
King Arthur long remained*

—Thomas Churchyard,
“The Worthiness of Wales”



Carlion (then called *Isca Silurum*) was the biggest fort in Cambria. Covering some fifty acres and solidly built of stone, it sported an amphitheater and palace complex outside the southern wall. A small civilian village (called

“Caerllion tref Newydd”) lay nearby, also to the south, between the fort and the river. Although the Romans pulled the legion out late in the third century, but the village and then-abandoned fort remained.

The ancestors of King Alain of Escavalon realized its military importance and kept it garrisoned and in good repair. After Arthur was crowned in Carlion, King Alain ceded the fort to his liege as a personal holding. Now, in the early years of Arthur’s reign, it is one of his favorite castles.

Carlion and Its Environs

Carlion is beautifully situated. By and large, it retains its rectangular shape characteristic of a Roman military camp (giving it the sobriquet of “Rome-camp”). Woods and meadows surround it. High above the water, not far from the city, a rocky eminence stands, dominating the River Severn. This local landmark is called Goldcliff, the Golden Rock. When the sun’s rays strike it, the stone shines very brightly and takes on a golden sheen.

The City

Carlion is a larger town than it was in Roman times. The amphitheater still stands, now used as a marshalling ground rather than for gladiatorial fights. The Roman palace to the south has recently undergone a restoration to make it suitable as a royal residence.

The passing of time wrought many changes in the fortress-city. It began in the Roman pattern, neatly laid out in square blocks and cut into quarters by the two principal streets found in every Roman camp (*cardo maximus*, going north-south, and *decumanus maximus*, going east-west). However, wars fought many years ago destroyed a wide area within the walls, where streets are now less organized. Between the high stone walls and the buildings inside is an open space of some 25 yards.

Houses, shops, servants’ quarters, and stables fill parts of the city now. In the center, the fine houses that once sheltered the military tribunes now quarter Arthur’s household knights and important guests. The old

legionary headquarters have become, with many additions, the Lord Mayor’s palace.

Other important sites include the riverside quay, split into commercial and military docks; the old legionary barracks, which now house the Lord Mayor’s soldiers; one of the city’s old Roman bathhouses, frequented by locals and visitors alike; and a great hospital, in use since Roman times.

Thursday is market day. There is a fair on the Feast Day of Saints Aaron and Julius on the 1st of July.

THE TOWER OF THE GIANTS

A castle stands at the eastern corner of the city. Originally a lone stone keep atop a double motte, it now boasts an outer bailey as well. Here is *Turris Gigantea*, *la Tor Gigantique*—the Tower of the Giants. It is so tall that it is possible to look over Christchurch Hill all the way across the River Severn mouth from its top battlements. Its castellan, a relative of King Alain of Escavalon, is named Sir Yonoc.

The bailey encloses the other of the city’s still-functioning Roman baths, these used more by the nobility. There is a rumored secret tunnel that goes below the river from beneath the motte toward Newport and another towards Caerwent.

Nearby, in an undisclosed location, is a hidden cave wherein Sleeping Warriors lie, waiting for the day of Britain’s need.

THE CHURCHES

There are two famous churches in Carlion, each dedicated to one of the third-century saints martyred here.

The Church of St. Julius (also called *Llan-tarnam*) hosts one of the three Perpetual Choirs in Britain, where two hundred monks sing hymns in shifts all day and night. It is here that Arthur is crowned and, later, he is married on the steps of the church by Archbishop Dubricus, who calls this his metropolitan church for all of Cambria (thus making it, technically, a cathedral).

The Church of St. Aaron (also called *Llan-aron*) supports a small school of philosophers,

$\frac{1}{2}$ mile

-ISCA SILURUM-



as well as a nunnery. Some whisper that the dubiously legal art of astrology is practiced in secret there.

THE COLISEUM

Colloquially called “The Coliseum” by locals, this Roman amphitheater did indeed once host gladiatorial combats and other spectacles. As Britain descended into disorder, the King of Escavalon ordered the amphitheater be fortified, turning it into an ersatz fortress.

It is here that the Boy King marshals his army in the early, desperate years of his reign; from here, he marches out to fulfill his destiny at the Battle of Carlion in 510. Later, when King Arthur receives his wondrous wedding gift of the Round Table from King Leodegrance, he needs a special place to set it up. After all, the table is fifty yards in diameter, far too large for any normal building of the time! The Coliseum makes a perfect site, and it is here the Round Table resides until the building of Camelot.

After the Round Table moves, the Coliseum’s fortifications are taken down, and it once again becomes the site of entertainments, this time as a jousting field during the *Pax Arthuriana*.

THE ROYAL RESIDENCE

This was once the riverside villa of the provincial Roman governor, raised when the military camp evolved into a city during the reign of Emperor Diocletian.

Later, it was taken as the residence of the kings of Escavalon before becoming a royal palace when King Alain of Escavalon bequeathed it to King Arthur as a token of the former’s allegiance and support in the first year of the latter’s reign.

In the ensuing five years, the building and grounds see extensive renovation and improvements to make the quarters worthy of the residency of the High King. It is now truly a royal palace, with the many amenities that implies. During the king’s annual progress, he always makes sure to include Carlion and its palace as part of his itinerary, and until the building of Camelot, it is here he spends his winters.



Now thrice that morning Guinevere had climbed

The giant tower, from whose high crest, they say,

Men saw the goodly hills of Somerset,

And white sails flying on the yellow sea;

But not to goodly hill or yellow sea

Looked the fair Queen, but up the vale of Usk,

By the flat meadow.

—Tennyson, *Idylls of the King*



Carlion’s Defenses

Carlion includes a city and a large castle complex. Carlion has the following defensive statistics (see the **Pendragon Noble’s Handbook** for more details):

- ✦ **City (DV 122):** 50 acres, 2,000-yard perimeter; Roman wall (7), 5 Double gates (–15), 5 Gateworks (5), 25 Roman towers (125)
- ✦ **Carlion Castle Walls (DV 29):** 10 acres, 785-yard perimeter; Curtain wall (7), 3 Double gates (–9), 3 Gateworks (3), 4 Round towers (28)
- ✦ **Turris Gigantea (DV 33):** Ditch and rampart (3), Triple motte (8), Chemise wall (5), Tall round keep (18), Gate (–2), Gateworks (1)





Chapter 3

The Brey Knight



he year is 515. It is spring in Britain, and the world is abloom again after a long, hard winter. King Arthur is hosting a tournament at Carlion.

The winner of the tournament gains the hand of his half-sister, Lady Achefflour. Naturally, all the great lords of Britain are turning up for this one, in addition to a nameless throng of landless knights and mercenaries, keeping their eyes on the main chance, as it were. The Player-knights may have a similar goal in mind or may simply be attending (as many others) to show their mettle and win Glory before such an esteemed audience, either on their own initiative or by command of their liege lords.

The tournament takes place a week after Easter, beginning on the second Monday

following. Many of the participants arrive at Carlion before the holy day (some to attend the spectacular Easter Mass conducted by Archbishop Dubricus), for this is a time of great pageantry and celebration and when new knights are made. Every spare room in Carlion and surrounding settlements hosts a knight and squire, it seems. Those who cannot find indoor shelter make do with their pavilion tents, which proliferate like a field of colorful wildflowers surrounding the grand city. The poorest knights sleep in the woods and wastes, their cloaks their only protection against the elements, their horses grazing at will.

Those Christian knights who arrive in time to attend the Easter mass receive experience checks for both the Religion (Christian) Skill and Spiritual Trait. Christian knights who have an opportunity to attend but choose not to get a Worldly check. At the latest, the knights must arrive on the Friday before the tournament.

*In the year 515,
Easter falls on the
fifth day of April.*

Court Gossip

As the lords of Britain and their retinues converge on Carlion for the grand Easter tournament, there is much exchanging of news and information. No Intrigue roll is required to learn the following tidbits; work them into your role-playing as the Player-knights converse with the attending knights and ladies at the tournament. By including news from faraway places that does not directly impact the Player-knights, you can facilitate a more immersive feeling of a living, breathing world.

- ✦ Sir Balin, the Knight of Two Swords, last seen at the Battle of Terrabil and notorious for his slaying of Lady Nineve of the Lake three years ago, has not been heard from in a year's time, nor has his brother, Sir Balan. Many assume they died on an adventure; some mourn the loss of two great knights while others curse Sir Balin's name for his perfidious deed in slaying a Lady of the Lake, and at the king's court, no less!
- ✦ There is word of a wasting drought in the north, in the far-off Kingdom of Listencisse. Refugees who have come south are calling their homeland the Wastelands now.
- ✦ Mark of Cornwall is the newly-crowned king of his realm, having gained the throne after the death of his father, King Idres.



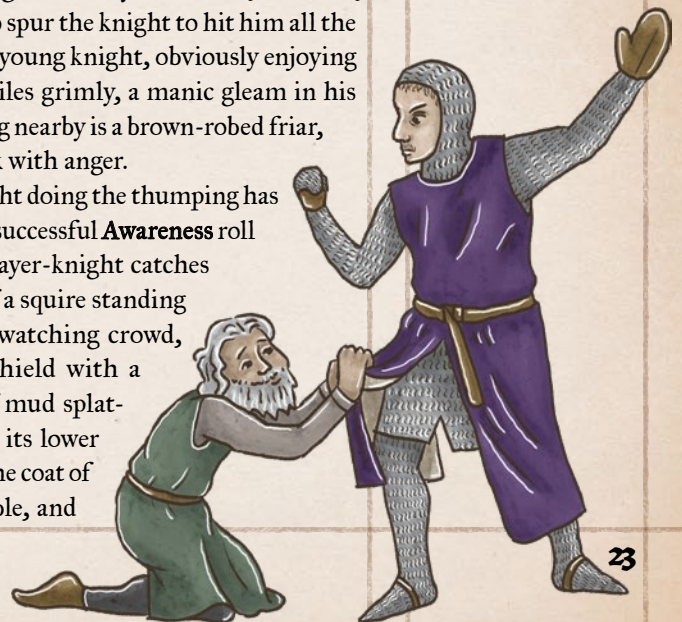
Sir Agravaine

A small crowd of travelers is gathered around an overturned cart. The ox in the yoke is all but dead, blood weakly pumping into a wide pool from a deep gash in its neck. Kneeling at the edge of this pool, an elderly woman cradles an unconscious young man in her arms. His battered face bears several rough gashes, and one eye has swollen shut. Hovering above her are two young women, both in tears. One holds a bawling three-year-old. The other, choked with sobs, tenderly caresses the face of the unconscious man. Close by, a very young knight with a handsome face and wispy mustache roundly thumps an aged peasant with his mailed fist. The peasant clings to his legs, begging for mercy. His cries, however, seem only to spur the knight to hit him all the harder. The young knight, obviously enjoying himself, smiles grimly, a manic gleam in his eye. Standing nearby is a brown-robed friar, his face dark with anger.

The knight doing the thumping has no shield. A successful **Awareness** roll from any Player-knight catches a glimpse of a squire standing amidst the watching crowd, holding a shield with a small bit of mud splattered across its lower quadrant. The coat of arms is visible, and

On The Road

Whatever day they arrive, as the knights travel the road to Carlion, they find traffic heavy with the usual crowd of nobles, peasants, hawkers, and gawkers all eager to catch a glimpse of the Pendragon and his household and enjoy the festivities. Not far from the city gates, the Player-knights come upon the following scene after passing an Irish cattle lord's herd (let the Players take note of this detail, which may become useful later on).



Chapter 3: The Grey Knight

a successful **Recognize** roll with a +2 bonus reveals it to be of the so-called Orkney clan, the family of the late King Lot of Lothian. A critical success identifies it as the shield of Sir Agravaine, the newly-knighted second son of King Lot himself and brother of the already-famous Sir Gawaine.

Also identifiable in the crowd is the bard Diarmuid. Christian knights unacquainted with the Order of Druids must first make a **Folklore** roll followed by an **Awareness** roll to spot him. Pagan knights, or those who have interacted with druids and bards before, only need roll **Awareness** roll to pick him out.

If the Player-knights attempt to discover why the beating is taking place, they have three options: Friar Coombs, Diarmuid, or the crowd.

The friar tells them the young knight demanded the peasant (the one now cradled in his mother's arms, wept over by his young wife) move his cart from his path, then struck and killed the ox before the peasant could comply. The cart overturned as the ox fell. The family—the peasant's wife and child, sister, mother, and father, who is now being beaten—were thrown out of the cart. As the peasant rose, he accidentally splashed some mud on the knight's shield. The knight became enraged at the perceived insult and began beating the peasant savagely. The peasant's father attempted to intervene but only succeeded in becoming the victim of the knight's anger after his son fell unconscious. Friar Coombs does not know who the knight is but thinks him both unchristian and unchivalrous. He asks the Player-knights to help the peasant.

If the Player-knights ask Diarmuid, he tells much the same story but with one addition: He recognizes Sir Agravaine. The flavor of the two descriptions, however, is different. Friar Coombs is filled with moral outrage, while Diarmuid's anger is cold. His role as a bard requires he watch and record the events transpiring but not intervene nor make any comment unless asked.

If the Player-knight asks other members of the crowd what happened, they get another

In King Arthur's Britain, bards are members of the larger druidic order and deft Enchanters in their own rights.

As with the encounter with King Ryons, this may prove a defining moment for the worldview of one or more of the Player-knights.

version of the same story, embellished from a societal point of view. For example, a noble witness may say the peasant tried to run the knight down with his cart. A peasant observer may claim the knight was out to dishonor the young peasant's wife. A third viewer may claim the peasant and his father tried to rob the knight, while a fourth may blame it all on the fairies. Be as creative as possible in creating confusion in the Players. If the knights ask the crowd what has happened, both Friar Coombs and Diarmuid step forward and offer their observations as well.

JUSTICE

The Gamemaster might suggest that the Player-knights attempt a **Just** Trait Decision roll:

- ✱ **Critical Success:** Sir Agravaine is acting in an Arbitrary manner by beating any peasant on the King's Road. Here they are under the protection of Arthur Pendragon, whose justice applies to all. Check Just and Honor.
- ✱ **Success:** Sir Agravaine has no reason to attack the father, who is only asking that mercy be given to his son. Check Just.
- ✱ **Failure:** The marking of Sir Agravaine's shield so close to the Easter Tournament could be interpreted as the peasant's attempt to prevent his participation in the tournament and win the hand of a princess. His reaction is understandable. The Player-knight cannot intervene unless they *fail* a roll against their **Station** Passion. Check Arbitrary.
- ✱ **Fumble:** Sir Agravaine, as a knight, is charged with keeping justice on the King's Road. To oppose him requires the case to be brought before the High King—who would doubtless frown on wasting his time. Check Arbitrary and Station.

Any Player-knight who opts to stop the beating before hearing an explanation receives a check to Merciful. Mercy does not wait for explanations, especially when the situation is as painfully obvious as this.

If Player-knights do nothing but watch, Friar Coombs begs them to intervene, saying the knight has no real reason to be so hard on the peasants. He tells them the story if they ask. Christian knights get a check to their Spiritual Trait if they are moved by the friar's plea to stop the beating. Non-Christian knights get a Trusting check if they believe the friar.

Needless to say, Sir Agravaine is none too happy with anyone interfering in his fun. He demands to know the name of the knight or knights involved. If asked his own name, he is certain to play up his relation to King Arthur and Sir Gawaine when he gives it. Player-knights must also decide how they will attempt to stop Agravaine from beating the old peasant. If they merely tell him to cease, he rains invective on them and says it is none of their business. Knights who back down from this must roll against their **Proud** Trait, losing 1 point of Honor if they succeed.

If a Player-knight attempts to stop Sir Agravaine physically, he draws his sword and prepares to fight unless he sees clearly he is outnumbered. (Player-knights who draw steel first should check Reckless for potentially starting a fight in the middle of a crowd.) If combat does ensue, Sir Agravaine yields if he is in danger of being beaten; otherwise, he does his best to kill the Player-knight(s). (Sir Agravaine is without his shield and helmet; assume the Player-knight has their shield but is similarly unhelmeted.)

If a Player-knight challenges him, he sizes up the challenger based on their **SIZ**, Distinctive Features, quality of armor, and so on. If he thinks he can beat them, he accepts. Otherwise, he begs off, saying he is fighting tomorrow and does not want to be injured. Should a challenge ensue, Sir Agravaine opts for lances on horseback. If he is unhorsed, he yields. If he unhorses the challenger, he stays on his mount and tries to run his opponent through.

“CAN WE KILL AN ARTHURIAN CHARACTER?”

As with any “canonical” figure, the Gamemaster must exercise some discretion in the fate of Sir Agravaine. If he is about to be slain, let Friar

Coombs intervene or have some powerful lord like King Leodegrance come riding along; he blusters about knights brawling on the King's Road and demands everyone clear off and save their feuds for the tournament. You can save a Player-knight in the same manner if you wish. This encounter is not designed to kill Player-knights—only to give them an enemy worth thinking about. Sir Agravaine is a bully at heart and backs down quickly if he thinks he has met his match.

If a Player-knight goes so far as to not only stop the beating but also tend to the beaten peasants, they deserve a **Merciful** check if they have not already received one. Likewise, if the Player-knights replace the fallen ox with one bought from the Irish lord (who will sell them one for 150 d. to match their generosity), they should receive a **Generous** check. Such actions bring nothing but contempt from Agravaine but gain the notice of any intervening lord and the respect of Friar Coombs and Diarmuid.

Part I: King Arthur's Court

After the incident on the road, the Player-knights proceed unobstructed to the Royal Residence—their first duty is to present themselves at court. As they ride into view of the great palace, they are greeted by a spectacle of color and glory unmatched anywhere in Britain. Silken pavilions are everywhere, flying the pennants of kings, nobles, and knights from every corner of the realm and foreign lands beyond. Comely dames and damsels stroll hither and yon on the arms of noble knights. Eager squires rush back and forth with equipment amidst crowds of jugglers, mimes, minstrels, acrobats, peddlers, fortune tellers, and general on-lookers. Beyond rise the stately edifice of the old Roman amphitheater, Carlion's mighty walls, and, over all else, the Giants' Tower.

The reaction of the common crowd thronging around them may be modified by the Player-knights' actions on the road. If they earned the respect of Diarmuid, they may notice some peasants pointing them out to others with a look of respect. Caps are doffed, and a path is cleared as a token of the knights' actions. If they

Why is Kay Always Such a Jerk?

Truth be told, he is not. Sir Kay is King Arthur's half-brother and is often presented as a loud, boorish bully in the Arthurian cycle. Yet Kay is a complicated figure whose churlishness is found in some chronicles and not in others. He wildly fluctuates between being Guenever's champion in the *Vulgate* and taking on two of the five kings who attack Arthur in Malory and killing Arthur's bastard son Borre in the *Vulgate Merlin*. Here are three possible motivations for Kay's "bullying" behavior:

- ✦ **He is a jerk:** While this is the simplest option, it can be unsatisfying to have one of the central figures of the Arthurian cycle merely turn out to be so one-dimensional.
- ✦ **He is jealous:** Kay almost becomes king when Arthur hands him Clarent. T. H. White has him jealous of Arthur's teacher, Merlin. Likewise, there is a strong tradition of Kay being devoted to Guenever—perhaps his passion for her eats at him. In any case, he is constantly aware of his lost opportunities.

- ✦ **It is his job:** The laws of hospitality prohibit a host from directly confronting a guest to test their worth or gain valuable information. This requires someone at court to do the lord's dirty work or at least play devil's advocate. Wolfram von Eschenbach identifies this as Kay's role in chapter six of *Parzival* specifically to refute the charge that Kay "had the manners of a ruffian." In *Beowulf*, Unferth plays this role in section eight when he challenges Beowulf's boasts and tales of valor. In addition to determining the relative worth of guests, it allows a lord to take the measure of the young—whether they be knights new to court or pages and squires who hope to become knights. This would explain his pride in Gareth "Beaumains," whom Kay refers to as "my boy of the kitchen." Arthur needs someone he can trust for this sensitive job, someone whom he can anticipate and who can anticipate his needs as well. Who better for the role than his foster brother, the man with whom he spent his entire youth?

have earned Friar Coombs' respect, a similar reaction may be noted among the lower orders of the clergy later that day.

As the Player-knights ride onto the tournament grounds and approach the gates to the palace, the going becomes more difficult. Crowds throng the narrow lanes between tents and stalls, cheering, laughing, and singing along with strolling minstrels. Rich fragrances waft in the air—the mouth-watering scent of roasting meat, the imported perfume of courtly ladies, the heady scent of ale and mead.

The Player-knights continue to ride slowly through the throng, perhaps being greeted by old friends who have come for the tournament. Dark looks may be exchanged with any rivals who also have come for the tournament. As they enter the palatial courtyard, the cheering

grows louder still, and the way becomes thoroughly congested, forcing the knights to stop for the moment. Looking up, the knights see the majestic figures of King Arthur and Queen Guenever waving to the happy crowd from a balcony of the residence proper. Such a sight should spur great response in the Player-knights, particularly any who have a Loyalty (King) Passion. Encourage appropriate cheers: "Hail Arthur Pendragon!"; "Long live the queen!"; etc. Player-knights who did not have an opportunity to generate an Adoration Passion for the Queen in 513 must attempt to do so now (see p. 10).

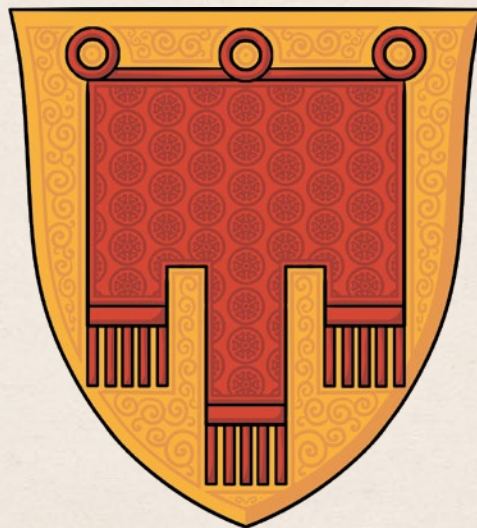
As the royal couple and their retainers retire into the palace, Sir Constantine, son of the famous Sir Cador of Cornwall, receives them. Sir Constantine is courteous but efficient in his

dealings with the Player-knights and informs them that they, along with many others, are to be presented to the king at a feast tonight, to be held at the Giants' Tower. Knights of sufficient standing may request the king's hospitality, but Sir Constantine explains there is no further room at the Royal Residence; they may be given lodging at the Mayoral Palace in the city proper and may display their shields there. Player-knights staying in inns are reminded to display their shields or heraldry at the windows of the inn. They are further informed that the Master of the Lists may be found at the Old Coliseum, nearby.

As the Player-knights prepare to depart the Royal Residence, they are held up as a line of servants wends its way through the tumultuous crowd, carrying huge platters of food. The line is led by Sir Kay and Sir Bedivere. Sir Kay is ranting and railing as he tries to carry out his duties, loudly complaining to Bedivere about the difficulties presented by the throng.

An Encounter With Sir Kay

Just after Sir Kay and Sir Bedivere pass the Player-knights, a large wolfhound breaks away from its owner, harrying the horses of the Player-knights. Already skittish because of the crowds and unfamiliar smells of the city, the horses rear and carry on.



Sir Bedivere

If the Player-knights are feeling exhausted from all the chaos and crowds by this point, you are doing a good job of conveying the general atmosphere of this massive tourney!

Call for **Horsemanship** rolls. Success means the rider calms their horse. Any knight who fails this roll is thrown as their horse bucks violently (taking 1D6 damage on a fumble), crashing down right in the midst of the servants, who in turn knock down Sir Kay. Should all the knights be lucky enough to make their rolls, the general chaos caused by the rearing horses causes a similar disruption. In any case, the result is Sir Kay is dumped onto his duff and splattered with food, as wolfhound and owner beat a hasty retreat.

As Sir Kay tries to rise, the Player-knights can make **Recognize** rolls with a +8 bonus to realize who he is. Knights can make a second roll (with the same bonus) to name Sir Bedivere as he helps a spluttering Kay rise to his feet. Before the Player-knights can beat an advisable retreat, the outraged seneschal confronts them and immediately treats them to a bitter tongue-lashing:

"Fools! Dolts! Bumpkins! Is there no knight left who can sit a horse?" Player-knights must roll **Station**, losing 1 point of Honor if they succeed. As his diatribe continues (make it as personal as you wish), let the Players react as they see fit, but remind them that the crowd is watching. (**Awareness:** They spot Diarmuid's familiar face in the crowd.) Should they try to apologize (assuming they are at fault), Kay rails at them all the harder: "Seek not to sway me with these honeyed words, knaves! A good turn or two on the wheel is the least you deserve for this insult!" Should they protest it was not their fault, he comes back with, "By St. Michael, is there no limit to your churlish behavior? I've a good mind to thrash you all bloody!" Should they take offense at his blustering, he retorts with, "Beware your tongue, or I shall sharpen my sword 'pon it this very hour."

Sir Gawaine Intervenes

Sir Bedivere now tries to intercede for the Player-knights, but Kay rants on that he wants all their names; he will not have ill-bred louts like these mucking up the king's tournament. Before things get completely out of hand, a robust



Sir Gawaine

laugh causes Kay to turn. Into the fray rides a tall, red-haired man with a disarming smile.

“By St. George, this is a pretty sight! A new dish: Seneschal in sauce with meat tiles! You’ve made my day, good knights!” **Recognize +5** tells them this is Sir Gawaine. Their eyes show him to be in fine humor, obviously enjoying Kay’s discomfort. Bedivere steps in again as Kay burns at this new humiliation and is, in his turn, treated to more of Kay’s abuse.

While Kay is thus occupied, Gawaine quickly introduces himself to the Player-knights and suggests they all proceed apace to the Master of the Lists before Sir Kay turns on them again. He wheels his horse about and gestures for them to follow. Assuming they do, Gawaine informs them as they ride that he saw the whole incident and knows it was merely an accident. He would not want such staunch knights kept out of the tournament by such a trifle, which is why he intervened. Besides, he admits, he thoroughly enjoyed it. Should any Player-knight not have the good sense to follow Gawaine, they are definitely in for more of Kay’s ranting, possibly to the point of a challenge.

Sir Gawaine continues to chat amiably as they make their way to the lists—as long as none of the Player-knights are dumb enough to mention Agravaine in a disparaging manner. Gawaine is not all that enamored of his brother, but Agravaine is family, and any negative remark

prompts a **Love (Family)** roll (see Gawaine’s Statistics on *Table 1.1: Tournament Rivals*). If successful, Gawaine challenges the speaker on the spot, demanding immediate satisfaction. You may wish to allow a **Courtesy** or **Prudent/Reckless** roll to forestall any ill-advised words prior to such unpleasant developments, as Sir Gawaine is famous for his blind devotion to his family.

Player-knights can bring up the encounter if they handle it in a tactful manner (e.g., “I fear my meeting with your kinsman was not as pleasant as my meeting with you, good sir.”). Gawaine knows his brother’s proclivities and can be objective if Agravaine is not attacked in a way that insults the Orkneys. Ideally, by the time they reach their destination, Gawaine and the Player-knights will have something of a friendly relationship. If the Player-knights really impressed him with their discourse (an **Orate** roll may see if this is the case), he asks them to join his team in the Grand Melee if they are not already **Queen’s Knights**.

After entering his name with the Master of the Lists, who sits at a small booth built within sight of the famous Round Table inside the Coliseum, Gawaine bids the Player-knights farewell; he must attend the king. They are then free to seek lodging in the city or pitch their tents in the fields. Follow the Players’ lead, giving them the opportunity to do what they wish before the grand feast.

A GRAND FEAST

This section contains a series of “atmosphere” pieces and courtly encounters. They are designed to provide characters with a feel for courtly life and provide some interesting plot complications. You need not resolve these encounters in any specific order, but rather strive to include all of them in the natural flow of events. If you have access to the “**Feast**” rules in the **Pendragon Gamemaster’s Handbook**, you may use them in concert with the following encounters in lieu of, or in addition to, the events presented in those rules.

The Player-knights should all be present for the grand feast held at court. Prior to the beginning of the feast, the visiting knights are

There are many Gamemaster characters introduced in this part of the adventure. You may find it useful to prepare cards, graphics, or similar aides memoire to help everyone keep track.

α Regal Feast

Favorite Dishes: Dressed Swan in Chaudron Sauce (an entire roasted swan, presented garlanded and crowned, with its wings spread as if in flight. Its neck is arched backward, and head is erect. The chaudron sauce is made from the swan's own guts, cut small and boiled in broth, blood, and vinegar with strong spices, and served hot). A dessert course of wild strawberries in almond cream.

Best Entertainment: Acrobatic fire-eaters from far-distant India perform many astounding feats of contortion and mind-over-matter.

presented to the High King and Queen. This encounter should be brief—the announcement of the Player-knight's name and titles and the name and titles of their liege lord(s). Arthur and Guenever welcome the knight to their court and wish them well at the tournament. The knight is then excused to mingle with the other gentry present. Sir Kay, although on the lookout for the knights who embarrassed him earlier, is not at the presentation, as he is attending to his duties.

The High Table

Despite the lack of a few dishes (those that wound up on Sir Kay...), the feast is sumptuous. The guests include a dazzling array of prominent figures. At the High Table, Bishop Bedwin discusses theology with his cousin, Sir Baudwin, Constable of Britain (the family resemblance between the two is quite remarkable), while King Pellinore entertains Guenever with his rendition of the call of the Questing Beast. At Arthur's side is Lady Achefflour, surveying the hall and commenting on likely prospects—somewhere in here sits her future husband, after all. Nearby, Merlin the Magician is having an intense conversation with young Nimue, the Maiden of the Lake abducted by Sir Hontzlake last year. She listens idly, but the knight

who makes the best successful **Awareness** roll catches her eye. She smiles in recognition, but her thoughts are clearly elsewhere.

Also, at the High Table is another of the king's half-siblings, Queen Morgan le Fay, dressed in a gorgeous gown of blue silk, her long dark tresses braided with gold ribbon. She seems very content this evening as she makes conversation with her companions, a handsome knight by the name of Sir Guiomar (the queen's cousin) and Lady Elavane, daughter of the King of Amans. Recognize rolls are not necessary, as “everyone knows everyone” at the High Table (and a knight need only ask about the identity of so-and-so), but successful **Intrigue** rolls reveal the following (one item per success, in order):

- ✱ Queen Morgan is rumored to be a sorceress of great power
- ✱ Lady Elavane and Queen Morgan are known friends, often visiting each other's halls
- ✱ Sir Guiomar is Morgan's latest lover, utterly under her sway
- ✱ The King of Amans plots against King Arthur and may have covertly aided King Ryons in his invasion of Came-liard last year

Should Player-knights mention the last rumor during the feast, they are overheard by people loyal to Lady Elavane, and the information is passed on to her, along with the names of the knights.

Player-knights who wish to know more about Lady Elavane may make another **Intrigue** roll. With a success, they learn she was close friends with Lady de Vawse, the lover of the late King Ryons.

An Encounter With the Orkney Clan

Sometime during the feast, the knights see Sir Gawaine chatting with his mother, the august Queen Margawse. Presently, Sir Agravaire comes up to Gawaine and speaks to him and Margawse. The Player-knights then see all three look in their direction. If not all the Player-knights were part of the encounter with Agravaire, they look at only those who were.

Most of your Players will have at least heard of Morgan, and it is only natural for them to feel suspicious towards her. Let them, for it draws attention away from Lady Elavane for the time being.



If the Player-knights avoid approaching the trio at this point, Gawaine or Margawse may speak to them in private about the incident on the road sometime later in the feast, simply to get their side of the story. If a Player-knight should be so bold as to stride up to them and make some to-do about Agravaine's behavior on the road, they find themselves quickly challenged by Gawaine. If the Player-knight makes a **Courtesy** roll (or role-plays appropriately), they manage to broach the subject in a way not insulting to Gawaine or his regal mother. A failure means insulting them all. This same roll comes into play if Gawaine or Margawse speaks to the Player-knights later in the feast.

Agravaine himself is very rude to any Player-knight who approaches, counting on the presence of his illustrious family to keep them in check. Any Player-knight who keeps their cool and is not provoked by the insulting young knight gets an automatic check to Modest. Such a knight also earns Gawaine's admiration. A knight who is provoked and reacts gets an automatic Proud check and is again likely to receive a challenge by Gawaine. If Agravaine fails to get his brother to challenge the Player-knights, he stalks off to drown his frustrations in wine.

Sir Kay (Again)

As the feast progresses, the Player-knights see Sir Kay and Sir Bedivere playing about their duties. Those involved in the incident with Sir Kay do well to avoid him. This is played out as an opposed **Awareness** roll against Kay's Skill of 10. If Kay succeeds in besting one or more of the Player-knights' rolls, he spots and confronts them. The knights may opt not to avoid him, in which case Kay needs merely to make an unopposed **Awareness** roll. Make such rolls three or four times during the feast to keep Player-knights sweating. If a confrontation takes place, it is in the form of a tongue-lashing in front of the whole court, automatically costing the Player-knight 1 point of Honor unless they immediately challenge Sir Kay. If so challenged, Kay sulkily retracts his statements.

There is another way out of this difficulty if the Player-knights remain in Gawaine's good

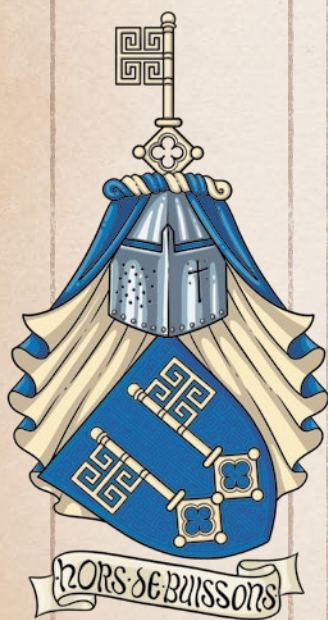
graces: He sees the confrontation starting and intervenes with King Arthur. Gawaine's tale of Kay's splattering visibly amuses Arthur, and he tells Kay to stop harassing the knights. Arthur does not publicly restrain Kay, however (and the Player-knights may still lose Honor as described above). Instead, he sends a page to tell Kay the king wishes to see him immediately. Word of Arthur's intervention spreads, however, and the knights gain 50 Glory. Make certain the Players know it is Gawaine who is responsible for their rescue. Once a confrontation with Kay takes place, make no further Awareness rolls.

Do You Feel Like You're Being Watched?

Diarmuid is also at the feast. If the Player-knights wish to speak with him, they may oppose their **Courtesy** against his **Awareness** of 15. They have four chances over the course of the feast to win an opposed roll, and only one Player-knight may try in any of the given chances. Be creative with introducing obstacles—a critical failure is certain to mean an encounter with Kay or Agravaine. A simple loss may generate other encounters that can be overcome by skills like **Flirting** or **Orate** (again, the Gamemaster may find inspiration in the “**Feast**” rules in the **Pendragon Game-master’s Handbook**, if they have access to them). These rolls, however, are primarily intended to generate memorable role-playing moments with other guests, not to corner Diarmuid and force an encounter with him. Should a Player-knight track down Diarmuid, he criticizes his final **Awareness** roll and slips away as a group of ladies passes between him and the knights.

If a Player-knight declares they are keeping an eye on Diarmuid and succeeds at an **Awareness** roll, they get some food for thought: At some point in the feast, they see Diarmuid bow and speak briefly with both Nimue and Merlin. Later, ask the Player-knight to make another **Awareness** roll with a bonus of +5. With a success, the knight turns and locks eyes with Merlin or Nimue (Gamemaster's choice), who is scrutinizing them from across the room. Tell the Player they feel how they would imagine a mouse does

*Sir Agravaine
makes for an
excellent recurring
foil or villain in
the years ahead...*



when spotted by a hawk or an owl. The sounds of the feast fade, and they feel distanced from the events around them. After three seconds of this, the watcher blinks slowly, and the feeling disappears as they turn to another guest and return to their conversation. Should the knight continue to look, they are ignored. Should they occasionally glance at the magicians (who do not remain in one place), an hour or so later, the one who did not initially stare at the knight will give a friendly, if distant, nod to the Player-knight.

Should any Player-knight approach either figure, what occurs next depends on the nature of their approach. Should a knight ask about Diarmuid both admit to knowing him and agree to introduce the Player-knight to the bard, should the opportunity arise. (Diarmuid has already left the feast, so it will not happen tonight.) Should the Player-knight think to ask about the look they received, they must succeed at a **Valorous** roll at -5 , followed by a successful **Reckless** roll to do so. When queried, the magician innocently states they were simply interested in the type of knight who was willing to help a peasant on the road.

A Bit of Conversation

The next incident takes place as the Player-knights are seated at a table. They overhear two knights discussing Sir Balin, the Knight of Two

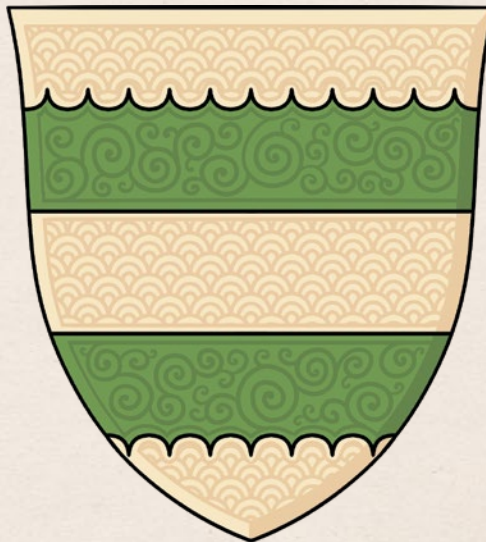
Swords. The first, Sir Cynwal the Strong, is saying one of his kinsmen recently visited the land laid waste by Balin's "Dolorous Stroke" and found it a most fell place, populated by monsters and demons too awful to mention. Cynwal contends Arthur's banishment of Balin was wrong and, had he not taken the action, the foul Wastelands would not now exist. The second knight, Sir Graid of Lyndsey, replies that the King was right to banish Sir Balin, and it was Balin's own lack of chivalry that was responsible for the Wastelands. Both knights turn to the Player-knights and ask their opinion—was the king right or wrong to banish Balin?

All Player-knights present should have the opportunity to answer before resolving their responses overall. Let them read the "May Babies" handout from **Appendix B**; allow Trait or Passion rolls and award checks based on responses. If a knight says the king was right, they are challenged the next day by Sir Cynwal. If they say the king was wrong, they are challenged by Sir Graid for what he considers disloyalty to the king. Neither challenge is made tonight; they are announced at the tournament.

If a Player-knight wisely declares they cannot reply on such a delicate matter without direct knowledge of the circumstances or will



Sir Cynwal



Sir Graid

Rivalries and Love Triangles

Ariette's subplot offers the chance to introduce some fun romance and possibly a deadly rivalry into your game, which may, in turn, result in many years of interpersonal intrigue and schemes!

If the Player-knights earned the ire of King Pellinore last year, Sir Tor (one of Pellinore's many bastard offspring) now also carries the grudge. At a minimum, this should be a Directed Suspicious Trait towards the Player-knights, and possibly a Hate Passion, depending on their actions last year. Tor's rivalry for the attention of Ariette may also spark a Hate Passion, regardless of prior events, if the Player-knight humiliates him or otherwise behaves loutishly, either towards Sir Tor or the young maid.

Sir Tor is susceptible to flirtations from any women Player-knights who wish to engage with him, quickly developing a sort of jocular and friendly rivalry to cover his piqued romantic interest. This may be sufficient, if played well, to make him forget any animosity towards other Player-knights, and possibly abandon his designs on Ariette.

As noted in the main body of the text, Sir Sagamore is mostly immune to Ariette's considerable charms. He *is* interested, however, in any male knight with an APP of 15 or better. Whether or not the Player-knight wishes

to return this attention is, of course, up to the individual, but regardless, this inspires Ariette's jealousy towards the Player-knight! She plays Sir Tor or others against the hapless Player-knight just as readily.

(And needless to say, if there are any high-APP women-knights disguised as men among the group, the possibilities for a romantic farce of Shakespearean proportions are left to the Gamemaster's imagination...)

Lastly, a word on Ariette: It is left to the Gamemaster's discretion in determining her true motivations.

Perhaps, under the influence of her mistress Queen Guenever's emerging philosophy of courtly love, she is merely playing a game, enjoying the experience of pitting knights against each other in a relatively safe, low-consequence environment. In this case, her ire comes more from a feeling of frustration that "her" knights are "not playing the game correctly." Or she may be genuinely smitten in the manner of young folk everywhere, across history—a true case of puppy love. Finally, in a reflection of the tournament's "grand prize," she may herself be looking for good husband material by testing the various knights against each other. Whatever motivation you decide on will have some repercussions at the conclusion of the scenario.

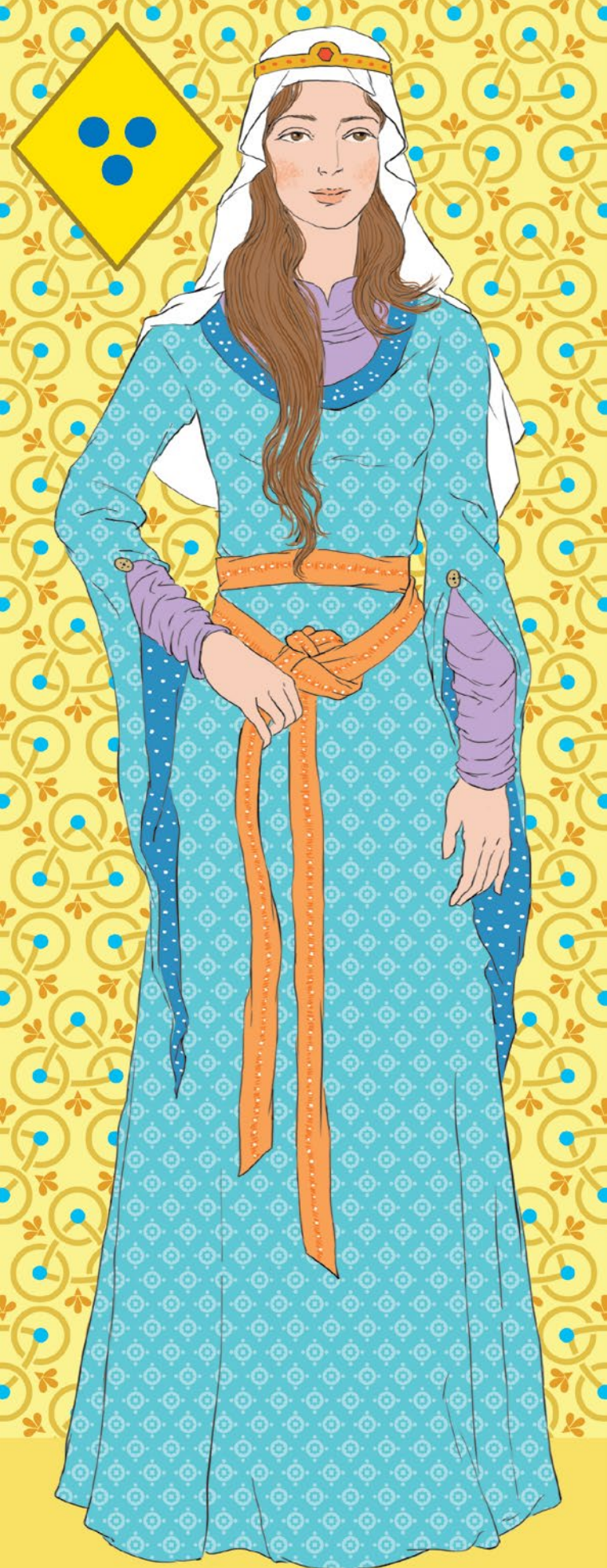
not speak on the king's actions while at the king's table, they get an automatic Courtesy check and Glory as both Cynwal, Graid, and others listening recognize the knight's wisdom. (Roll **Courtesy** or **Prudent**. Success grants Glory equal to five times the final value of the roll. Failure means only 10 Glory.)

A Flirtation

The final encounter at the feast involves a beautiful maid-in-waiting of Queen Guenever's court by the name of Ariette de la Belle Sourire. Ariette is smitten with Sir Sagamore le Desirous, a newly arrived knight from

the East. In turn, Sir Tor is passing fond of Ariette and intends to impress her in tomorrow's challenges.

Ariette is flirtatious and has a plan to inspire the ardor of Sir Sagamore, who, almost completely unaffected by her charms (see the nearby sidebar), is too cool for her taste. She approaches the Player-knights, flashing her gorgeous smile and introducing herself; being, in general, alluring. All Player-knights inclined to find her desirable should make a **Chaste/Lustful** Trait Decision roll. With a Lustful success, the knight is swayed by her charms. Knights who wish to remain faithful to their



Ariette



Sir Tor

Chapter 3: The Grey Knight



Sir Sagramore

spouses, lovers, or amors may modify their **Chaste** roll with an appropriate Passion first.

Swayed knights then can use whatever Skills they like to impress Ariette. Good choices are **Courtesy**, **Dancing**, **Orate**, **Play Instrument**, and **Singing**. Player-knights choosing the same Skill must make opposed resolutions to see who impresses her the most. If several knights make equal impressions (e.g., one might impress her with **Dancing** and **Play Instrument** while another might use **Courtesy** and **Orate**), the knight with the highest APP wins her favor. If APP does not break the tie, make an opposed resolution of the knights' APP values.

Once one of the Player-knights outstrips their comrades in impressing the maid, Ariette asks that knight to wear her favor (a white silken hair band) in the Grand Melee tomorrow. Should the knight demur, she asks the same thing of the next runner-up. When a knight does accept, she makes a great show of appreciation, making sure to catch the attention of Sir Sagramore, who is watching anyway. Sir Tor also notices. The result is challenges from both Tor and Sagramore the next morning. In short, the knight was suckered by the romantic plotting of Ariette.

The swayed knight involved in this challenge should generate an Adoration Passion for Ariette with a value of 1D6+4 (or 1D6+9 if their **Lustful** roll was a critical success).

Other Possible Events

Not every Player-knight needs to be involved in the above events. In fact, it is better to distribute the incidents amongst the Player-knights. Other encounters with notable figures may be added at the discretion of the Gamemaster or determined by the interests of the Players. Indeed, short of Arthur and Guenever, the Player-knights should be free to mingle with all the guests. A dance with Morgan le Fay might provide a knight with a moment's diversion, as might a game of Roman Tabula with Nimue—just be certain not to make Merlin jealous! In short, allow the Players to feel they are a part of the wonder of Arthur's Court.

Tournament Day

After a good night's rest, the Player-knights get ready for the great tourney. (For more details on tournaments, consult the **Pendragon Starter Set** or *Gamemaster's Handbook*.) Mass is held at Llantarnam in the early morning. Christian knights who do not wish to attend must roll **Religion** against **Lazy**. Success at the former means they go; a **Lazy** success allows them the luxury of sleeping in. Non-Christian knights are free to do as they will. Knights who do attend Mass and make an **Awareness** roll spot Friar Coombs there. They may speak with him when Mass is over, and he is more than happy to speak to anyone who aided the peasant on the road, spurning those who did not.

Challenges

As the knights assemble on Table Field in the shadow of the Coliseum, the Herald announces the challenges to be fought before the melee commences later this afternoon. Any challenges issued to the knights during the Grand Feast are made known. This might include a challenge by Sir Gawaine (a joust and sword on horseback), by Sir Tor and Sir Sagramore upon Ariette's favored knight (joust only), by Sir Graid and/or Sir Cynwal (sword on foot to first blood), and by Sir Kay to someone involved in the food-splattering incident (joust only).

Let the precise details of the tournament fade into the background, and keep the focus on the individual activities of the Player-knights. Just like in S10, this tournament is due for an interruption, anyway.

For an example of how a chivalrous challenge is expected to play out, see “**The Guardian of Olbray**” on p. 47.

In addition, if any Player-knights made their own challenges (e.g., to Sir Agravaine), these are also made public. All these challenges are by name (“Sir Gawaine challenges Sir So-and-So to a joust and sword on horseback!”). Player-knights may reject a challenge with the usual penalty of a Cowardice check, a loss of 1 point of Honor, and the creation of rumor and scandal. These penalties may be reduced or eliminated based on circumstances. For example, a wounded knight has grounds for delaying or refusing a challenge with no loss of Honor. Going through with the challenge, however, may earn the knight additional Glory. Well-known oaths are another example of a case where consideration is warranted.

There is no shame attached to being unhorsed by the young Sir Gawaine or Sir Sagamore—indeed, many consider it an honor, as these youths are making names for themselves already. Besides, the knight could win and earn the Glory that comes from such a feat. If a Player-knight bests any of the knights from *Table 1.1: Tournament Rivals*, it could have repercussions in the future. If Agravaine is defeated in a challenge, he bears a grudge and learns to Hate (1D6+6) the knight.

Have Player-knights commended by King Arthur himself should they win a challenge against Sagamore. Indicate Merlin is watching their deeds with interest. Have Morgan smile prettily at a Player-knight who has done well, or let Gawaine congratulate a Player-knight who put up a good fight only to go down to defeat.



Chapter 3: The Grey Knight

Ariette's Challenge

Most of the challenges are conditional, dependent on what actions the Player-knights took previously. The only one that definitely happens is the one engineered by Ariette. During the challenge (the Gamemaster determines which of the two knights fights the Player-knight first), the Player-knight (and their opponent, if applicable) should make **Adoration** Passion rolls for Inspiration. Ariette is very visible in the stands and continues to play up to the Player-knight to make Sagamore jealous (to little end). Tor's challenge is a surprise to her, but she revels in it and pays him some attention, too. If the Player-knight defeats Sagamore, Ariette rushes to the foreign knight, cradling him in her arms and railing against the Player-knight for harming her beloved. If the Player-knight or Sir Tor is defeated, they get no such comfort. (If Sir Tor harbors a grudge towards the Player-knight, he blames them for Ariette's seeming lack of interest, saying they have stolen her away from him.)

Optional Melee

The challenges continue until noon. At that time, the assembly of knights gets ready for the first day of the Grand Melee, shaking out into rival teams. This is to be a mock battle, with each team representing a rival "army." The goal is to capture as many rival knights as possible, scoring points for doing so. The knight who scores the most points is declared winner of the tournament!

The theme of this melee is Youth and Beauty Against Age and Wisdom. Old campaigners like King Leodegrance, Duke Ulfus, Sir Brastias, King Pellinore, Sir Cador, Dame Aspara, and Arthur's foster father, Sir Ector, lead the latter team, while the younger team is led by members of the Queen's Knights: Sir Gawaine, Sir Kay, Sir Griflet, Sir Dodinas le Sauvage, and so on. The Player-knights are most likely on this team!

THE COMING OF THE GREY KNIGHT

The watching crowd buzzes with excitement as hundreds of knights prepare to meet in mock battle. Cheers echo off the walls of Carlion as knights ride up and down the huge grandstands, beaming and showing off, sunlight glinting off their armor. Pennants snap crisply in the warm breeze blowing toward the river and out to sea.

A clap of thunder unexpectedly rolls across the field, reverberating like a thousand drums and silencing the crowd. Nary a bird sings in the sudden silence. The breeze dies, leaving the suddenly-heavy air stagnant. Billowing upriver, a thick, bone-white mist rolls toward Carlion. Washing quickly over the walls of the Royal Residence, it abruptly ends at the far side of the field. Wispy tendrils snake across the edge of the field, threatening to encroach around the city. The sky seems to lose its luster and, once clear and pleasant, now seems frighteningly empty. A chill descends upon the crowd.

A strange, misshapen shadow appears in the gloom. As it rides onto the field, all can see it is a bearded dwarf riding a thin donkey. Slowly,

TABLE 1.1: TOURNAMENT RIVALS

KNIGHT	SWORD SKILL	DAMAGE	CHARGE SKILL	CHARGE DAMAGE	DEX	ARMOR	KD	HP	PASSION
Sir Gawaine	17	5 to 8D6*	18	6D6	18	12 + shield	16	36	Love (Family) 16
Sir Agravaine	13	5D6	15	6D6	14	11 + shield	12	28	None
Sir Tor	15	5D6	15	5D6	15	10 + shield	14	32	Adoration (Ariette) 12
Sir Sagamore	18	6D6	15	7D6	13	11 + shield	13	30	Honor 18
Sir Kay	15	4D6	18	6D6	13	12 + shield	14	32	Adoration (Guenever) 18
Sir Cynwal	14	5D6	17	5D6	13	10 + shield	18	34	Loyalty (Arthur) 13
Sir Graid	16	5D6	15	5D6	14	10 + shield	12	27	Loyalty (Arthur) 15

* Sir Gawain's strength increases until noon, then decreases: Before 7 AM = 5D6; 7 AM–9 AM = 6D6; 9 AM–11 AM = 7D6; 11 AM–1 PM = 8D6; 1 PM–3 PM = 7D6; 3 PM – 5 PM = 6D6; After 5 PM = 5D6.



the dwarf's mount clops to the center of the field. Lifting an iron horn to his lips, he blows one discordant note.

The dwarf cries in a cragged voice: "Notable lords and gracious ladies, attend now upon my mistress and her champion!" At his word, two more shadows swirl out of the mist. The first is a woman seated upon a palfrey as black as midnight. She is clad in mourning garb, a black veil hiding her face. Behind her is a knight wearing a hauberk of lusterless grey links. His face is masked by a hideous helm in the shape of a grinning death's head. The shield he carries likewise bears a skull. His cloak and tabard, although thick, flutter as if made of spider web or some other diaphanous material. He is a giant of a man and rides an enormous charger cloaked in the same grey material as his tabard and cloak. Wisps of the fog swirl around him and seem to rise from the ground before him as he rides. The charnel smell that hangs about him is apparent even from this distance. Worst of all, he makes no sound as he follows his lady forward.

The knight stops where the dwarf has reined in his donkey while the lady continues forward to where the king and queen stand in their viewing box. She stops her palfrey and draws back her veil. All can see in an instant the lady was once beautiful. Lines etched by some dark and terrible inner turmoil now taint that beauty. Her baleful gaze fixes upon Arthur, who seems to shiver. Guenever slips her arm into her husband's, equally affected by this woman's stare. The lady's voice rings in the gloom—deep, dark, and foreboding, yet as clear as a bell. Player-knights who were present at the fight with King Ryons in 513 recognize it immediately: It is the face of none other than King Ryon's lover, Lady de Vawse!

"Arthur Pendragon, Killer of Babies: I accuse you in the name of all those innocents you have so foully slain!" There is an immediate gasp from all who are watching, and the king seems about to swoon. Guenever clasps Arthur's arm in support as Gawaine's hand flies to his sword. As the queen responds, her rich voice steady and poised, his hand slowly returns to his side.

"Good lady, your words are passing harsh. Why do you accuse my husband, the king so, whose chivalry is unmatched in all the realm?"

The Lady in Black sneers, her beauty suffering the more for it. "Is it chivalry, then, which on May Day three years past put to death the newborn sons of Lothian? Such chivalry I spit upon!"

It is now more than clear the lady is referring to the May Babies Incident. Quickly poll the Players for their reactions to that incident, as it is described in the handout found in **Appendix B**. The information is commonly known but should be presented to the Player-knights through the lenses of their backgrounds. For example, knights from Lothian *know* Arthur is responsible, while those from Logres feel the accusations must be rumors. Those who think Arthur should be forgiven receive a Forgiveness check; those who do not receive a Vengeful check.

The Lady in Black continues: "You are not fit to rule this gleaming isle, Arthur. It is my intent to make proof of this. Here stands my champion." The lady points to the Grey Knight, who immediately draws his sword, as lusterless as his armor, and nudges his horse to a trot. He rides to the stand and, with two mighty swipes, cuts through the stout poles bearing the standards of the Pendragon and the Kingdom of Escavalon, sending them crashing to the earth amidst the gasps of the court. The Grey Knight



The Grey Knight

Keep track of the passage of days as the Player-knights pursue their quest. A running tally is kept in the margins to help with this.

sheathes his sword and rides back, taking up a position next to his lady. She speaks again.

"I herewith challenge your court and your rule, Arthur Pendragon. Forty-two days hence, on the Feast of Pentecost, let the death of your champion at the hands of mine prove to all that your soul is condemned and your honor is a sham. If any of this company dare to champion a slayer of babies, that is."

A profound silence now falls upon the field. Have Player-knights make **Awareness** rolls. Any who succeed get a check and notice Morgan Le Fay, alone of the King's company, wears a sly smile. A critical success spots Lady Elavane behind her and in the shadows, watching intently, biting her lower lip as if in anticipation. As the Grey Knight sits on his horse, immobile, the king's knights look fearfully at each other. Arthur scans them, hopeful yet also afraid.

Have Player-knights who received a Forgiveness check earlier now make a **Valorous** Test roll at -10 to see if any of them step forward to champion the king. This roll is required to accept the challenge—the Grey Knight is a terrible sight. Anyone who does so receives a check as they move forward. They notice they are among a small handful of knights present who do so, earning them Glory equal to their unmodified Valorous Trait. Before they have the chance to speak, however, a familiar voice rings out:

"I accept this challenge in the name of my king and good uncle, Arthur Pendragon. Let my sword cleanse his name forever of this vile accusation!" It is, of course, Sir Gawaine who throws his mailed gauntlet down before the Lady in Black even as the king cries out, "Gawaine, no!"

The dwarf immediately scrambles off his donkey, retrieves the gauntlet, and hands it to his mistress. She looks at it, and a terrible smile crosses her face.

"So be it. We shall return at this same hour on the Pentecost. May Jesu have mercy upon your soul, young knight."

The dwarf lifts the iron horn and blows another discordant note. This one echoes so strongly that all must clap their hands over their ears against the pain of it. As the note

⌘ Regal Feast

Favorite Dish: Venison medallions in wild mushroom sauce, served in pastries.

Best Entertainment: Diarmuid, who sings Deirdre's lament over the death of the Sons of Usna from the Táin Bó Cúlaighe (*The Cattle Raid of Cooley*).

rings and echoes back across the field, the dwarf, the Lady in Black, and the Grey Knight enter the mist and disappear. As the mist quickly retreats downriver, the day returns to the way it was: The sky is blue, bright, sunny, and clear. A warm breeze blows toward the ocean. The only hint that what has just happened is not some horrible nightmare is the unnatural silence that continues to hover over the lists. Of the strange trio, there is no sign. Yet, as the king and queen rush off with a most distraught Merlin, it is obvious what has taken place is all too real.

A SOMBER FEAST

After the Grey Knight's coming, the Player-knights have the whole evening to ruminate on the incident. There is a feast, but there is no merrymaking. King Arthur, Guenever, Gawaine, and Merlin are absent throughout, and the conversation is hushed and somber. Most of it centers on the Grey Knight and the Lady in Black.

Do the Player-knights share the identity of Lady de Vawse? If so, much gossip and speculation ensue.

The other thing they might learn is that Morgan le Fay has left the city along with her entourage (including Lady Elavane). This takes a successful **Intrigue** roll to discover. A critical roll reveals that Morgan's destination is Lady Elavane's estate at Hautdesert.

As everyone retires for the night, one last incident may occur: Did any of the Player-knights take the sword Marmiodoise after the events of 513? If so, they are approached by Merlin from out of the dark shadows on their way back to their lodgings.

“Hail, gracious knights! ‘Tis I, Merlin. For the good of Britain and the love of your king, you must entrust your marvelous blade to me.”

Turning over the sword immediately and without question earns a check to Trusting and 50 Glory. Otherwise, the Player-knight may opt for a **Trusting/Suspicious** Trait Decision roll. This may be modified by a **Loyalty (Pendragon)** Passion roll first, applied to the Trait of the Player-knight’s choice (depending on their opinion of Merlin). A pagan Player-knight might gain a +5 bonus to **Trusting**, as the request is coming from the Archdruid of Britain.

A success at Trusting means they hand over the sword after all. They earn 25 Glory but no check. A Suspicious success means refusal; no Glory is earned, and the Player-knight should generate a Directed Trait of Suspicious (Merlin) +1D6.

If the Player-knight holds onto Marmiodoise, they find that night they sleep more deeply than ever in their life, as does their squire and anyone else in their immediate vicinity. In the morning, the magic blade is gone...

A ROYAL PROCLAMATION

The next morning dawns bright and clear. There is a distinct air of tension as Christian Player-knights make their way to Mass. The faces of all those abroad are grim and concerned. As they enter the cathedral, the Player-knights see Arthur, Guenever, and Gawaine in the front pew. **Awareness** rolls show traces of a sleepless night upon their faces.

Most everyone the Player-knights have met or glimpsed thus far is at Mass, except for Merlin. Archbishop Dubricus officiates, and the Mass feels rushed. When it is over, the king, the queen, and Gawaine hurry away as Dubricus announces all knights are to proceed at once to the Coliseum for a royal proclamation. There is a general rush for the door. If you would like to lighten the tension a bit, have the Player-knights arrive there at the same time as Sir Kay and get jammed in with him (“By all the saints and holy martyrs! Am I forever to be plagued by you ninnies?”).

At the Coliseum field, the Player-knights see King Arthur and Sir Gawaine standing before

the Round Table. A successful **Awareness** roll spots a new sword hanging from Gawaine’s baldric: It is Marmiodoise! (If the Player-knights played no role in retrieving it, they know of it—and of its former owner—by reputation.)

King Arthur reads the following proclamation: “I, Arthur Pendragon, High King, and Dux Bellorum, do hereby challenge all knights loyal to my crown to set forth this day upon a great quest. Roam the lands of Britain and, before the feast of Pentecost, bring back to the Royal City of Carlion the Thirteen Treasures of Britain.”

A low buzz ripples through the crowd as Nimue steps forward and, in a melodious voice, sings an ancient lay about the Thirteen Treasures and their properties (see the handout in **Appendix B**).

At this point, the crowd begins to murmur again as glances are exchanged. Player-knights may want to shout questions to King Arthur.

If they do not, a Gamemaster character asks the following: “Why do you urge this quest, sire?”

Arthur answers: “Merlin says one of these relics will aid Sir Gawaine in the fight to come. Without it, his death is certain.”

There is another shout: “Cannot Merlin tell which of the treasures will aid Gawaine?” Arthur looks out among the knights. Suddenly, Merlin is seen there by all, astride a horse larger than any the knights have seen before. The large spots on its shaggy white coat seem to glow a golden color before they fade to a normal brown. As Merlin looks about him, his gaze seems to catch those of everyone on the field—everyone, in fact, in sight of him. Each Player-knight feels Merlin’s eyes on them alone, no matter how far away they are from him.

“Prophecy is a mysterious messenger, my good knights,” Merlin says. “It answers as it will. Arthur’s charge should be reason enough for any knight to ride forth—*without question*.” Merlin’s eyes visibly flash. Have Player-knights make their **Loyalty (Arthur)** rolls. Those that make them automatically shout they will ride on this quest. Those who fail, or who lack the Passion, do not succumb to Merlin’s enchantment and may choose to ride on this quest or not. (Those that choose not to, of course, will be Out of the Game

for the whole adventure...) While they may ask further questions, they are drowned out by the calls for squires and horses and other activities of knights preparing for the quest.

THE QUEST

The treasure needed to prevent Gawaine's death and save the honor of King Arthur and his reign is the Whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd. You may wish to outline the other quests so that you may recount their retrieval by other knights. Alternatively, you may list the retrieval of some and leave others hidden for later quests. Merlin will take all Treasures found with him when he disappears in §17.

The Player-knights may get more information from one of the following sources. Who approaches them depends on the Player-knights' actions thus far in the scenario. If they have ruined their chances with all three of the potential sources of information, they will have to rely on their own Skill rolls.

Friar Coombs' Advice

Friar Coombs comes to the knights to tell them they can discover where the treasure they seek lies by consulting the Queen of the Wastelands. Friar Coombs has been to the priory of the Queen, a very holy woman. She told him she was one day to guide a great quest, a quest that would be fulfilled by a very pious knight. Friar Coombs believes the knights' mercy on the road identifies them as such. The friar knows where the priory is and gives the Player-knights directions to get there. He cannot go with them, as his duties require him to stay in Carlion. He also warns them the Wastelands are a foul and dread place, cursed with evil.

Diarmuid the Bard's Advice

Diarmuid approaches the knights and tells them he knows something that might help them. A tale he heard says the Queen of the Wastelands knows much of treasure and where it may be found. If asked why he is willing to help, he tells them he has two reasons: First, the Thirteen Treasures are sacred objects, and only those of worth should bear them. Their actions on the

road show them worthy. Second, if they succeed, he will be well-placed to record their exploits and play a part, allowing his name to also live forever alongside theirs. He will, upon request, list the Thirteen Treasures for the Player-knights, and asks if he may travel with them. (If the Player-knights grant this request, remind them of his "neutral observer" stance—he will not aid them in any way, merely witness their glorious actions.)

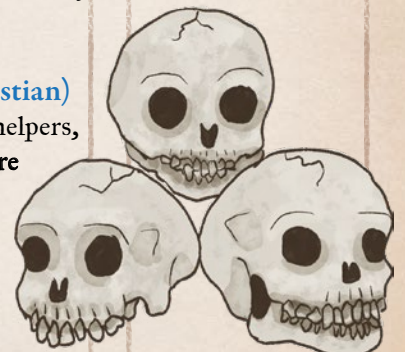
Ariette's Advice

Ariette de la Belle Sourire comes to the knight whom Sir Sagramore challenged. She apologizes for any inconvenience she caused the Player-knight and, batting her eyes at them, asks a favor. The Player-knight must roll their **Adoration (Ariette)** Passion, if any. If successful, they grant her request at once. If they fail, or if they do not have any Adoration (Ariette) Passion, they may choose.

Her favor is for the knight to seek out the Queen of the Wastelands. Ariette earnestly assures the knight the Queen will know where the treasure to aid Gawaine is located. She will not say how she knows this, but, if the Player-knight succeeds at a **Suspicious** Test roll, Ariette tells them she was visited by Sir Sagramore and Sir Tor the previous evening, and they told her about the Queen. Ariette wants the knight to find the treasure before Sir Sagramore and Sir Tor but will not say why. (The reason is that both knights were angry at her for giving her favor to the Player-knight and, in discussing it later, decided the maid was at fault. She was piqued by their anger and, to show them up and win favor with Queen Guenever, she is helping the hapless Player-knight.) Ariette does not actually know how to get to the Wastelands, nor anything about the Queen.

Using Folklore or Religion (Christian)

In the absence of any of the above helpers, the Player-knights may make **Folklore** or **Religion (Christian)** rolls. Success reminds them of a tale of a wandering holy man who said the "Queen of the Wastelands" had a gift for finding treasures and had led knights to such before.



The day Arthur makes his announcement is designated "T". Thus, the Player-knights must be back within T+42 days to succeed at the quest. Assume the Player-knights take the rest of the day to make arrangements for travel and depart the next morning on T+1. All further times from here on out assume a T+1 departure; adjust accordingly for hurried departures or bothersome delays.

The Player-knights arrive at the Wastelands on day T+13.

Neither Ariette nor Skills tell the Player-knights where to find the Wastelands. If you use these ploys, utilize the information known by Sir Cynwal to send the characters on their way (remember, he claimed to have some information on the Wasteland during the feast). The Player-knights must catch Cynwal before he leaves—give them a full day to do so. Otherwise, they must find their way there by some other manner (e.g., they could follow Tor and Sagamore's trail—someone outside the city will have seen them leave). Sir Cynwal, while he knows how to reach the Wastelands, does not know where the Queen's priory is. He does know her to be a very pious woman.

Part II: Into the Wastelands

The Wastelands are in the Kingdom of Lisenisse, north of the Perilous Forest. They were created by the Dolorous Stroke: The wounding of King Pellam with the Spear of Longinus by Sir Balin in 514. They are a terrible place, blasted and infertile, home to many dark creatures, both fiendish and fairy.

As there are several ways of reaching the Wastelands, the specifics are left to you. The most direct route, however, wends its way from Carlion towards the great city of Glevum, then north through the kingdoms of Galvoie and Cameliard before taking the road from Carohaise Castle to the city of Eburacum. From there, they ride on through the duchy of Cambenet as if making for the port of Carduel. The knights leave the King's Road before Carduel, however, most likely at Appleby Castle.

This leg of the journey takes approximately twelve days, assuming the knights do not stop for any length of time on the road, pausing only to present themselves at various courts of the lands they are passing through (and perhaps encountering old friends and rivals...).

Feel free to introduce small obstacles or delays along the way—perhaps a knight guards the bridge at a major river crossing, challenging all to a joust before allowing them to pass. Perhaps the King of Galvoie threatens to throw the knights into his oubliette for trespassing before extracting some valuable or oath from

them as a forfeit. The Player-knights should feel pressed for time, but not so much that they are prevented from reaching the Wastelands.

The Player-knights may cross paths with Sir Tor and Sir Sagamore, who elected to quest together in friendly competition, sometime during the journey to the Wastelands, but this is not essential. Should the knights get into too much trouble, the two knights may arrive and assist them. Naturally, they part company with the knights soon thereafter, wishing them luck.

If Player-knights ask people on the road about the Wastelands, they discover little of practical use. If, however, they are traveling with Diarmuid, peasants will be more likely to help them find their way (the knights are becoming folk heroes, at least for this year)—reduce all given travel times until the knights reach the Wastelands by one day each. Even if they receive help, however, the peasants speak of the Wastelands in hushed tones. It should be obvious it is a shunned place. No one can tell them where the Queen's Priory is, but a few may know her to be a very pious and holy woman.

A few miles west of Appleby Castle, beyond the Lune River, the Wastelands begin. They are nothing but miles of stark, jagged cliffs stabbing feebly into a leaden sky, dead ground, and rotting flora. Where streams do flow, the water is brackish, seemingly unable to soak the ground. Dust and fog hang thickly in the air, heavy with the smell of rotting plants. The scent of decay is palpable. Any Player-knight who makes an **Awareness** roll notices that the stench is like that of the Grey Knight. As they ride deeper into the Wastelands, impress upon the Players the awful "feeling" of the area: The unnatural bareness, the desolate stillness, and the profound emptiness of a kingdom gone to ruin.

If the Player-knights have Friar Coombs' directions, they quickly find them of no use. The landmarks noted cannot be found, and riding in the direction indicated turns up nothing. The actual location of the Queen of the Wastelands' priory is unimportant. The Player-knights will find it, but only after the following encounters.



Arrival at the Dark Abbey occurs on the night of T+14.

THE DARK ABBEY

After the first day of riding in the Wastelands, as night is about to fall, the Player-knights spy what looks to be an abbey made of dark stone. At the same time, a violent storm rolls in, with crashing thunder and crackling lightning quickly unleashing a torrential downpour. Since the abbey is the only logical shelter, the knights should head for it. As they approach, call for **Religion (Christian)** rolls. A success notes the total lack of religious symbols of any kind on

the abbey. Player-knights of any religion who request a **Spiritual** Test roll and succeed note an indefinable feeling that something is very wrong here. A successful **Stewardship** roll tells a knight the stone of the abbey is remarkably un-weathered, as well as being of no sort they have ever seen before.

Even as they dismount, the gate of the abbey opens, and a cowed, black-robed figure greets them.



“Good knights, please enter and be welcome. ‘Tis a vile evening to be abroad in this fell land.” The figure removes its cowl, revealing a sleek man in his twenties with a black beard, green eyes, and a toothy smile. He introduces himself as Brother Taman.

Brother Taman shows the squires where to stable the horses. If a knight decides to go along, they note there are the same number of stalls as there are horses in the party—no more, no fewer. If no one goes with them, have each roll their **Squire Skill** when the squires return. A successful roll means the squire volunteers this information.

While the squires see to the horses, Brother Taman leads the knights into the dining hall of the abbey and bids them sit. Allow Player-knights another **Religion (Christian)** roll within the abbey to note the lack of religious symbols in evidence.

Brother Taman gets a set of simple cups from a cabinet, along with a stone jar. He pours wine for each knight and a cup for himself. A Player-knight wishing to refuse the drink must have one of two reasons: Either they care not for drink, in which case they can roll **Temperate**, or they are suspicious of Brother Taman, in which case they can roll **Suspicious**. In either case, a failed Test roll means the knight drinks the wine. Those knights who do drink find the wine excellent—surprisingly so, considering the source. If they compliment Brother Taman on the quality of the wine, he tells them it used to be made here in the abbey, and there is only a small supply left. He agrees it is most excellent and particularly warming on such a cold, damp night.

After the wine, Brother Taman brings forth some meager food (bread and cheese only, no meat or fruit), apologizing for the scant provisions. If the Player-knights ask to hear his story, he tells them he is the last of the order that founded this abbey. Ever since the Dolorous Stroke was smote, the land has withered, and little by little, all the brothers, including the abbot himself, became despondent and wandered off or perished. He alone remains, maintaining the abbey in confidence

On Matters of Consent

The “hequibede” (incubus/succubus) is an iconic monster of medieval myth. It also presents a very real issue for use in a role-playing game: That of causing discomfort at the gaming table due to the themes it evokes.

Accordingly, Gamemasters should handle this encounter with care, up to and including modifying it to eliminate the hequibede entirely. (Instead, have Brother Taman attack a random Player-knight directly, as described at the end of the encounter.) If you decide to run the encounter as-written, make sure to check in with your Players before the session (if you have not already had a conversation around safety and consent), clarifying the lines which folks would rather not cross in play. In particular, according to medieval legend, a woman who lies with an incubus may conceive a demon-seed; this should *never* be a fate foisted upon a woman-at-arms by Gamemaster fiat!

In short, let your Players guide how far they wish to delve into the unsavory legends of the hequibede, if at all. Your game will be richer for it.

that, one day, the land will be redeemed and the abbey will flourish again. If they ask whom the order serves, he tells them, “god, of course.” If they refer to the lack of religious symbols, he explains the departing brothers took them all. Should a Player-knight offer him a crucifix, rosary, or other such icon, he thanks them but does not take or touch it.

If asked if he knows where the Queen of the Wastelands might be found, he says he does. Brother Taman does not really know where the queen is but wants the Players to think otherwise. He even offers to guide them in the morning. He confirms almost anything the knights have heard about the Queen to maintain the illusion of knowledge.

A Midnight Seduction

Not long after the “meal” is served, all knights who drank the wine start feeling very sleepy, as do all the squires (they were given wine as well as the knights; none of them are assumed to have refused it). At the first yawn, Brother Taman remarks that the knights must be very tired and offers to show them to their rooms. Those who accept this hospitality are conveyed to a wing of the abbey in which there are numerous doors—in fact, one for each Player-knight, no more, no fewer. Squires are assumed to be bunking with their knights or just outside their doors if their knights have a high Station Passion and are real sticklers for place.

If any knights wish to remain up, Brother Taman gets a little annoyed and again urges them to retire, or at least let him show them to their rooms so he can bed down for the night. Whatever occurs, in another twenty minutes, all who drank the wine are sound asleep.

The wine is a powerful sleeping potion. The only drinker awake is Brother Taman. He urges any knights still standing to convey the others to rooms so they may rest comfortably. If they refuse, he shrugs his shoulders and excuses himself, trundling off to his bed. Knights may follow him; he goes right to his room, enters, and bars the door. If they listen, they hear nothing from inside. Sleeping knights cannot be wakened by any means. If a Player-knight stubbornly refuses to take their sleeping comrades

PANTHER

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON
12	25	25	15

ATTACKS

WEAPON	VALUE	DAMAGE
Claws	20	2D6/2D6
Maul	20 (+5)	4D6

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	27
Knockdown	12
Major Wound	15
Unconscious	7

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	20
Armor Points	3
Glory Award	100
Valorous Mod.	-5

Claws: Panthers may attack one target per round using both claws at the same time. If the cat wins, it makes two separate damage rolls as shown. Damage inflicted by these two damage totals is treated as two separate wounds. However, the two damage values are totaled for the purposes of determining Knockdown.

Maul: If the cat scores a Knockdown result on its opponent, on the following Combat Round it follows up by leaping upon its prey and attempting a “killing bite” with its powerful jaws. Any attempt to defend against this attack short of Brawling suffers a -5 penalty to Weapon Skill.

to comfortable beds or refuse to go to sleep themselves, let them either sit around watching their fellows snore or prowl about the abbey for a while. Nothing happens until they finally decide to be sensible and get a good night’s rest in a comfortable bed. If they try to stay up all night, they must make an unopposed **Energetic** roll every hour. Feel free to pile on increasing penalties with each passing hour (-5, -10, -15); they have traveled many long and hard miles in recent days.

Once they are all abed, a cowed figure appears to one of the knights who drank the wine (either choose the knight at random or by highest APP). This figure is a spirit of lust and desire called a hequibede, and it takes the form of an extremely comely (APP 20) man or woman, depending on the preferences of the Player-knight. Its male form is called an incubus, and its female form a succubus.

Make an opposed Trait Test roll of the victim’s **Chaste** (if they try to resist) against the hequibede’s **Lustful**, with a reflexive +5/-5 modifier if the Player-knight has had *any* reason to be suspicious of this dark abbey and its sole resident prior to now.

If the hequibede wins, the victim loses 1D6 CON for the remainder of the year or until healed by magic or miracle. The victim does not recall the incident, save as a very pleasant, if naughty, dream.

If the first knight cannot or does not resist the hequibede’s wiles, it then moves



on to the next drugged knight, repeating the same performance. It continues to visit the drugged knights until one wins the opposed roll (see below) or until it has gone through all of them, in which case it then visits the knights who did not drink the sleeping potion, using the same seduction technique; these knights resist with a +5 modifier to **Chaste** (in addition to the +5/-5 modifier, if applicable). Gamemasters may also allow Player-knights, regardless of whether they drank or not, to roll a relevant Passion for a further bonus to Chaste. Suitable choices include **Love (Spouse)**, **Adoration (Beloved)**, or **Devotion (God)** (if a Religious Knight).

Should all the knights fall victim, they simply awake the next morning and find the abbey gone—no Brother Taman, no nothing. They are all lying on the ground with memories

of an intensely erotic, if strangely disturbing, dream. All feel a little weaker.

If the target wins against a hequibede's Lustful, they suffer no ill effects, and the hequibede is banished, dispersing in a miasma of foul vapor.

If a Player-knight banishes the hequibede, a moment later, a black panther bounds into the room, snarls once, and springs at the knight, jaws agape. Any other knight who did not drink the sleeping potion may make an **Awareness** roll. A success means they heard the snarl, awoke with a start, and can go to the aid of the attacked knight and be at their side in one melee round.

The attacked knight may also foil the panther for a moment by flashing a crucifix or other holy icon in front of it. This allows the other knights to make **Awareness** rolls and reach for their weapons before the panther springs.

If the Player-knight does not have a holy icon, assume they can reach their weapon after the first spring if they are not mauled. Once it has appeared, the panther attempts to kill everyone in the abbey. If it kills one knight, however, allow even the knights who drank the wine to make an **Awareness** roll to wake up, as the dead knight is unlikely to have died silently. Allow the squires a roll against their **Squire Skill** as well. Those who pass wake up and may assist their knights from then on.

Once slain, the panther changes shape in death, revealing itself to be Brother Taman. A moment later, the abbey explodes around the knights. They are knocked off their feet but not hurt. When they look up into the rain, the abbey is gone. Horses, equipment, and squires are all there. Sleeping knights awaken with a most interesting story to tell...

Hequibede

Trait: Lustful 20 (+6)

Glory Award: 25 per resisted seduction

THE GUARDIAN OF OLBRAY

Late in the afternoon of their second day in the Wastelands, the Player-knights spot a small village in the distance. They are too far away to make out much more than a collection of buildings. However, they can tell nothing is moving around the village—neither peasants nor animals. The Player-knights may elect whether or not to approach the village. If they turn away, proceed on to “**The Lion and the Serpent**” (below).

If they ride toward the village, they spot a knight cresting a rise, heading from the village itself. The knight wears a well-made hauberk, though the rest of his gear is frayed and weathered. He sits astride a ragged-looking charger, its gear in the same shape as its rider’s. There is a coat-of-arms on the knight’s shield; a successful **Recognize** +5 roll tells the Player-knight it is the arms of the kingdom of Listeneisse; a critical success reveals the knight’s name: Sir Vardilain the Staunch. The knight wears an advanced helm with a faceplate, so the Players cannot tell what he looks like.

Behind the knight, on foot, is his esquire: A man in his thirties, dressed in ragged clothing. He carries several lances and a mace.

The knight stops his horse some distance from the Player-knights and immediately hurls a challenge: “I am the Guardian of Olbray, and as my liege has charged me, I defend this village with my life. Turn about or meet me in mortal combat!” The Player-knights may question him, and he answers quite courteously as he is able, but if they try to get past him at any point, he springs to the attack.

Sir Vardilain the Staunch is a man in his fifties, a knight of long experience and many battles. He guards Olbray at the behest of his lord, King Pellam. He does not know any Queen of the Wastelands nor where she may be found. He is also not aware of the Dolorous Stroke; neither is his esquire. There is little else he can tell the Player-knights about himself or his mission.

Once Player-knights have asked any questions they wish, they may ride away from the village in peace, and the encounter ends. Should they attempt to move past him, he immediately springs to the attack.

A large party of knights could attempt to overwhelm Sir Vardilain or have a portion of the party keep him occupied while the others ride to the village. Such an action is highly unchivalrous. If the Player-knights suggest this, remind them of this fact. If they persist, any knight with the Chivalry Passion loses 2 Honor.

Should the knights choose to face Sir Vardilain in a chivalrous manner, the fight takes place as follows: The two knights begin on horseback with lances and continue on foot with hand weapons, if necessary. If Sir Vardilain is unhorsed, he asks to continue the fight on foot with his mace. He fights his mounted opponent even if this request is not granted. A Player-knight who refuses this request should roll **Merciful**, losing 1 Honor if they succeed.

If a Player-knight is unhorsed, Sir Vardilain gives them a chance to yield. If they do not, Sir Vardilain dismounts to continue the fight on foot, using his mace. Should Sir Vardilain score a Knockdown on a Player-knight, he is assumed

*The Player-knights
arrive at Olbray
on T+15.*

to have bested them and again offers the knight a chance to yield. Should he render a knight Unconscious, he does not slay them. Instead, he meets other challengers. Any Player-knight who yields must vow an oath upon their Honor to go to King Pellam within a year and tell the king that Sir Vardilain the Staunch keeps his faith and guards Olbray as bidden. Fulfilling this oath could become the basis for an exceptional scenario the following year. (See “Oaths” in the *Pendragon Player’s Handbook* for more information.)

If Sir Vardilain is Knocked down, the Player-knight has bested him and may kill him or offer a chance to yield (a **Merciful/Cruel** roll may be in order). Sir Vardilain will not yield under any circumstance. He would rather die than fail in his duty to his liege. If a Player-knight refuses to kill him, Sir Vardilain attacks as soon as he can get to his feet.

If Sir Vardilain is knocked Unconscious, his esquire begs the knight who defeated him to kill his master before he awakens (he may make this request any time he can speak outside his master’s hearing). By way of explanation for this astounding request, he leads the knights to the village of Olbray.

When the Player-knights enter the village, they discover all its inhabitants are dead, killed by a terrible plague. Bodies lie in the streets, their flesh churning with maggots and rotting from the bones. Even the animals are dead. The

old knight and the esquire are the only survivors. Thomas, Sir Vardilain’s esquire, does not know what caused the plague. All he knows is that Sir Vardilain was charged by King Pellam to defend Olbray with his life, and the death of all its inhabitants has unhinged him. For a full year, Sir Vardilain has dwelt here, challenging anyone who approached the village, and he will continue to do so until Pellam relieves him of the obligation.

As noted before, neither knight nor esquire knows of the Dolorous Stroke. If

informed, it makes no difference to Vardilain, who has sworn to keep his post until relieved. This madness is why the squire believes his master’s death is the true mercy in this situation. “His loyalty has become a madness only death may cure.”

If the Player-knights agree and finish off Sir Vardilain, the squire falls on his sword directly after, thanking them with his last breath.

Alternatively, the Player-knights can offer to go to King Pellam and tell him what has happened here in Olbray. King Pellam has forgotten he posted Vardilain here. This, of course, means finding Castle Carbonek—the Grail Castle—which has been magically hidden so that anyone who seeks it cannot find it. Thus, this is a task more difficult than finding the Queen’s priory and well outside the scope of this adventure. Thomas can give them directions to the castle, but the knights find the Wastelands

SIR VARDILAIN THE STAUNCH

The Guardian of Olbray

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON	APP
16	8	11	11	8

ATTACKS

WEAPON	SKILL	VALUE	DAMAGE
Lance	Charge	18	6D6
Arming Sword	Sword	16	5D6
Mace	One-handed Hafted	18	5D6*
Dagger	Brawling	10	2D6+5

* Deals +1D6 Damage against opponents wearing Mail armor

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	27
Knockdown	16
Major Wound	11
Unconscious	7

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	15
Armor Points	12+6
Glory Award	50
Healing Rate	2

Armor: Advanced hauberk, advanced nasal helm, aketon + kite shield*

Traits: Valorous 17

Passions: Homage (King Pellam) 20+1, Honor 15

Skills: Awareness 15, Battle 18, Courtesy 15, First Aid 13, Horsemanship 18, Hunting 14, Recognize 17

* Shield penalizes –2 to all weapons when mounted except Mounted Charge with spear or lance; –10 Missile Attack Penalty



*The Lion and the
Serpent appear
on day T+19.*

are so warped that his directions quickly become useless, and in time, they encounter **“The Lion and the Serpent”** (below).

If a Player-knight slays Vardilain, they receive checks to Merciful and Arbitrary. If a Player-knight makes an oath to search out King Pellam, they receive a Just check. If they simply ride away, they get no checks, and Sir Vardilain remains part of the Wastelands, to be used in later adventures as you desire.

THE LION AND THE SERPENT

After the incident with Sir Vardilain, the Player-knights must roam the Wastelands aimlessly for several days, meeting no one and traveling farther and farther into the ruined terrain. On the afternoon of the second day, tell them they have not come across any water recently. On the third day, have them come across some dark, brackish water in which lies the rotting body of a dead wolf. On the fourth day, as the Player-knights become increasingly anxious about ever finding fresh water or the Queen, the following encounter occurs.

While riding along a dry, desolate gully, lightheaded and headachy with thirst, they hear a fearful roar and an equally tremendous hiss up ahead. Continuing forward as cautiously or recklessly as they like, they turn a bend and see a large tawny lion confronting a truly massive white serpent. Both creatures are bleeding and torn. If the Player-knights succeed at a **Battle** roll, they notice the lion’s moves seem calculated to keep the serpent from approaching a nearby boulder.

As the lion and serpent come at each other again, the Player-knights hear the voice of a small child to their right: “Will you not intervene in this conflict, good knights?” Looking down from the saddle, the Player-knights see a three-year-old boy with golden hair and a smug smile. He is attired in a tunic, its left side white and its right side black. His breeks are likewise hued, except that the colors are reversed. None of the Player-knights can say where he came from—it is as if he simply appeared out of thin air.



He speaks again: “Come, dear knights, can Good hope to defeat Evil without the help of those of goodwill?” It is obvious the child is asking the Player-knights to take a hand in the combat without telling which of the creatures he wishes them to help. Nor does he reveal this, no matter what the knights try. In fact, he does not speak any further. He stands and looks from them to the two creatures and back. If he is asked about the Queen of the Wastelands, he reacts with a knowing smile and a nod of the head but says nothing.

Should the Player-knights choose to help neither, they see the serpent slay the lion. It then slithers to the boulder the lion was guarding and thrusts its head beneath. It extracts three mewling lion cubs and devours them in one gulp. As its jaws clamp down on the cubs, its fangs send a stream of blood onto the ruined ground. Smoke arises from the drops of blood, which hiss as they land. The boy then turns to the knights: “The innocents are slain, and the serpent reigns! The Grey Knight’s case is proven!” The boy then disappears, as do the serpent and the body of the lion, leaving only the blood quickly boiling away into smoke to indicate the battle was not some horrible dream. If the Player-knights examine the small pool of blood on the ground, they discern an image of Arthur slain by an unidentified knight.

If the Players decide to help the serpent and aid it in killing the lion, the events occur as above, once they have played out the fight.

LION

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON
40	20	40	15

ATTACKS

WEAPON	VALUE	DAMAGE
Claws	20	4D6/4D6
Maul	20	8D6

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	55
Knockdown	40
Major Wound	15
Unconscious	14

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	35
Armor Points	5
Glory Award	250
Valorous Mod.	-5

Claws: Lions may attack one target per round using both claws at the same time. If the cat wins, it makes two separate damage rolls as shown. Damage inflicted by these two damage totals is treated as two separate wounds. However, the two damage values are totaled for the purposes of determining Knockdown.

Maul: If the cat scores a Knockdown result on its opponent, on the following Combat Round it follows up by leaping upon its prey and attempting a “killing bite” with its powerful jaws. Any attempt to defend against this attack short of Brawling suffers a -5 penalty to Weapon Skill.

If the Player-knights opt to aid the lion, run the combat as normal. A bold band of knights and a lion should be able to lay the serpent down. When it is slain, the lion goes to the rock, turns it over with his paw, and gently extracts the three cubs. The boy in the black and white tunic turns into a snake and slithers away as the body of the serpent disappears. (All attempts to slay the transformed boy fail—he slithers into a hole too quickly). The giant serpent’s body quickly decays, turns to dust, and

blows away on the wind. In its place, a spring of fresh water burbles forth, quickly forming a stream running along the gully. Knights, squires, and horses alike may slake their thirst.

The lion sets down its three cubs and, in a shimmering flash, becomes a knight in black armor who bears a shield with a *per pale* ordinary of black and white and wears a tabard bearing the image of a lion’s face in gold upon a black field. As the cubs look at the knight, the Player-knights should roll **Awareness**: Success leaves the knight with the impression that the cubs’ eyes are very similar to human eyes. A critical success notes one of the cubs has eyes just like Gawaine’s. (The other two have the eyes of Gawaine’s younger brothers, not yet knighted: Gaheris and Gareth, but the Player-knights cannot know this yet.)

As they ponder this odd feeling, the Lion Knight speaks: “The innocent are saved though the serpent’s spawn lives. The Grey

Chapter 3: The Grey Knight

Knight's cause is unjust." The knight says nothing more unless the Player-knights quickly ask about the Queen of the Wastelands. In this case, the knight points to the northeast and says, "Ride there. Ride through blackest night and stray not from your good quest. Your goal you shall find with the dawning." If the Player-knights do not ask about the Queen within a minute or so of the Lion Knight's pronouncement, he disappears. His cubs disappear with him.

If the Player-knights decide to attack both lion and serpent, the beasts

cease fighting one another and defend themselves. Should the knights succeed in killing both, the boy in the tunic laughs heartily, saying, "You shall never know, foolish knights! You shall never know!" He then disappears along with the carcasses. The knights never see the cubs and do not hear any prophecy.

The boy's image is that of Mordred. The Player-knights have no reason to recognize him but may roll **Recognize** at -5 upon meeting him for the first time in subsequent years. Whether or not Mordred remembers his participation in this event depends upon your interpretation of his character in your campaign. If he arrives in Camelot already set on destroying Arthur, he was a willing participant in the spell. If he begins as a good knight who slowly corrupts himself over time, he has only vague memories of this event, as if his actions took place in a

GIANT SERPENT

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON
35	15	40	15

ATTACKS

WEAPON	VALUE	DAMAGE
Bite	15	special
Coil	15	special

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	50
Knockdown	35
Major Wound	15
Unconscious	13

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	5
Armor Points	15
Glory Award	250
Valorous Mod.	-10

Skills: Avoidance 10

Bite: A serpent's bite attack is treated as a Grapple (Hold) attack. A serpent achieving a Hold while grappling in this way swallows any creature of SIZ 50 or less. The hapless target is slain and devoured. (Generous Gamemasters may allow for the survival of the character for a few rounds, giving their friends an opportunity to slay the beast and rescue the character. Treat swallowed characters as suffering from the effects of suffocation.)

Coil: A giant serpent may attempt to crush a target by coiling around it as per a Grapple (Hold) attack. Targets who are successfully held take 10D6 points of damage per round in addition to the usual effects of a Hold.

dream. Alternatively, Mordred may not be an actual participant in this event, and the child, while wearing Mordred's appearance, is but a shadowy projection of his potential for evil or the result of a shape-shifting fairy or fiend who knows the truth of the boy's paternity.

Finally, if the knights did not slay the giant serpent, they must go on without water, suffering a -5 penalty to STR, CON, DEX, and all of their Skills until they are able to drink. Gamemasters should apply the rules for Aggravation as well, with knights and horses

alike losing Hit Points for strenuous activities (such as combat and travel...).

THE HOST

The knights continue their search for the priory of the Queen of the Wastelands for another day. Then, late that night—either as they are riding or after making camp—they hear a frightful sound. It is a gibbering wail, low at first and gradually growing louder. A sulfurous stench permeates the air as half-seen skeletal apparitions shriek and rattle about our brave knights. A successful **Folklore** roll identifies them as the *Sluagh na Marbh*, a host of the unforgiven dead.

The Sluagh manifest as rotting corpses, flying around the knights and evoking crippling fear in all who witness them. There is seemingly no escape from their torment. If

The Host torments the Player-knights on day T+20.

the Player-knights succeeded in identifying the Sluagh, allow a second **Folklore** roll. A success calls to mind the following protections against them (and the roll required to chase them away):

- ✱ Invoking the name of Jesus Christ, the Virgin Mary, or any of the saints, or making the sign of the cross (**Spiritual to test your conviction; non-Christians roll at -5**)
- ✱ Throwing sea salt over your left shoulder (**Stewardship** to see if you brought any)
- ✱ Banging a bronze-bladed weapon against your shield (no roll required, but you must possess such a weapon to begin with!)

The same successful roll reminds the Player-knight that, as they wear iron armor and wield iron weapons, the Sluagh will not dare touch them nor approach too close. This knowledge grants them a +5 to their Valorous roll when the time comes, below.

As the night wears on, the Sluagh demand the knights vow to cease their quest and tell all others the Queen of the Wastelands is dead. In return, the Sluagh will leave them in peace. The demand is repeated once per Player-knight. An answer of “no” angers the Host, and the Player-knight must oppose their **Valorous** Trait against the Sluagh’s **Life Force** of 20 (+10). On a loss, the Player-knight’s heart seems to freeze, and they immediately lose 15 Hit Points; only supernatural armor (such as the Armor of Chivalry) protects against this loss, which is not marked as a wound and may only be healed through natural recovery. A fumbled Valorous roll leaves the target with a Directed Trait of Cowardly (Spirits) +1D6, and the knight also gains the negative distinctive feature “Prematurely Grey or White Hair.” Either way, the character flees at their (or their horse’s) full Movement Rate the next Combat Round.

A Player-knight who loses Hit Points to the Sluagh is offered surcease if they promise



to abandon their quest and return to Carlion empty-handed. Those who so promise, check Cowardly and immediately lose 5 Honor. The Sluagh bother the shameful Player-knight no more...but that was bound to happen anyway, as they can only “attack” each character once! The Sluagh know this, but they are lying manipulators intent on spreading corruption.

When the sun rises, the Sluagh fade away, leaving behind a band of tattered knights. What happens next depends upon how the Player-knights reacted to the Host.

If all the knights held fast to their quest, neither running away nor promising to commit wicked deeds, they see in the distance a small building, shining in the dawn like a beacon.

If all the knights told the Host they would abandon the quest, they see nothing but the same terrain they have been traveling through. They find their way out of the Wastelands in 1D6+6 days. They are forever cut off from the Queen of the Wastelands. For them, the scenario is over. They have failed the adventure (see “What If...?” on p. 76).

If only some of the knights vowed to abandon the quest, the building still appears in the distance, but only those who resisted the Sluagh can see it. In this way, the party can reach their goal, although some cannot see it. Naturally, the knights who cannot see the building may think those who claim to are mad. Leave the Player-knights to sort this out for themselves. The knights’ squires, while assaulted by the Sluagh, were not asked to assent to or deny the quest. Only those knights who held firm in their resolve see the priory.

THE QUEEN’S PRIORY

The small building is the priory of the Queen of the Wastelands. Reaching it takes several hours of weaving through the twisted trees and tangled terrain of the wasted forest. The actual site is a humble spot. The glow surrounding it when those knights who did not abandon the quest first saw it has gone. A door opens, and the Queen of the Wastelands steps out. At this moment, all who abandoned the quest are suddenly separated from those who did

Background: The Queen of the Wastelands

This mysterious Arthurian holy woman is the aunt of Sir Percivale, who will become one of the most famous knights to complete the Grail Quest. In some stories she is the wife of King Pellam, living chastely apart from him. In others, she is his grandmother. Regardless, she appears to have a special relationship with the Grail Family and is favored by God for her chastity and humility. Interestingly, she accompanies Nimue and Morgan le Fey with the mortally wounded King Arthur on the black barge to Avalon at the end of the Arthurian saga.

not. They find themselves in the Wastelands, their fellows gone. Before saying what happens to the other Player-knights, determine their intentions: Do they stay where they are, go back the way they think they came, or go on? If they stay, or at least indicate they are staying close to where they were separated, these knights are reunited with their companions following this encounter. If they do anything else, the scenario is over for them. They have failed the quest. (Either way, the squires and horses of the knights stay or go with their masters.)

The Queen is a woman of gentle beauty, chastely attired in a tattered grey nun’s habit. If the Player-knights ask if she is the Queen of the Wastelands, she replies, “Some have called me that. Some have called me the Queen of Most Riches in the World. Yet, my life of riches never pleased me so much as my life of poverty does. Come in, gentle folk, and tell me of what you have seen in this poor land.” Presumably, the knights enter, leaving their squires outside to tend to the horses.

The Queen does not divulge her real name, nor does she answer the Player-knights’ questions until they tell her about all they have encountered in the Wastelands. She fixes with a look of disapproval any knight who intentionally

lies about an encounter. That knight automatically receives a **Deceitful** check. Should a knight honestly forget to mention an event, she prompts them to speak of it. When she has heard all, she now answers any questions they have about the encounters. She knows the following:

- ✱ The dark abbey contained a malevolent fairy called a hequibede and its damned guardian, once an abbot of a Christian order. He traded his soul to Satan for youth and aided the fairy in draining all the other monks of the order.
- ✱ King Pellam is found in Castle Carbonek. She can direct them there to honor any vow they made to the Guardian of Olbray or his squire. **Note:** It is up to you how much of Castle Carbonek's location you wish to reveal to the Players. A journey there should be out of the way, costing the Player-knights valuable time. If you wish them to enter the castle, you may find information about the events that transpire therein in the scenario entitled "**High Adventure in the Wastelands**" in *The Great Pendragon Campaign*. If you do not wish your Player-knights to enter the castle, have them meet a patrol of King Pellam's knights, who either swear to inform their king of Sir Vardilain's situation or volunteer to accompany the knights back to Olbray.
- ✱ If the serpent was killed, the Queen tells the Player-knights it represented Satan. The lion was a messenger from God, assigned to prove to them their cause was just. The lion's cubs were symbols of young knights who would be involved with the spawn of Satan, represented by the boy in the tunic. If the lion was killed, she deems the message of the serpent a false prophecy sent by the Devil to dissuade them from their quest. Regardless, the boy is the servitor of the serpent, who would cause Arthur's downfall—a corrupt innocent, no doubt. She does not know Mordred is the boy.
- ✱ The Sluagh were a test of their dedication to this quest, a test they obviously passed.

Once the Queen passes on all the above insights, she deals with their quest. She begins by inviting any knights who did not lie about an encounter in the Wastelands to pray with her for guidance. Each knight is invited by name, whether they have introduced themselves or not. She escorts those invited into a small shrine within the priory. To those pagan knights in the company, she still welcomes them to join her and pray to whatever gods they choose or has one of her novices offer them refreshment in the priory's hall.

The Queen prays for several hours. Those praying with her may leave at any time. Those not praying may busy themselves as they please. When the Queen finally ceases her prayers, she says the following:

"Jesu has shown favor upon your adventure, dear knights. In his name, I bid you go to the Forest Arroy and seek out the Castle of Haut-desert. He that dwells within is your gate to the prize you seek: The Whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd. Only this blessed sharpening stone can aid good Sir Gawaine in his challenge against the Grey Knight."

Player-knights now have the benefit of knowing what they are looking for and where to look. (They may also recall this was the last known destination of Morgan le Fay, which may cause some consternation.) Any knight who spent the whole time praying with the Queen of the Wastelands receives a **Spiritual** check and finds their Hit Points completely restored, all their wounds healed. Those who did not must make a **Spiritual** roll to be healed. This applies to both those who left before the prayer was over and those who did not pray at all. This effect is not applied until the knights leave the priory.

Having obtained the information, the knights may leave now or ask the Queen to let them stay the night. The Queen grants this if requested, although the knights must sleep on the floor of the hall. The Queen has some meager fare she gladly shares with them. She is, however, a very pious woman, and any worldly behavior (e.g., drinking to excess or attempting to woo her) meets with her stern disapproval.



*The Player-knights
are ready to leave
the Wastelands
on day T+21.*

The knights may not stay with the Queen for more than a single night.

Knights who never got in but stayed put meet their friends soon after their departure from the priory. This is a sudden appearance—the reverse of what happened earlier. They are suddenly together, as if they had never left.

After this encounter, the knights may leave the Wastelands and head for the Forest Arroy.

Part III: The Forest Arroy

There are two ways for the Player-knights to reach the Forest Arroy:

- ✱ First, they can backtrack along the King's Road from Appleby to Eburacum, at which time they take the road south to Pase Castle and then the trade roads west to the City of Legions. This takes fourteen days (nine, if hurried). Note that

a hurried journey requires the knights' mounts to roll against CON at the end; a failed roll means the steed must rest an additional day before continuing, while a fumble means the steed is blown or injured and must be replaced!

- ✱ Alternatively, they may travel north to Carduel, from whence they can sail south to the City of Legions. This mode of travel takes a total of eight days (including a day of waiting in port for a ship large enough to carry the knights), or five, if hurried (by paying £1 per knight).

There is a third option of crossing overland to the south, eschewing established routes and skirting the Perilous Forest—the most haunted forest in Britain! This is more direct but slower, takes just as long as the Eburacum route, *and* requires a daily **Hunting** roll to keep from getting lost; each failed roll adds one day to the journey. Failed **Hunting** rolls may lead to encounters with malevolent fairies or giants from the Perilous Forest at the Gamemaster's discretion.

Show the Players the map and let them decide on the route themselves. Tell them their current location is somewhere in the vicinity of the “C” in the word *Cumbria* on the map, and they can navigate their way back to Appleby, should they wish. Player-knights from the North or Cumbria automatically know Carduel is a big port with ships for hire; if no such knight is in the party, do not share this information unless someone thinks to ask. Make the point that time is beginning to run short, and backtracking may not be the most efficient route.

Whichever way they get to the City of Legions (a Roman settlement quite like Carlion), they must now locate the estate of Hautdesert.

If any of the Player-knights are from Cameliard or Cheshire, they can guide their fellows to a small village at the edge of the Forest Arroy. From there, the party can get accurate directions to Castle Hautdesert, located within the woods; this takes one day. If no one is from Cameliard, the Player-knights must wander the land for 1D3+1 days before happening upon

Getting to the Forest Arroy adds anywhere from +1 to +4 to the current T-value.

Arrival at Hautdesert comes +2 days after reaching the Forest Arroy.

Depending on how they got there, the Player-knights arrive at the City of Legions sometime between T+26 and T+35 (or even later, if they got lost!).

this village. In either case, the villagers tell the knights Sir Bercilak dwells at Hautdesert with his gracious wife, Lady Elavane. (Do the Player-knights recall her from the tournament feast?) The villagers know nothing about the Whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd.

The Forest Arroy is deep, thick, and full of enchantment. Its terrain is rough, with many rocky hills and escarpments. As the knights ride through its confines, they hear strange noises—cries and whispers, bell-like music, the screeches of strange animals—and catch glimpses of the movement of light and shadows out of the corners of their eyes, only to disappear when looked at directly. Every so often, inform the Player-knights that they feel like they are being watched, but that there is no visible watcher. Due to the terrain, the journey takes a further two days as they walk their horses through the forest.

CASTLE HAUTDESERT

Hautdesert is a large, well-appointed shell keep built atop a promontory, giving spectacular views of the forested valley beyond towards a great rocky escarpment called the Roaches. When the knights first approach the castle, the gates are shut. They see no guards on the wall and must hail those within. Once they have done so, a porter appears and asks who they are and what they want. If their reply is courteous (and if they do not role-play this encounter, ask the knight speaking to make a **Courtesy** roll), the gate opens immediately. If not, the porter politely asks them to return tomorrow. They must wait a full day before requesting admittance again. If the knights remain discourteous, the porter again asks them to return tomorrow. After several days of this, even the densest of knights should get the picture. If not, have them make a **Courtesy** roll to figure out what they are doing wrong.

Once inside, the Player-knights are treated with great hospitality and courtesy. They meet Sir Bercilak, a large man with a great beard and the manner of a true lord. They also meet Lady Elavane, his beautiful wife. If the Player-knights did not recognize her name from the feast, they now recognize her face. Even if

Background: Sir Bercilak & Lady Elavane

Sir Bercilak is the man who becomes the Green Knight in 524 through a glamour of Morgan le Fay's art. Morgan's visit to the castle this year marks the beginning of their relationship, though Morgan is not directly involved in the plot of this adventure. Bercilak's wife, Lady Elavane, is a sorceress of considerable skill. It was she who provided Lady de Vawse with the potion that brought King Ryons back from the dead, and it is she who plots against the Player-knights. It is just one of her many plots, all intended to bring down the house of Pendragon.

she heard of the knights spreading scurrilous rumors about her at the feast, she plays the part of the gracious hostess.

Sir Bercilak immediately has the Player-knights fed, their horses tended to, and their garments mended, as needed. He asks them why they have come to Hautdesert unless the Player-knights already told the porter the whole story. Sir Bercilak is very disturbed at the mention of the Whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd. He does know where it is but promised to keep this location a secret. On the other hand, he has heard much about Sir Gawaine and would help him and King Arthur if he could.

Sir Bercilak invites the knights to stay at Hautdesert for the night while he considers the matter. They may accept or reject this offer as they choose, but Bercilak makes no decisions that night. If they stay and one or more of the Player-knights decides to search the castle for the whetstone, let them try. The knights and their squires sleep in the great hall, along with Bercilak's three household knights, their squires, and close members of the staff. They must avoid men-at-arms and servants as they conduct their search (**DEX** rolls versus the guards' **Awareness** of 10 and the servants' **Awareness** of 6). Sir Bercilak and

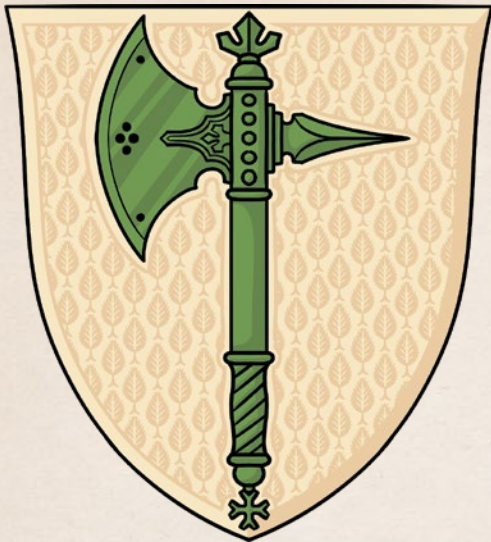
his lady have a separate chamber above the hall, accessed by a steep stairway. Sneaking up there requires another **DEX** roll at -5 against Lady Elavane's **Awareness** of 14. There are also stables, a kitchen and pantry, a chapel, and a barracks, with people to avoid there as well.

If they are discovered, Sir Bercilak hears of it and charges them with a serious breach of hospitality. If they do not apologize for their actions, which requires a successful **Modest** roll, he has them all ejected from the castle, and they each lose 1 point of Honor if they succeed on a **Hospitality** roll (any knights who did the sneaking lose the point of Honor automatically). Each knight searching also receives a Deceitful check and suffers the loss of 2 points of Hospitality (you may choose to warn them of this) whether they are caught or not. In any case, the whetstone is nowhere to be found. If the Player-knights simply enjoy the accommodation of Hautdesert, the night passes uneventfully—or so it seems at first.

Lady Elavane's Enchantment

Lady Elavane was caught by surprise at the Player-knight's arrival. She is determined to sabotage their quest and performs a wicked enchantment to hinder their progress. While the Player-knights sleep, she sends each a potent dream that changes their waking personalities. Lady Elavane's spontaneous magical working exhausts her, and afterward, she retires to a private lodge deep within the woods to recover for the remainder of their stay at Hautdesert.

The Player-knights awaken the next morning with only hazy memories of their dreams that quickly fade in the morning light. Have each Christian Player-knight make a **Devotion (God)** Passion roll. Any Religious Christian Player-knight who succeeds is immune to Elavane's enchantment. Any non-Religious Christian Player-knight only gains the same benefit if they roll a critical success. Pagan Player-knights have no protection against magic and automatically succumb to the enchantment. Tell the Player-knights who succumb that for the next week, they suffer a -5 penalty to their **Just** Traits (and thus a +5 to

*Sir Bertilak*

their **Arbitrary** Traits). Do not explain why or how. Let the players speculate.

The next morning, there is no sign of Lady Elavane. If the Player-knights inquire about her absence, Sir Bertilak is unconcerned. "My lady has many responsibilities which often take her from the hall." If they ask about Morgan le Fay, Bertilak confirms that the queen did indeed stay with them for a fortnight before continuing to her holdings in the north. He clearly did not think very highly of her, but courtesy (or fear) forbids him from extrapolating.

Convincing Sir Bertilak

Sir Bertilak remains undecided about revealing the location of the whetstone. He invites the knights to hunt with him while he reconsiders their request for the treasure. During the hunt, each knight must roll against their **Awareness**, **Horsemanship**, **Hunting**, and **Spear** Skills. Any Player-knight who succeeds at all four performs well on the hunt and is looked upon with favor by Sir Bertilak. Such a Player-knight may make a **Just** roll (with the penalty from Elavane's magic!) opposed by Bertilak's **Arbitrary** 12. If the roll wins, the Player-knight convinces Sir Bertilak their quest justifies breaking his oath. Bertilak does not give any signs he is convinced, waiting to reveal his decision at the evening repast. On a successful **Intrigue** roll during

*Lady Elavane*

the hunt, the Player-knights may learn Lady Elavane once knew Lady de Vawse, and the latter occasionally visited the castle.

Sir Bertilak's Decision

When the day's activity is done, the hunters return to the castle and another hearty meal.

If Sir Bertilak is convinced to help, he announces this at the feast. If he is not yet convinced, assume Sir Bertilak is "still considering." He invites them to spend yet another night at Hautdesert. The next day, repeat the hunt (or substitute other courtly behavior of your choosing, picking four **Courtly Skills** to test), and so on, until Sir Bertilak is swayed.

Once convinced, Sir Bertilak tells the Player-knights that the whetstone is kept safe in a hidden kingdom called Inaperçu, which lies beyond the cliffs called the Roaches. (*Inaperçu* means "unnoticed," or "invisible" in French.) Bertilak can lead them there but dares not enter with them lest he fall prey to the vengeance of the lord that rules that land. The reason, he explains, is that he promised never to tell where the whetstone is located or how to get to the hidden kingdom. He insists the knights vow not to tell the inhabitants of the kingdom of his involvement. Once they so vow, he leads them to the border of the Kingdom Inaperçu that day (or in the morning if it is night).

Staying at Hautdesert adds at least +2 to the current T-value.

THE KINGDOM INAPERÇU

With Sir Bercilak in the lead, the Player-knights leave Hautdesert and guide their horses miles along a high ridge before descending into the thickest part of the Forest Arroy along a poorly-defined trail hemmed in by thick stands of oak and beech. The terrain is exceedingly rough, with great dark stone outcroppings thrusting up through the forest floor, casting their own palls of darkness. More than ever, they feel the strange enchantment of the woods around them. Suddenly, their horses become skittish, whinnying and snorting and stamping on the ground. Sir Bercilak turns, gesturing for the others to halt. He points at a great chasm bisecting a moss-covered wall of rock and speaks:

“The Kingdom Inaperçu lies just ahead. Keep to the path and move as silently as possible, speaking no word and listening with all your heart for music such as you have never heard before. When you hear it, you will have reached the Kingdom Inaperçu. Good luck, and may the saints preserve you, good knights.” Sir Bercilak moves swiftly back through the thick forest, saying no more.

Walking the Silent Path

The path is a gentle slope between two sheer rock walls, their surfaces carpeted with thick moss and drooping ferns. The stony ground is slick with moisture and more moss, and quite uneven in places. As the path progresses, stone steps carved into the rock by ancient hands assist the knights in the climb. Overhead, a narrow band of daylight peeks down through tangles of brambles and branches growing at the top of the chasm. The knights must follow Sir Bercilak’s directions precisely, keeping to the path while moving as silently as possible and speaking no word until they hear the music. Should they fail to do so, they walk until the rising path terminates atop a great bald hill, affording spectacular views of the rocky hills around and the nearby sea in the distance. They must return to the chasm’s entrance and begin again, should they wish to reach the Kingdom Inaperçu.

To test their silence, each knight must roll their **DEX** to keep from slipping and

falling—they take no damage, but the noise of an armored knight crashing to the ground reverberates up and down the chasm. Knights who shed their weapons and armor gain a +4 to **DEX** for the purposes of this roll; knights who leave their armor behind but bring their weapons get a +3. Likewise, they must each roll **Horsemanship** to guide their mounts along the tricky path if they brought them. Finally, each knight’s squire must succeed at their **Squire Skill** to see if they inadvertently speak or make a noise before music is heard. If these latter rolls fail, when the knights do hear the music, the squire(s) in question are simply no longer there; no one saw them disappear.

If they brought their mounts, the horses continue to whinny and snort and stomp the ground, regardless of the success of the knights’ Skill rolls. Allow an **Awareness** roll to realize their horses are making too much noise before they reach the end of the trail. The best option is to leave the horses, along with their weapons and armor in care of one or all the squires but leave this to the Players to work out.

Assuming they stay quiet, after walking through the chapel-like gorge for a half-hour, the knights hear a distant, bell-like music. Once they hear this, the knights and their squires may speak freely. (You do not, however, need to tell them this.) As the knights continue, the music draws closer and closer until they suddenly find themselves in a wooded clearing. If the knights make a successful **Awareness** roll, they notice the foliage shows unseasonal fall colors despite it being high summer. The Player-knights may make **Folklore** or **Religion (Any)** rolls to confirm that they have crossed to the other side of the fairy veil.

King Billis and Queen Arawan

As the knights enter the clearing, they see strange and beautiful knights and ladies, many astride magnificent horses, all around them. Bizarre one-legged, one-armed, one-eyed monsters stand watch, looking at the knights with suspicion. Tiny sprites flit here and there while freakish inhuman creatures scamper about. A wide field, upon which scores of colorful



silk pavilions stand, displaces the dense forest around. Here and there are patches of flowers as tall as trees. A soft golden glow emanates from everything. The music the knights heard upon entering the kingdom continues to play, and the gathered assembly murmurs in a strange, melodious tongue. All eyes are fixed on the knights. The crowd parts, revealing a throne under a great oak. Here reside a breathtaking lord and lady couple. Both are attired in rich robes made of soft, rustling fur and ethereal, flowing cloth; their features are not-quite human, both unearthly and unnerving. The lord beckons the party forward and speaks.

He addresses by name and proper title the knight with the greatest Glory: "Come forward. Sir/Dame [name]. Indeed, come forward, all of you." He addresses each knight present by name and proper title. When all the knights approach, King Billis speaks once more.

"I am called Billis, King of the Unnoticed Land, and this is my Arawan, my Queen," he says, gesturing to his lovely wife. "It is not often that mortals tread these paths. Tell us how you came to know of our realm and what you seek here." Any Player-knight who tells King Billis about Sir Bercilak receives a Deceitful check and loses 1 point of Honor for breaking the vow not to tell of his involvement. The knights notice a frown cross King Billis' face when Bercilak's name is mentioned, but he says nothing about it. Any knight who makes up a lie about how they came to know of the Kingdom Inaperçu gains a Deceitful check as well (but loses no Honor) for lying to his host. The proper course of action is to courteously refuse to answer (e.g., "Forgive me, my lord, but I am bound to say nothing about how I came to be here.") Player-knights are free to make **Courtesy** rolls to realize that this is an option.

When the knights tell King Billis they seek the Whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd, he asks why, assuming they have not already told him when they explained how they came to be in his kingdom. Once told, the fairy king admits the whetstone is indeed in his possession, and the knights may have it if they are willing to do him a service first.

He gestures lovingly to the lady sharing his dais. "My Lady Arawan's horse was taken from her by a brute of a giant named Sangnoir, who dwells in a cave in the Forest Arroy. Return the horse, and you may have the whetstone. Do you agree to this bargain?"

Once the knights agree, King Billis tells them the horse's name is Selemine and may be recognized by a star-shaped mark on her forehead. To waste no time, he will send one of his courtiers to guide them to the giant. He claps his hands, and a stunning young fairy maiden steps forward. She kneels before her king and the knights, bows her head, and, in an instant, is gone. In her place, a small white bird flutters merrily in the air.

Billis tells the knights to follow the bird, and she will lead them to the giant. If they think to ask to get their horses first, the king grants their request. If they do not, they will have the unenviable task of fighting a giant on foot. Either way, the bird begins flying away from the fairy assembly. The Player-knights have no trouble following and soon find themselves back in the familiar surroundings of the Forest Arroy. If the Players ask about their horses (and any squires and equipment left with them), the bird leads them to their mounts before fluttering in the direction of the giant's lair. If not, their guide takes the knights directly to the lair.

SANGNOIR THE GIANT

The Player-knights follow the bird to the edge of the forest. There it stops and flutters, cheeping. The knights see a small, treeless hill about two hundred yards away. There is a large cave mouth halfway up this hill. A narrow path, big enough for no more than two horses abreast, leads up to the cave. All around the cave mouth are bones and skulls—some human, but most are horse skulls. There is a fire burning in a pit just before the cave. When the bird is certain the knights have seen the cave mouth, she flies off.

Even as she departs, a monstrous figure emerges from the cave. It is the giant, Sangnoir. He holds a horse's head impaled on a stick. Should they ask, reassure the Player-knights it is not Selemine as it has no mark on its

forehead. Sangnoir squats down before the fire and begins to roast the still-bleeding head. He hums a simple tune in a rough, growly voice as he cooks his repast.

There is no way to reach the cave except via the path. A knight might conceivably climb the rocky hillock and come up behind the cave, but they must pass a **DEX** roll with a -5 penalty five times, with each roll representing six yards of ascent. Any Player-knight who

fails a roll takes damage as if falling from half the height they have so far ascended as they go slipping and rolling back down the slope, making enough noise to alert Sangnoir.

Player-knights cannot approach the hill on horseback without alerting Sangnoir. They can sneak close to the path on foot, rolling their **DEX** opposed by Sangnoir's **Awareness** of 8. If they succeed, they reach the path and can hide behind rocks around its base. However, Sangnoir automatically notices the knights' presence after they travel halfway up the path on the hill, as he catches their scent.

If three or more knights boldly sally forth to combat the giant, he immediately looks at them and rises. He steps to a pile of large rocks and begins throwing at them. The knights must cover 150 yards before they can engage Sangnoir—use the Missile Attack rules for “Closing Distance” to calculate how many rounds Sangnoir may throw his rocks. The knights cannot move faster than a jog on foot or a trot if mounted due to the uneven, rocky terrain. When the knights reach the giant, he wields his club and fights normally.

SANGNOIR THE GIANT

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON
30	8	30	25

ATTACKS

WEAPON	VALUE	DAMAGE
Club	13	2D6+10
Grapple	15	special

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	55
Knockdown	30
Major Wound	25
Unconscious	14

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	24
Armor Points	15
Glory Award	100
Valorous Mod.	-5

Skills: Awareness 8

Reach: Thanks to their long arms small giants do not suffer a height disadvantage when fighting mounted knights.

Throw Rocks: Sangnoir can easily hurl rocks as far as 150 yards, doing 5D6 damage (normal armor protects at half its normal value, and shields do not impose a Missile Attack Penalty). He can throw one rock per Combat Round with a Skill of 10.

flees, he pursues as described below.

If only a single knight comes forward to challenge him, Sangnoir takes up his club and, after searching for ambushers as described above, charges the knight. If the knight is mounted and rides off, Sangnoir pursues for 1D6 rounds, then returns to the cave. The fleeing knight must roll their horse's Movement Rate against the giant's own Movement of 34 (treat as a value of 20 with a +14 critical bonus!). If the knight wins, they escape the giant's clutches. Any other result means Sangnoir catches up. The knight may still fight Sangnoir, of course. If the knight is defeated, the horse flees in terror. It takes Sangnoir 1D6 rounds to catch it, giving other Player-knights a chance to act as they see fit.

If all the knights are on foot, the process is much the same. However, Sangnoir does not pursue knights on foot. It is the horsemeat for which he has a fondness and is interested in, not the knight. Once Sangnoir is off the hill and fighting or pursuing a knight, other knights can easily cut him off from his lair.

If a Player-knight suggests his squire divert the giant's attention, roll against the squire's

If only two knights come forward, Sangnoir moves halfway down the path, looking around until he is convinced no other knights are in the area hiding with an **Awareness** roll. If successful, he spots any others who may be lurking, returns to his cave, and begins throwing rocks as above. If he believes he is only facing two opponents, he waits for the knights to reach him and fights normally. If he kills one knight and the other





age -5 to see if they comply. After all, this does not fall within the normal purview of a squire's duties. The knight suggesting this kind of diversion receives a **Cowardly** check, as should any knights who agree to the plan.

The Player-knights may wait for dark to fall to confront the giant

or, perhaps, withdraw until after dark if their initial foray does not go well. In this case, Sangnoir's Awareness is penalized by -5. However, Sangnoir does not leave the cave area after dark. He waits there for his enemies to come to him and his handy pile of rocks. He may, however, fall asleep, in which case the knights could sneak up on him on foot. If they are mounted, Sangnoir may make an unmodified **Awareness** roll to smell the horses coming.

Sangnoir does not waste any time in idle speech with knights. He is a nasty, horse-eating giant who hates all knights and whose only pleasure is to kill anyone who dares cross his path. Once Sangnoir is killed or diverted, Player-knights may enter his lair.

Sangnoir's Lair

Sangnoir's lair is nothing but a filthy cave. It smells foul; the scent of horses and their waste, the rank odor of the unwashed giant, and his bedding of untanned horsehides hangs heavily in the air. Bones are scattered across the floor, and a few rotting horse carcasses hang on the walls. At the back of the cave is a large pen holding 1D6+4 horses of varying types. The sound of these horses' whinnying is audible to anyone within ten feet of the cave's mouth.

Among the penned horses is Selemine, the fairy horse of Lady Arawan. She is obviously different from the others: Her forehead is marked with a star-shaped patch; her coat

SELEMINE

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON
26	28	24	18

ATTACKS

WEAPON	VALUE	DAMAGE
Hooves	12	5D6

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	44
Knockdown	26
Major Wound	18
Unconscious	11

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	31
Armor Points	4
Glory Award	25
Valorous Mod.	0

Avoidance: 20

is a shimmering, brilliant grey; her grey mane seems to move as if in the wind, feathery and ethereal.

Selemine immediately attacks anyone who approaches her and, if she can, tries to bolt out of the cave and escape. Rate her chance of success depending on the circumstances (e.g., if the

Player-knights opened the pen, if they released the other horses already, etc.). Knights on horseback can block the escape route. Selemine does not fight other horses.

Call for **Folklore** rolls. A success reminds the Player-knight of an old tale that says a whip of rowan can tame a fairy horse. There are rowan trees growing nearby, and such a whip may be easily obtained. With this in hand, any knight may approach Selemine without difficulty—even to the point of being able to ride her.

Should such rolls fail, you may have Diarmuid arrive on the scene with a rowan whip, even if he did not accompany the Player-knights on their journey. (If asked, he says a little bird told him of the knights' situation.) Alternatively, you may allow a knight to make a **Horsemanship** roll to calm the fairy horse. While this does not allow the knight to ride Selemine, it does enable them to lead her. Any attempt at riding Selemine without a rowan whip results in the knight being unceremoniously dumped on their duff.

Once Selemine is subdued, she unerringly runs back to her mistress, even if being ridden. The knights need only follow her to get back to Inaperçu, and they may ride their horses into the fairy kingdom as the steeds are calmed by Selemine's presence. If Selemine escapes, she returns to the Kingdom Inaperçu. In this case, the Player-knights must repeat the procedure of passing through the chasm and moving

as silently as possible. If the knights do not think to return to the kingdom on their own, have them make another **Folklore** roll or have Diarmuid recommend they return. If they do not return to the Kingdom Inaperçu, they will have failed in their quest!

THE RETURN TO THE KINGDOM INAPERÇU

There is much celebration in the Kingdom Inaperçu when the Player-knights return. King Billis praises them highly and wants to hear all the details of their combat with Sangnoir. Lady Arawan, with tears in her eyes, thanks them with all her heart. The Player-knights are invited to a grand celebratory feast—an invitation they may accept or decline as they wish. Should they ask, they are informed they will return to the mundane realm the morning following their arrival in Inaperçu, no matter how long they linger here.

If they politely decline, King Billis gives them the Whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd. He thanks them again and bids them farewell. He also tells them to beware of Lady Elavane, for she is ultimately responsible for the coming of the Grey Knight and may try to stop them. (He also gives this warning to Player-knights who stay for the feast.) Once thanked and warned, the knights ride off, and the Kingdom Inaperçu fades away almost instantly; quite unexpectedly, Stafford Castle grows visible on the horizon as they ride out of the woods. They are miles away from the Forest Arroy!

If they accept the fairy lord's hospitality, he does not give them the whetstone directly. He does, however, lead them to a sumptuous feast of exotic foods, heady wine and ale, and music and dancing long into the night. Player-knights may participate in mock combat with fairy knights or woo fairy



α Fairy Feast

Favorite Dishes: While all the food is extraordinary to mortal tastes, the dressed white peacock in orange and peach sauce stands out.

Best Entertainment: Fairy musicians, accompanied by nightingales and other songbirds.

squires and maidens, as they will. Any knight who does attempt to woo a fairy need only make a successful **Lustful** roll to pass a very exciting evening. If such a coupling might result in offspring, remember to roll for this next Winter Phase. In addition, the Player-knight gains a Love Passion for their fairy lover, with a value of 2D6+3.

Eventually, the weary knights fall fast asleep only to awake the next morning and find themselves at the edge of the Forest Arroy, not far from the mighty Castle Stafford (some days' ride from Hautdesert). There is no trace of the Kingdom Inaperçu. The Whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd is clutched in the hands of one of the knights. Those knights who have taken a fairy lover may find a small token of remembrance on their persons, such as a maiden's sleeve or a courtier's neckerchief. Any squires or horses who were left behind at the Roaches are here as well, unable to account for how they got there.

It is up to you whether the Player-knights ever find the Kingdom Inaperçu again. Such places muddle the senses of the knights and bend the very nature of space and time. Allow them to remember enough to tell grand stories at court. Whether they possess a more detailed memory of the events may be determined by the nature and direction of your campaign. Should any of the knights have developed a powerful Love Passion, you may build a series of adventures around the knight's pursuit of their lover. If the Player-knight roleplays their frustrated Passion well, by voluntarily taking on the Misery Affliction for example, you may have them come to the attention of Queen Guenever

The Whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd

Type: Artifact

Object: Whetstone

Tradition: Roman Pagan

Description: One of the Thirteen Treasures of Britain. A yellow-grey sharpening stone passed down from the line of the house of Emperor Magnus Maximus (reigned 335–388) until it became an heirloom of the royal house of Strangorre.

Properties: Any valorous knight who uses it to sharpen their sword automatically kills their enemy if they strike true.

Game Effect: Once per year, the owner of the whetstone may sharpen their sword with it. They must then make a Valorous roll to summon the magic. With a success, the next person they damage with the sword automatically takes a Mortal Wound. The effect is spent after the successful hit until the blade is sharpened with the whetstone again.

and be invited to compete for a position as one of her knights.

Should any knight be foolish enough to have somehow offended their hosts (e.g., trying to steal something, acting loutish or ungrateful, etc.), they should pay a heavy penalty—if not immediately, then certainly sometime later in the campaign.

Part IV: The Journey Back

Have the Player-knights taken more than 37 days to reach this point? If so, they have failed in their quest, as you will see. Skip ahead to “What if...?” on p. 76 and offer your sincere condolences for a well-fought effort.

Otherwise, the aim here is to make the Player-knights sweat, but otherwise, let them get to Carlion on Pentecost Day—no sooner. It is 130 miles from Stafford to Carlion. If the

knights push their mounts, they can make the trip in five days. If the knights are more than five days ahead of the deadline, they find themselves beset by a violent storm. They are lashed at by rain, branches whip around them, and the wind howls. So intense is the storm their movement is drastically slowed.

Call for **Awareness** rolls—any who succeed realize this is no ordinary storm, and they may now attempt **Folklore** rolls. Success recalls tales of witches able to brew up such storms. Are there any Religious Christian Knights in the group? If so, they may roll against their **Devotion (God)** Passion; a success immediately cancels the baleful weather-magic. The rain stops, the clouds break up, and a golden ray of sunlight shines down upon the pious knight. This only lasts for one day, however. The next day, the storm whips up anew, and another **Devotion** roll must be attempted.

The storm rages for several days, exactly as required, to slow the knights to a pace that will get them to Carlion on Pentecost. During the storm, the Player-knights are only able to cover 15 miles, 25 miles if they push their mounts. When the storm clears, their pace increases to 20 miles or 30 if they push their mounts.

When the storm lifts, beautiful spring weather returns and the knights may press on towards Carlion. Several obstacles await them along the way, however...

GILEGRA THE RAVEN WITCH

On the day after the storm clears (or the knights begin their journey if there is no storm), the knights hear a woman’s cry on the road ahead of them. Turning a corner, they see a young, dark-haired maiden. She is surrounded by five surly-looking men armed with bows and swords, wearing expressions of evil intent. If the knights do not charge immediately, she cries to them for help. If the knights challenge the men, the ruffians tell them to bugger off and not bother real men at their play.

This should be more than sufficient excuse for any knight to massacre the varlets (if any Player-knights are still hesitant, have them roll against **Merciful**, **Just**, or **Proud**). Three



of the men loose arrows as soon as any knight charges. Once the knights close, the bandits leg it. The knights have time for one swipe or thrust before they disappear into the brushes. Any pursuit must be done on foot and requires a success on an opposed **Hunting** roll. Any knight succeeding corners a bandit. The bandits fight to the death, using their spears. If a knight does manage to capture a bandit, they may torture him and learn he was sent by the Raven Witches (torture is the only thing that makes him reveal who sent him). To even suggest torture, however, requires a knight to make a **Cruel** roll against his **Merciful** Opposing Trait, as torture is not a chivalrous act.

Once the bandits are taken care of, the knights may see to the maid. She says her name is Gilegra, and she is trying to reach King Arthur's court to ask a boon of Merlin. Her father, an old friend of the Archdruid from the days of Vortigern, is very ill. She begs to accompany the knights, as she is afraid more bandits may lurk in the forest. Any knight who declines should be reminded how unchivalrous an act this is; any knight with the Chivalry Passion loses 1 Honor if she is not allowed to accompany the group.

Gilegra is a Raven Witch, working in concert with Lady Elavane and sent to steal the

Raven Witches

The Raven Witches are an ancient order of wicked enchantresses who specialize in glamours that allow them to take the forms of giant ravens or warrior women. They are reclusive and value their privacy but can be convinced to aid other wicked magicians under certain circumstances. In this case, Lady Elavane has enlisted them and their bandit henchmen to ambush the Player-knights.

whetstone from the Player-knights. It was she who conjured up the storm (if any), and she now intends to end their quest for good. When they encamp that night, she waits until they are asleep and goes to the one who has the whetstone, quietly and carefully shaking the knight awake. If the knights set a watch, she waits for the knight who carries the whetstone to take their turn. She asks the knight to accompany her into the woods, claiming she must deliver a secret message from Merlin concerning the treasure. Her innocent, dark eyes fix upon the knight as she weaves an enchantment to make them trust her.

A Religious Christian knight may roll on their **Devotion (God)** Passion, with a success or critical success rendering them immune to her enchantment. A non-Religious Christian knight must critically succeed. A pagan knight automatically succumbs. Otherwise, ask the knight to roll **Trusting** +5. If the roll succeeds, the knight follows her. They may take a weapon only if they had one equipped; otherwise, they do not think to bring it.

Once she walks a good distance from camp, Gilegra tells the knight that Merlin is concerned about the treasure they carry. He sent her to examine it, and, if it is the correct treasure, he will use his magic to help get them to Carlion in time. If asked, she says she could not say this openly, as dark enemies watch them. She cannot name these enemies, claiming that merely saying their name may draw their attention.

BANDIT

Curs and dogs, the lot of them

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON	APP
12	10	12	12	1D6+5

ATTACKS

WEAPON	SKILL	VALUE	DAMAGE
Spear	Spear	8	4D6
Self Bow	Bow	8	3D6
Dagger	Brawling	8	2D6+4

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	24
Knockdown	12
Major Wound	12
Unconscious	6

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	16
Armor Points	4
Glory Award	10
Healing Rate	2

Armor: Gambeson

Traits: Merciful 7, Trusting 4, Valorous 8

Passions: Hate (Knights) 12

Skills: Awareness 18, Hunting 16

GILEGRA (HUMAN WARRIOR FORM)

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON	APP
14	11	15	14	18

ATTACKS

WEAPON	SKILL	VALUE	DAMAGE
Arming Sword	Sword	12	5D6
Grapple	Brawling	10	special

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	28
Knockdown	14
Major Wound	14
Unconscious	7

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	18
Armor Points	6 + 6
Glory Award	100
Healing Rate	3

Armor: Haubergeon and aketon, + round shield*

Traits: Chaste 4, Energetic 16, Generous 16, Honest 17, Proud 16

Passions: Devotion (Morrigu) 15, Loyalty (Lady Elavane) 14

* Shield penalizes -2 to all weapons when mounted; -10 Missile Attack Penalty.

GILEGRA (RAVEN FORM)

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON
14	11	15	14

ATTACKS

WEAPON	VALUE	DAMAGE
Peck	18	3D6

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	30
Knockdown	10
Major Wound	20
Unconscious	8

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	30
Armor Points	4
Glory Award	100
Valorous Mod.	-5

Ask for a **Trusting/Suspicious** Trait Decision roll. If Trusting wins out, the knight hands the whetstone to her. If Suspicious wins or both fail, they may decide to do so or not at their own discretion. Note that if the knight is still under her enchantment, they roll Trusting +5.

If handed the whetstone, Gilegra takes it and steps back from the knight, beginning a transformation into a giant raven. The knight has two Combat Rounds to act before the transformation is complete. They may strike at her if they have a weapon, or they may attempt to grapple her. They may also shout out to their comrades at the same time, in which case give everyone else an **Awareness** roll to rush to their comrade's aid (if successful, and they do not pause to don armor, they arrive on the second round, as she completes her transformation).

In her transitional form, consider Gilegra to have 15 Hit Points and no armor. Once her transformation finishes, she tries to fly away with the whetstone. If a knight hits or grapples her in any way, she drops the stone. If the knight successfully grapples her, she pecks at them to get free. If she drops the whetstone, she attacks the Player-knight once with a peck, grabbing it if she incapacitates her opponent. Otherwise, she flees in raven form.

If the Player-knight does not give her the whetstone, she shrieks and drops the glamour that disguises her as an innocent maiden, appearing instead as the armed and armored warrior she really is. She then attacks the knight with her sword—an attack so sudden the knight is unable to do anything but take defensive action (Defend or Evade) until the next round. She continues attacking until she either kills the knight or renders them unconscious, at which point she snatches the whetstone and begins her transformation into a raven.

Each round of combat gives the sleeping knights a chance at making an **Awareness** roll and waking up. Once the knights arrive, she begins her transformation, and they have one round to strike or grab the Raven Witch, as above. Her glamour fades if killed or knocked unconscious, and she becomes an armed and armored woman.

If no knight stops her, Gilegra gets away with the whetstone. The Gamemaster can either consider the scenario over or have the knights meet a forester the next day who has the whetstone (he saw the raven and took a potshot at it, causing it to drop the stone). He gladly turns it over when the knights explain its importance.

If she is captured, Gilegra will later make her escape at an opportune moment. She is a powerful magician; she has her ways of slipping the noose.



BANDIT AMBUSHES

The Player-knights continue onward, probably somewhat shaken from their encounter with Gilegra. As they ride along the next day, ask for **Battle** rolls. With a success, they spy movement in the woods and realize there is an ambush ahead. They can avoid the ambush by either turning aside or charging the ambushers (use the Bandit Statistics). In either case, the ambushers flee into the woods. Knights must win opposed **Movement Rate** rolls to catch the ambushers.

If the Player-knights miss their Battle rolls, they ride into the ambush. This starts with two volleys of arrows launched by the ambushers after the knights pass their position. There are two ambushers for each Player-knight. Therefore, four arrows per knight are loosed before they can react. The ambushers aim for the horses in the first volley and the knights in the second. The ambushers flee into the woods after firing. They can be chased down as above.

These ambushes continue, one each succeeding day until all the ambushers are dead or within a day's ride of Carlion. If any of the ambushers are caught, as with the encounter with Gilegra, only torture can make them admit they are in the employ of the Raven Witches. They fear them too much to do anything but attack daily until they are all dead.

The ambushers are meant to be a harassment more than anything else. Do not spring more than a single ambush per day, and do not add ambushers to the party to replace losses.

THE FINAL NIGHT: ATTACK OF THE BARGUEST

When the knights are one day away from Carlion, Lady Elavane, now recovered from her magical working at Hautdesert, unleashes her final attempt at stopping them. This attempt comes in the dead of night as most or all the knights sleep and begins with a low growl that alerts all the Player-knights. This allows them to reach their weapons, though unless they were sleeping in armor, they cannot do anything better than their helmets and shields before

BARGUEST

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON
10	15	15	15

ATTACKS

WEAPON	VALUE	DAMAGE
Bite	13	4D6
Terrifying Stare	15	special

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE	STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	25	Movement	15
Knockdown	10	Armor Points	5
Major Wound	15	Glory Award	100
Unconscious	6	Valorous Mod.	-5

OTHER

Skills: Avoidance 14

Terrifying Stare: Each round, the barguest may fix its Stare on one opponent within 30 yards, even while attacking with its bite. It opposes its Stare value against the opponent's Valorous. If the opponent loses, the horrifying vision causes them to check Cowardly and flee in panic from the combat for 1D6 rounds at maximum Movement Rate; on a partial success, they still flee as on a loss but do not check Cowardly.

they find themselves facing the huge glowing eyes and snarling fangs of a barguest!

The black-furred, horned hound concentrates all its Bite attacks against the holder of the whetstone. It targets each of the other Player-knights with its Terrifying Stare, one per round, to scare them off and reduce the odds against it.

Did anyone sharpen their blade with the whetstone before this encounter began? If so, remember a single damaging strike will lay it low.

If the barguest does kill the whetstone holder, it grabs the stone in its teeth (tearing the holder to pieces to get it if necessary) and flees. Hopefully, the Player-knights kill it before it comes to this, but if not, the scenario is over, and the knights have failed. Otherwise, when the barguest is slain, it crumbles into dust and blows away as an eerie howl cuts through the night...

Part V: Pentecost

The morning after the barguest's attack is Pentecost. The Player-knights must now ride

furiously to arrive at court on time. No matter how fast they ride, however, they arrive after the beginning of the battle between the Grey Knight and Sir Gawaine.

The mood in Carlion is one of a funeral. In addition, the city is even more choked with people than usual. The knights must push and shove their way through the crowds to reach the tournament field, which is thronged with onlookers. The sounds of battle ring out as they draw nigh to the field. No one attempts to stop them (although some jostled knights may mark them for a future challenge). Any cries are ignored, as all attention is focused on the field.

GAWAIN FIGHTS THE GREY KNIGHT

The Player-knights eventually reach the edge of the tournament field. Sir Gawaine and the Grey Knight have at one another. Gawaine wields Marmiodoise, its blade shining like the sun against the pervasive gloom. King Arthur watches from the dais to the side of which stand Lady de Vawse and her dwarf servant. Gawaine's squire, Eliezar, also watches from a place near the Player-knights, his face pale.

Sir Gawaine is bloody from many wounds; only his great strength and will, waxing with the rising sun, are keeping him alive. The Grey Knight bears obvious signs of frequent wounds—indeed, he is almost butchered. His armor is rent and dented, and strips of flesh dangle from his body. There is, however, no trace of blood on his person.

Then, as the Player-knights watch, Sir Gawaine delivers a mighty blow to the Grey Knight's head, knocking off his helmet. A collective gasp arises from the crowd as it becomes undeniable that the Grey Knight is a dead man. His face is clammy white. There are wormholes in his flesh. His eyes are sunken into his sockets. All is still and silent for a heartbeat...no one moves; no one speaks. Then, all hear King Arthur's awed gasp: "King Ryons!"

While the shock of the revelation sinks in, ask the Player-knights their intentions. They must get the whetstone to Gawaine and ensure him time to use it. Remind them, however,

that this combat is an affair of Honor and that their interference will not be tolerated and may even reflect badly upon their lord and King Arthur. In addition, it may be held against them at later tournaments, causing them to be barred from entry.

Once reminded, they have three options:

1. One or all the knights may race onto the field and attack King Ryons. Even if a knight sharpened their sword with the whetstone, they still must do enough damage to pierce Ryons' armor, which is enchanted to absorb up to 30 points of damage. Gawaine's magical strength currently grants him 8D6 Damage—the only reason he has been able to “wound” Ryons. Should any Player-knight manage to kill Ryons, they are banished from Logres forever for having soiled Arthur's reputation both by interfering with an affair of Honor at his court and for leaving the question of his innocence or guilt forever unanswered. It is, however, unlikely that any Player-knight will penetrate Ryons' armor. Their interference will cause enough of a disruption to allow them to pass the whetstone onto Gawaine and bid him run it along his blade. They have one Combat Round to accomplish this before the king angrily orders them to leave the field. Several dozen men-at-arms step forward to march the Player-knights off.
2. The Player-knights may demand the fight be stopped. Men-at-arms move towards them as the king angrily demands why they so disrupt the duel. Again, this may give one of the knights an opportunity to slip the whetstone to Gawaine. The king does not listen to any reason given by the knights. They are, as above, escorted away in disgrace (though not banished).
3. The knights may approach Eliezar, Gawaine's squire, and tell him about the whetstone. Within the rules of proper courtesy, he can stop the fight long enough to get the whetstone to his master without disgracing the Player-knights.

à Gawaine by àny Other Name...

It may seem strange at first glance to put a Gamemaster character in the role of the “hero” of the scenario. In fact, the Player-knights are the true heroes of the tale, for without the whetstone, Sir Gawaine is doomed; with it, his victory is a *fait accompli*. The drama lies in the fetching of the stone, not in the actual defeat of the Grey Knight. The central importance of the Player-knights' role is reflected in the Glory and Favors awaiting them at the conclusion of the quest.

That being said, if you find your group down a knight this year due to a Player being unable to attend, you could consider placing that character in Gawaine's shoes. This should only be done with the consent of the Player, but the other Player-knights may feel the stakes are much higher if the life of one of their own hangs in the balance!

If you use this option, award the “Gawaine” Player-knight 500 Glory. The other Player-knights earn their Glory as usual but do not enjoy a Favor owed from Sir Gawaine. In compensation, the “Gawaine” substitute should consider offering a comparable Favor or sharing their Glory award equally amongst the group. If the Player-knights have a Loyalty (Companions) Passion for each other, the value should automatically increase by 1 in addition to earning a check. And if they have not yet generated this Passion, now would be the time to do it!

The Players may, of course, come up with other schemes. Adjudicate these as best you can (e.g., they might attack or threaten Lady de Vawse, causing Ryons to go to her aid but allowing a knight to pass the whetstone to Gawaine). The Player-knights are not close enough to get either Arthur's or Merlin's attention. The important point is for the Player-knights to



succeed without disgracing themselves. If your Players are completely stumped due to their personal unfamiliarity with the formal rules of combat, allow them a **Courtesy** roll to remind them that Eliezar may freely assist his master.

Once Gawaine has the whetstone, he plies it against the vorpal edge of Marmiodoise (and naturally succeeds in his Valorous roll). He continues with the battle, perhaps being wounded once or twice more before unleashing a tremendous blow. It pierces Ryon's chest, and, with a look of surprise, the twice-dead king crumples

and falls. Worms erupt from his flesh as a terrible stench washes across the field. In an instant, nothing is left but a suit of empty armor.

Bloody but unbowed, Gawaine lifts his sword high and proclaims, "The truth is proven. Hail Arthur Pendragon, rightful king of this shining realm!"

Lady de Vawse, in utter shock, rushes past Gawaine and cradles the empty suit of armor in her arms as tears stream down her face. Her dwarf servant attends her.

From the gathered onlookers, a mighty cheer rises: "Hail Sir Gawaine, the King's Champion!" The cheer continues to grow until, suddenly, Gawaine sags and falls. His squire and several men rush to him and carry his limp body from the field. Player-knights can only look on from amidst the confusion. If, however, they make an **Awareness** roll, they notice Merlin approach

THE GREY KNIGHT

The Vengeance of King Ryon

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON	APP
20	10	14	—	—

ATTACKS

WEAPON	SKILL	VALUE	DAMAGE
Arming Sword	Sword	16	6D6
Lance	Charge	13	8D6
Dagger	Brawling	12	2D6+6

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	—
Knockdown	—
Major Wound	—
Unconscious	—

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	17
Armor Points	30 + 6
Glory Award	250
Valorous Mod.	-10

Armor: Enchanted hauberk, aketon, advanced nasal helm + kite shield*

* Shield penalizes -2 to all weapons when mounted except Mounted Charge with spear or lance; -10 Missile Attack Penalty.

From Beyond the Grave: The Grey Knight does not feel the pain of wounds and is immune to Knockdown and Unconsciousness. While he is not the best fighter in the world, he cannot be stopped by normal means, fighting long after he should be "dead." Only a weapon sharpened with the whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd or similar enchanted objects can release the knight from his unearthly existence.

Eliezar and, after a moment's conversation, take the whetstone and Marmiodoise.

AFTERMATH

Sir Gawaine, of course, survives, although he needs some time recovering. Needless to say, he is very grateful to the Player-knights.

If the Player-knights have disgraced themselves, they must appear before the king and his knights to account for their actions. Of course, the court is disposed towards leniency, given the circumstances. Give them some uncertain moments before they are exonerated.

The only exception to this is if they somehow managed to kill Ryon, for which they are banished.

If the Player-knights did not disgrace themselves, they should be appropriately rewarded. King Arthur's generosity is legendary; a Favor of at least F250 is in order, offset by the value of any equipment damaged or destroyed on their quest replaced by an item of the highest quality. For example, if a Player-knight's warhorse was killed, they can expect to have it replaced by a fine gray charger worth £160, leaving them with an F90 Favor—perhaps expressed as the gift of a manor worth £9.

It is not out of the question for a Chivalrous knight to be made a Knight of the Round Table if they have sufficiently high Glory. To put this reward in perspective, however, remember that even Sir Gawaine does not receive this honor

until 517. If the Player-knight who gave up Marmio-doise wishes Merlin to give it back, use your best discretion. If Merlin thinks the knight (or perhaps their heir) will do great deeds, he returns it. Otherwise, he holds onto it, perhaps earning the Player-knight's enmity.

If the Player-knights publicly mention Lady Elavane's participation in this affair,

they are skating on thin ice. Accusing the daughter of a powerful king is not to be done lightly. You may wish to allow the Player-knights a **Prudent** roll. If successful, remind them they have no actual proof beyond the word of the fairies, who are unlikely to appear at court any time soon. If they managed to capture a bandit who talked, he dies of magical causes long before he can be brought forth to confirm their accusations. Such knights are marked for vengeance by Elavane, just as she does Sir Gawaine, and will find themselves targeted by dark conspiracies in the years ahead.

If, on the other hand, the Player-knights mention Elavane's involvement privately to Sir Gawaine or Merlin, or even to Arthur himself, they do not suffer for it. While Arthur does not want to believe such tales, he does recognize the knights are doing their duty in reporting their suspicions to him. Their discretion may aid them later.

Merlin is very interested in all the knights' adventures—particularly in their encounter with the lion and the serpent. He does not, however, give them back the whetstone, nor does

ARIETTE DE LA BELLE SOURIRE

The Lady of Stonewall

SIZ	DEX	STR	CON	APP
10	13	8	16	17

ATTACKS

WEAPON	SKILL	VALUE	DAMAGE
Dagger	Brawling	10	2D6+3

HEALTH

STATISTIC	VALUE
Hit Points	26
Knockdown	10
Major Wound	16
Unconscious	7

OTHER

STATISTIC	VALUE
Movement	16
Armor Points	0
Personal Glory	893
Healing Rate	3

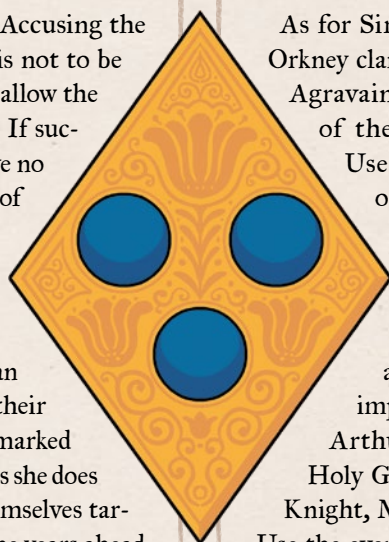
Traits: Chaste 17, Modest 5

Passions: Adoration (Sagramore) 5, Hate (Clarence)

18, Love (Family) 14, Loyalty (Duke of Glevum) 12,

Skills: Battle 10, Chirurgery 10, First Aid 14, Industry

12, Orate 12, Singing 13, Stewardship 16



As for Sir Gawaine and the rest of the Orkney clan (with the single exception of Agravaire), they become firm friends of the Player-knights henceforth.

Use this as the springboard for other scenarios—for example, the arrival of Sir Lancelot and Sir Mordred.

Also, keep in mind that this tale anticipates and foreshadows many of the important events to come during Arthur's reign: The Quest for the Holy Grail, the coming of the Green Knight, Mordred's treachery, and so on.

Use the events you have created to forge a tighter link between the Player-knights and the world of Arthur.

ARIETTE'S FINAL BID

If the Player-knights succeed in their quest, there is a chance someone may win the hand of fair Ariette. What motivated her games of love at the beginning of the scenario? If she was looking for a husband or was really infatuated, then she proceeds to beg the queen to arrange a marriage between her and the Player-knight she interacted with before.

Ask the Player-knight to make a **Glory Roll**. If they succeed, Queen Guenever puts in a good word with the king. In the heroic glow of the quest's success, King Arthur then successfully urges the Duke of Glevum (Ariette's regent since the death of her father) to approve the marriage. A Yuletide wedding ensues. The new husband acquires the honors of her father's position, becoming a rich vassal—a great success indeed! (Such a prize, of course, takes the place of any other Favors the Player-knight in question might have received.) Of course, the Player-knight's holdings are now uncomfortably close to the Raven Witches of Glevum, who no doubt have some unfinished business regarding the ill-treatment Gilegra suffered at their hands...

(So great is this success, in fact, that the Player-knight could justifiably retire. Discuss this possibility with the Player and how marriage into the upper echelons of nobility with one degree of removal from the king's court and the attendant increase in responsibilities could change the course of the campaign, before letting them decide whether they wish to move forward with the wedding. More guidelines on running campaigns at this level may be found in the **Pendragon Noble's Handbook**.)

Enclosed among the handouts is a simplified land record for her property, ready for use. Just copy it and hand it to the Player. The knight has the choice of impaling their arms with hers, and a martial heir to that property would thus bear quartered arms.

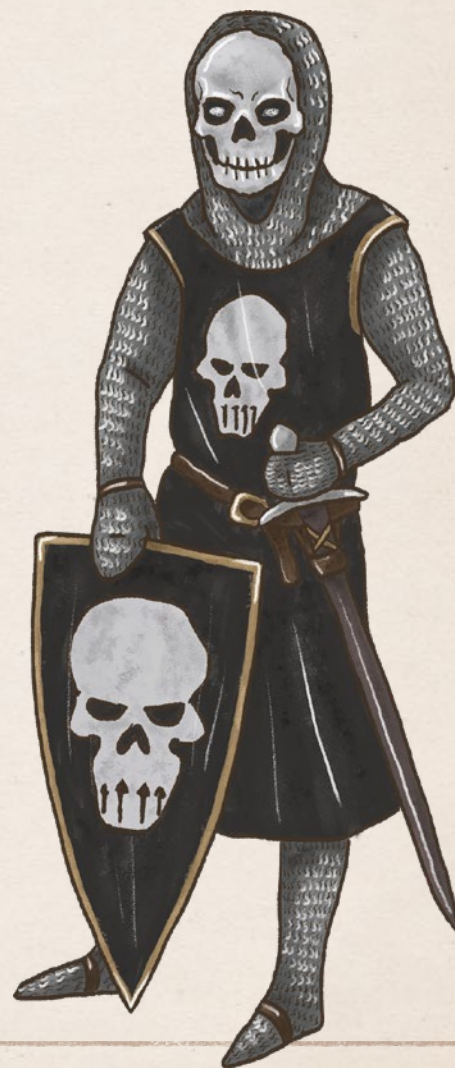
Copy Lady Ariette's statistics onto a character sheet and give it to someone other than the Player or her spouse for their use as a Supporting Character. If her interest in the Player-knight was based on genuine affection, replace her Adoration Passion with a **Love (Spouse)** Passion of half the value of the Adoration, or 1D6+4 if she did not have that Passion for the Player-knight; otherwise, she carries a torch for Sir Sagamore, her great unrequited love.

In a few years, when Queen Guenever introduces the tradition of *fine amour*, she is the perfect candidate to be the paramour of some romantic knight.

WHAT IF...?

...the Player-knights do not succeed? In this case, the Gamemaster has two options:

- * Gawaine is killed, and Arthur's honor is soiled. This option is undesirable; it takes a fabulous knight out of the game and darkens the "bright" phases of the saga.
- * Alternatively, merely assume that another knight completed the quest they failed. Sir Tor and Sir Sagamore are both likely candidates. Naturally, the Player-knights (if they lived) lose the Glory and the great honor and contacts they would have made. Alas, such are the fortunes of errantry.



GLORY FOR 515

This is a list of the standard awards in this scenario. There are numerous opportunities for awards based on performance in tournaments and at court (see the *Pendragon Gamemaster's Handbook*) in addition to these.

- ✱ **On the Road:** Award 10 points for stopping the beating, 10 points for replacing the ox. Award an additional 50 points if Leodegrance or some other very important character is present.
- ✱ **Arrival in Carlion:** Those knights who keep their seats in front of Kay and Bedivere earn Glory equal to the value of their Horsemanship Skill or double that amount with a critical success.
- ✱ **The Feast:** Award 50 points if Arthur stops Kay's chastisement.
- ✱ **A Bit of Conversation:** A knight earns Glory equal to their Prudent Trait, or 25 points if they did not roll.
- ✱ **Tournament Day:** Award Glory for defeating opponents "for love" based on the opponent's *best* Weapon Skill value (including any bonuses from Passions): 1 point for a value of 10 or less, 3 points for a value of 11–15, 5 points for a value of 16–20, and 10 points if the Skill has a critical bonus.
- ✱ **The Coming of the Grey Knight:** Each knight who succeeds at their Valorous roll earns Glory equal to the value of the Trait.
- ✱ **The Dark Abbey:** Award 25 points for successfully resisting the hequibede; 100 points for killing the panther; 10 points for being present at an extraordinary event.
- ✱ **The Guardian of Olbray:** Award 50 points for defeating Sir Vardilain, 50 points for getting word to Pellam, and/or 100 points if the knights actually reach the Castle of Adventure.
- ✱ **The Lion and the Serpent:** Award 250 points for slaying the lion or the serpent (a total of 500 if they slay both) and 10 points for being present at a miraculous event.
- ✱ **The Host:** Knights receive 25 Glory points for encountering the spirits of the dead or 50 points if they successfully resist their torment.
- ✱ **The Priory:** The knights receive 10 Glory for finding the priory (even if they do not enter it—being present is enough) and 10 more for being present at the miraculous healing.
- ✱ **The Kingdom Inaperçu:** Award 10 Glory for entering a Fairy Realm.
- ✱ **Sangnoir:** Award 100 Glory for defeating the giant. Any Player-knight who thinks to use the rowan whip to tame Seleminé receives an additional 10 Glory.
- ✱ **The Whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd:** Award 25 points for successfully using a weapon sharpened by the whetstone in combat.
- ✱ **The Witch Gilegra:** Award 10 points per bandit killed, 100 Glory for killing Gilegra.
- ✱ **The Final Night:** Award 100 points for killing the barguest.
- ✱ **Pentecost:** 300 points for getting the whetstone to the Grey Knight's opponent without receiving a rebuke from Arthur, or 200 points if they do receive a rebuke but still hand off the whetstone.
- ✱ **Marrying Ariette:** 893 points (Ariette's Glory), plus 500 (becoming a Banneret Knight).

Appendix A: Designer's Notes

The following Designer's Notes, penned by Larry DiTillio back in 1986 and presented here with minimal corrections, provide both a helpful insight into his choices in putting the original adventure together as well as serving as a model of how Gamemasters can take various sources of Arthurian inspiration and weave them together to create original stories.

I've never been one for King Arthur, but after one play of **Pendragon** I was impressed. Here at last was a real role-play fantasy, a world in which the sword was still prominent but the man behind it was even more so. I saw in Greg's work a piece of innovation, a system that was simple and elegant and designed to make characters think and feel deeply. That got me interested. I then dutifully slogged through Malory (the "easy" version), delighted in Steinbeck's *Acts of King Arthur*, wrestled with a ponderous Tolkien translation of *Gawaine and the Green Knight*, read some scattered tales from my *Enchanted World* collection, and watched the films *Knights of the Round Table* and *Sword of the Valiant* (this latter piece is an extremely loose rendition of *Gawaine and the Green Knight*. Its principal actor sucks, but it's worth seeing if only for Sean Connery as the Green Knight).

Thus armed, I considered my plot. I had warmed up to Gawaine quite a bit, though my reading and film viewing gave me an interest in the Green Knight story. However, I couldn't see simply recounting that. Tales of Silent Knights (i.e., knights resurrected from the dead) intrigued me and I hit upon the idea of an unkillable knight challenging Arthur's reign. Since the scenario was designed for the second phase, the May Babies incident seemed a good catalyst for the tale. Thus the Grey Knight rode onto the field and my scenario was underway.

There were several things I wanted in the scenario; one was a lot of interplay between the characters of the Arthurian mythos and the player knights. Being the fiend I am, I also wanted the players to be constantly in trouble. Thus, the meeting with Agravaine, a minor incident that nevertheless keeps players cautious in all their dealings with the Orkney clan. This is followed by the comic incident with Sir Kay and the subsequent meeting with Gawaine. In short, by the time the players get to the grand feast, they're already beset with problems.

The feast continues the problems so that the tournament day finds the hapless players challenged for all sorts of reasons. Then, all the minor problems disappear as Lady de Vawse and the Grey Knight appear and major trouble starts.

Once this section gets going, the actions the players have already taken contribute. They may find their way to the Queen through the friar, through Dame Ariette, or even because of the conversation between Sir Cynwal and Sir Graid. What they do pays off or doesn't, as the case may be.

In the Wastelands, the true mettle of the players is tested again and again. Decisions must be made frequently and quickly, decisions resting on both player skill and game mechanics. The Dark Abbey gives players the sense of mystery and horror that permeates the Wastelands. The incident in Olbray gives the knights a lesson in loyalty, chivalry and madness. The Lion and the Serpent forces them to act quickly with no basis for their decision other than their gut feeling. (In one test, one player attacked the lion while all the others went after the serpent. He got roundly trounced and only my soft heart kept him alive.)

The final incident with the Sluagh is a real test; the foe is both unbeatable and inescapable. Players must fully commit at this point and generally those who survive are more determined than ever. This is also a good test of the Gamemaster's ability to instill utter fear and despair in the players.

The Queen of the Wastelands is a resting point. Here, the players can meet one of the most mysterious characters from the Arthurian tales, as well as get themselves restored for the last leg of the adventure (expect to have many players grievously wounded at this time).



In the Forest Arroy, I made full use of the Green Knight tale (I just couldn't resist) and then moved over to the more magical with the players' foray into the Kingdom Inaperçu. The fight with the giant is designed to suck in know-it-all players (I'll never forget my elation when one player suggested they simply ride out and challenge the "stupid" giant. Once the rocks started flying, the true measure of stupidity was apparent), likewise, their difficulty in subduing the faerie horse goes a long way to shattering preconceived notions.

The Journey Back is the full cut-loose, all-or-nothing leg of the scenario. Now the players have what they need, but can they get it there? Storms, ambushers, the raven witch, and the barguest all contribute to the urgency of their ride back. The hardest part of this to work is the raven witch. The players are warned and most smell a fish when she arrives. Gamemasters may have to think quickly to spring Gilegra on them. Loss of Honor helps (how can you ignore the plea from an innocent maid?), as do her magical powers. The barguest may *seem* like overkill, but the whetstone makes its dispatch simple. Here, the Gamemaster is warned to be subtle about the effects of the whetstone. It is suggested you take all the names of those who've sharpened their swords (generally, you can count on all of them doing so), then have them roll their skills when the weapon in question is actually used.

The final scene of the scenario is again meant to test the players' decision-making ability. They must *move* fast but are constrained by the code of honor. This can lead to wrong actions (e.g., in one game, a player desperately tried to give Gawaine his sword since it had been sharpened with the whetstone. Of course, only Gawaine's sword could work against the Grey Knight: The use of the whetstone is strictly limited so that Gawaine would have to sharpen his own sword with it to get its power). In most cases, the players will disgrace themselves in some way. This does not hurt overmuch if they succeed in saving Gawaine.

In addition to the actual episode itself, *The Grey Knight* is also designed to meld intriguingly into a **Pendragon** campaign. The tale is literally fraught with prophecy: The Queen of the Wastelands will lead a pious knight on a great quest, Sir Bercilak will become the Green Knight. Mordred will be the serpent who undoes the lion. Morgan le Fay will launch major plots against Arthur. All these things are foreshadowed so that knights who survive and play on will have knowledge useful to them in later years. The scenario also bids goodbye to Merlin, a fact that Gamemasters may wish to alter should they want Merlin to stick around a bit. Beyond all this, the scenario also helps put the May

Babies incident in perspective, as well as resolve it to the benefit of Arthur (assuming the player knights succeed). It also gives the players great connections with the important knights, particularly Gawaine (though this may be tempered by the way in which the players handle Agravaire). Finally, I am very proud of the imagery in this scenario: The Grey Knight's appearance, the storms, the Sluagh, the lion and the serpent, the devastated village of Olbray, the Fairy realm, etc.

Not too many changes were made in the original manuscript. The major one was adding Morgan Le Fay's "glamour" on The Journey Back so the players would think they were gaining ground when they were actually riding in circles. This came about from a playtest run at the DunDraCon '86 game convention held in the San Francisco Bay area, in which it hit me as an inspiration. The players were well ahead of schedule and rightfully asked why they couldn't recognize landmarks that should have been there. Bingo. Morgan's grand "glamour" came into being. Greg, who was in on the playtest, asked me to add it and I did.

Another interesting change came in the plot phase of writing. I had intended to make the Grey Knight King Lot, raised from the dead, giving Gawaine double problems (he'd have to kill his own resurrected father). Greg said OH NO! So, I searched for another knight and came across King Ryons who worked perfectly. For this, I am indebted to Greg and Mac MacMahon, our local working Arthur-encyclopedia who came up with the notion. More debt goes to Phyllis Ann Karr, whose *King Arthur Companion* gave me the necessary information on the Queen of the Wastelands, King Ryons, and Lady de Vawse.

I believe *The Grey Knight* is the best scenario I have ever written. It opened my head to the richness of the Arthur mythos, as well as being just plain fun to write. Again, credit goes to Greg for a fine job of design and writing and to Mac MacMahon, whose enthusiasm got me involved. It's best played by beginning knights. If veterans who are already familiar with Arthur's court are involved, much of the fun of meeting star knights for the first time is ameliorated. It should also remain in 515. If played in a later year, it loses much of its impact and can cause problems (due to the prophetic events involved). It could be set earlier, though obviously not before the May Babies incident. I hope **Pendragon** players receive it warmly and have as much enjoyment in its play as I have. Thus, the tale is told. *Exeunt omnes*.

—Larry DiTillio
April 15th, 1986

Appendix B: Handouts

The May Babies Incident

In the early summer of 512, Merlin and Lady Níneve, the Chief Lady of the Lake, visited the Kings of the North. They spoke of a famous child born on May Day. The power of their glammers and prophecies allowed the pair to take the children born on that day upon their departure. What became of them is not known, but rumors quickly began to spread that the children had been killed and Arthur was responsible. The incident led directly to the 513 campaign that culminated with the Battle of Terrabil.

Nimue's Song

Thirteen completes any great list—
Companions and covens, the months of the year,
Disciples and master traitorously kissed.

Listen, my lords and great ladies fair
The Thirteen great Treasures—list as I list!
The Thirteen great Treasures of the land of Lear.
Thirteen great Treasures, for which warriors fight,
Some easily seen, some easily missed,
Some scattered, some hid, some in plain sight.

Thirteen great Treasures appear on my list,
Granted to Britain by most ancient right.
Thirteen great Treasures—list as I list!

The dread blade Dyrnwyn
Which burns mortal hands, except for the king
Who shall rule in Strathclyde.

The bountiful hamper of Gwyddno Garanhir,
Which with the food of a single man
Will feed a great host a hundred strong.

The great brimming horn of Bran Galad,
Which slakes the thirst for any taste,
No matter what drink, it's never run dry.

The far-ranging chariot of dread Morgan:
No place too strange or too obscure
To be found by its swiftly-turning wheels.

The glittering halter of Clydno Eiddyn,
Which reins in even the wildest steeds.
Broken or no, this will tame all.

The well-greased knife of Llawfrodedd :
It serves two dozen dinner at once.
A fantastical blade for feasting alone.

The deep iron cauldron of the giant Wyrnach,
A cauldron of heroes and heroes to be
A brave man's food's cooked. Cowards go hungry.

The razoring whetstone of Tudwal Tudglyd
Will perfect the edge of any strong sword—
Any sword borne by a brave-hearted man.

The exclusive coat of Padarn Reedcoat,
Which fits only men of noblest birth,
Not titled alone but bred blood and bone.

The crock and the dish of Rhygenydd,
Two treasures held in this single verse,
Provides fair and fresh food of any kind.

The gwyddbwl board which plays itself:
Silver and gold pieces contest for the prize.
It belongs in the north among the wild Picts.

Finally, the mantle of invisibility
Of our High King, great Arthur Pendragon,
The brave and fierce bear of the isle of Britain.

Thirteen completes any great list—
Companions and covens, the months of the year,
Disciples and master traitorously kissed.

Thirteen great Treasures appeared on my list,
Granted to Britain by most ancient right.
Thirteen Treasures of Britain. I've finished my list.

Holding: Stonewall Estate

Situated in the picturesque River Severn Valley between the Forest of Dean and the city of Glevum, Stonewall is a prosperous, mid-sized estate. Its chief income is derived from harvesting flax in the fens along the river, and from collecting tolls at several fords across the Severn. During the Anarchy, this land was in constant peril from foreign invaders, and was plundered during the wars of King Nanteleod. All that is in the past now, and the land prospers once again under King Arthur's reign.

DETAILS

Stonewall Estate consists of the eponymous manor and its village of Flaxfield as well as a number of villages and hamlets scattered across two hundreds.

Value: £50 (£5 discretionary income; 50 Passive Glory)

Army: 5 knights, 10 spearmen, 10 archers, and 10 garrison troops (personal household)

Special Holdings: Streamside Quarry (held in trust for the Crown)

FORTIFICATIONS

Stonewall Manor, formerly known as Flaxfield, earned its newer sobriquet during the Anarchy, when Ariette's father fortified the hall proper and erected a great perimeter wall using stone from the Streamside Quarry.

Stonewall Manor

Location: Valley Forest, Glevum

DV: 2/4

Defensive Ring—Rock Wall (DV 2): 15 acres, 2,865 ft. perimeter; Gate (-1), 2 Gateworks (1)

Defensive Ring—Manor Hall (DV 4): Two-story stone manor (2), lead-tile roof (2)

UPCOMING HISTORY

The Wastelands reach Stonewall in the year 549.

SETTLEMENTS

Stonewall Manor: This manor is the chief residence of the future Lady Ariette and her spouse.

Flaxfield Village: The largest village in the estate, immediately adjacent to Stonewall Manor, located in Westville Hundred.

PLACES

Defiance: The local name for a nearby hillfort where the Dobunni tribe made its last stand against the Romans.

The Forest of Dean: This great, ancient forest forms the western border of Stonewall Estate. The Beast of Dean, called "the Moose-Pig" locally, is a giant boar so large it can knock down trees which haunts the forest's great valley.

St. Anthony's Well: Not far from Defiance is this natural spring, where people come to pray for the return of lost items.

Tintedbarrow Hundred: This hundred includes the villages of Alders, Allanstown, Mounds, Peartree, and Tintedbarrow, as well as the hamlets of Ashtree and Pooltown.

Westville Hundred: Besides Flaxfield, this hundred includes the village of Westville, situated at a major ford over the River Severn, as well as the hamlets of Bullfield and Longvale.

Britain



Escavalon & Glevum



Cameliard & Cheshire



The Wastelands



Challenge Death's Companion!

Arthur's right to rule is jeopardized when the fearsome Grey Knight accuses the King of murdering children.

Sir Gawaine steps forth to defend the King's honor—but Merlin foresees this champion will die at the hands of the Grey Knight.

The Grey Knight waits for vengeance, and time is running out! Can you find the treasure that holds the key to defeating this vile foe, and save the life of Sir Gawain and the kingdom itself?

- * Everything you need to run the legendary Grey Knight campaign, fully updated for the new edition of the game.
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- * Attempt to turn the tide of Arthurian history by participating in famous battles.
- * Two prequel scenarios bridge The Sword Campaign from the *Pendragon Starter Set* to the adventures in The Grey Knight.
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The Grey Knight is a complete campaign and is fully compatible with both the *Pendragon Starter Set* and the *Pendragon Player's Handbook*.



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